

THE HORIZONTAL GEOMETRY OF PRODUCTION NETWORKS

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Abstract

This paper makes two novel contributions to the understanding of production networks and their role on comovement. First, it introduces a theoretical framework that distinguishes between demand- and supply-driven network distances, measuring economic distance between sectors based on shared upstream sellers or downstream buyers. These horizontal complementarities determine how sector-specific shocks transmit horizontally across the network, paralleling and rebalancing the standard vertical mechanism of sectoral supply chains. Comovement thus hinges on the geometry of network distances: nearby sectors tend to move in opposite directions due to common trade relations, whereas distant sectors comove as vertical propagation prevails. Second, using sector-level U.S. employment data, the paper provides empirical evidence that positive employment shocks in closely demand- or supply-related sectors are counteracted, while greater network distances generate employment comovement. Together, these two contributions reveal that the horizontal geometry of a production network plays a critical role in understanding how sectoral interactions propagate micro-originated shocks in an Input-Output economy.

JEL: C67, D57, E32, F16, L14

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INTRODUCTION

An hallmark of contemporary production systems is the comovement of economic activity across sectors. Recent advances in the production networks literature have demonstrated how independent, idiosyncratic shocks to a specific sector can propagate through Input-Output linkages, generating sectoral comovement in production and contributing to aggregate fluctuations. The presence of “(anti-)cascade effects” diffuses the shock along parallel supply chains via the tangle of Input-Output connections that tie sectors together.¹ In essence, a positive sectoral shock transmits positively and vertically to other linked sectors participating in the network, thereby inducing economic variables across different sectors to move together over time.

Yet, once complementarities in intermediate inputs constrain substitution possibilities, the transmission of shocks proves less straightforward.² One contribution of this paper is to theoretically assert that sectoral comovement depends crucially on the nature of *economic distance* between sectors. Beyond vertical linkages, sectors can be additionally connected through demand and/or supply interdependencies, contingent upon their common structure of inter-sectoral trade. Specifically, a pair of sectors exhibits *factor input demand* network distance if they are buying intermediate inputs from a similar set of upstream suppliers, whereas the pair reflects *factor input supply* network distance whenever its sectors are selling part of their production as intermediate input to a similar set of downstream buyers (e.g., Conley and Dupor 2003). As sectors depend on overlapping sets of buyers/suppliers, intermediate inputs substitutability across the production network is linearly embedded in its horizontal geometry, and patterns of sectoral comovement hinge on the network economic distance between sectors: nearby sectors move in opposite directions due to shared Input-Output relations, whereas distant sectors tend to comove as the standard (vertical) propagation prevails.

Under this perspective, an Input-Output structure not only reflects *vertical* complementarities in propagating shocks (i.e., the intensity of the comovement between two sectors depends on their intensity of being interconnected; refer to Shea 2002), but also *horizontal* complementarities as sectors are additionally held together by demand and supply relations from having in common a resembling Input-Output geometry, also connecting disconnected sectors (as established by Theorem 1). While vertical propagation mechanisms are broadly utilized in the literature, this paper

¹ Central insight is that a positive shock to a sector enhances its productive performance, triggering: (i) a *downstream effect*, as other sectors have an incentive to expand their demand from that sector; (ii) an *upstream effect*, as higher production in the shocked sector raises its demand of intermediate inputs, benefiting its suppliers; and (iii) *network spillovers*, where the positive effects ripple beyond immediate trading partners, benefiting indirectly connected sectors. On the verticality of Input-Output economies refer to Pasinetti (1973).

² Limits to the ability to adjust input combinations within sectors challenge classical comovement, as reflected in a Constant Elasticity of Substitution (CES), non-linear setting (e.g., Corsetti et al. 2008, Atalay 2017, Baqaee and Farhi 2019). My network’s horizontal geometry – captured by sectoral “economic” distances through shared upstream suppliers or downstream buyers – embeds this logic in reduced form, as distance-based interdependencies initiate an horizontal propagation of sector-specific shocks; refer to Subsection 1.3.

explores how horizontal interdependencies and various forms of network economic distance affect comovement across sectors participating in the production network, with theoretical insights tested empirically using sectoral U.S. employment data.

On the empirical validation, a number of studies have documented the presence of sectoral comovement in employment levels (*e.g.*, Cooper and Haltiwanger 1990, Christiano and Fitzgerald 1998, Yedid-Levi 2016).³ Yet, much of this evidence treats sectors as isolated units and gives limited attention to the role of inter-sectoral linkages. Understanding how these Input-Output relationships shape sectoral comovement remains an open question, and there is a lack of empirical research specifically examining sectoral employment comovement within the context of a production network. Another contribution of this paper is to attempt at filling this empirical void.

From a network perspective comovement is endogenous. The aforementioned standard propagation system suggests that comovement originates from the even transmission of sectoral shocks through Input-Output linkages. Does this vertical transmission mechanism persist when different types of network distance are factored in? Does a positive shock to one sector propagate in the same way to others under horizontal demand and supply linkages? My empirical findings show that positive comovement primarily arises between sectors that are “economically distant” in the network (with few common upstream suppliers and downstream buyers), while the picture is mixed for closely demand-related sectors sharing similar suppliers: vertical and horizontal transmissions overlap, rendering it difficult to identify which one prevails. In contrast, supply-based distances produce opposite movements: a positive shock to closer sectors negatively affects other sectors that sell intermediate inputs to the same downstream buyers, thereby counteracting the expected and classical upward transmission of shocks along the production network.⁴

Indeed, building a coherent theoretical framework that emphasizes the role of demand- and supply-driven network distances in shaping sectoral comovement within an Input-Output economy, and validating its main predictions using sector-level U.S. network and employment data, constitute the two central contributions of this paper.

Section 1 introduces two complementary measures of Input-Output economic distance: (i) *factor input demand* network distance, when sectors are buying their intermediate inputs from similar sectors; and (ii) *factor input supply* network distance, when sectors are selling their intermediate outputs as intermediate inputs to similar sectors. Both distances are formalized as full matrices, derived from the supply-side with profit-maximizing behaviour, summarizing demand or supply horizontal linkages from common Input-Output relationships. Demand-based distances cap-

³ Sectoral activity and comovement are not separate phenomena but overlapping features. Various papers suggest how business cycles are driven by micro-level shocks rather than aggregate ones (*e.g.*, Long and Plosser 1987, Foerster et al. 2011, Gabaix 2011, Moro 2012, Garin et al. 2018), and that a synchronization between changes in output and employment, either at aggregate or sectoral level, is occurring (*e.g.*, Quah and Sargent 1993, Hornstein and Praschnik 1997, Stock and Watson 1999, Rebelo 2005, Barrot, Grassi, et al. 2021).

⁴ Differently, Conley and Dupor (2003) empirically find that sectors with similar upstream suppliers exhibit stronger correlations in productivity growth than those selling to similar downstream buyers.

ture how shocks to a downstream buyer trigger coordinated adjustments in input usage across sectors that share common upstream suppliers, whereas supply-based distances capture how shocks to an upstream seller drive coordinated relative price adjustments across sectors supplying the same downstream buyers. In other words, on the input side, sectors that buy from the same suppliers reveal simultaneous adjustments as they rebalance labour and intermediates; on the output side, sectors selling to the same buyers show revenue shifts when downstream demand changes. A sufficient-statistic perspective interprets these distance effects in reduced form. Under demand linkages, negative comovement arises only when intermediate inputs complementarity in downstream buyers is strong (a positive shock to one sector increases the price of a common supplier, and other downstream buyers with limited substitutability reduce demand). By contrast, in the supply-based case, negative comovement is immediate and mechanical, as a sector capturing demand from a shared downstream buyer reduces activity among competing suppliers after a positive supply shock (it effectively lowers its relative price). In this sense, demand linkages make comovement ambiguous and dependent on substitution patterns in downstream demand, while supply linkages make comovement transparent and directly tied to upstream competition for downstream markets. Network distances thus reproduce the negative comovement from non-linear intermediate inputs complementarities (*e.g.*, Baqaee and Farhi 2019), with demand- and supply-driven horizontal interdependencies linearly summarizing its propagation mechanisms.

Building on these effects, Section 2 examines their general equilibrium implications for employment comovement across interconnected sectors. Consistent with standard exogenous production network models (*e.g.*, Long and Plosser 1983, Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012), a shock to a given sector propagates vertically along its supply chains. Once network distances are introduced, the strength of vertical spillovers is partly offset or reshaped by horizontal propagation. Employment responses are ambiguous under demand-based distances, since vertical and horizontal channels overlap and may either reinforce or counteract one another. By contrast, clearer responses are identified under supply-based distances: when serving the same downstream buyers, a decline in the relative price of a nearby supplier increases its own employment while reducing that of competing suppliers. In sum, network distances govern not only the direction but also the intensity of cross-sectoral comovement, with horizontal transmission acting as a distance-dependent trigger factor which gradually fades with weaker distance-based interconnections.

In developing this perspective, a central theoretical result (Theorem 2) emerges: measures of network “economic” distances are not themselves weighted by the Input-Output structure. In other words, sectoral distances in terms of common demand or supply relationships retain an independent force in shaping sectoral comovement, distinct from the intensity of inter-sectoral trade flows. This separation strengthens the importance of horizontal complementarities between sectors.

As a validation of theoretical insights, the role of network distances on sectoral comovement is empirically tackled on U.S. employment and Input-Output data, whose

distance-based production network characteristics are presented in Section 3. Section 4 implements the two-stage approach in Barattieri and Cacciatore (2023): first, sector-specific structural shocks are isolated by extracting residuals from panel Fixed Effects (FE) regressions; second, these identified shocks are used in a panel Local Projection (LP) analysis to estimate how employment changes in one sector affect others, distinguishing effects according to both demand- and supply-driven network distances. The empirical results are threefold. Firstly, an increase in the set of intermediate inputs specific to a sector leads to a comparatively smaller rise in its employment with minimal, but alternate, effects from similar changes in more distant sectors. Secondly, sectors closer under factor input supply distance exhibit opposite employment comovement: an increase in employment in nearby sectors tends to reduce employment in the sector; for closely demand-linked sectors, the responses are often ambiguous (increases for some, reductions for others), but mostly pointing to a dampening effect on the positive shock’s transmission. Thirdly, positive comovement emerges among more distantly demand- and supply-related sectors, since sectoral employment rises in response to increases in more distant sectors.

Overall, these findings provide strong empirical support for the main theoretical predictions: horizontal linkages in terms of similar demand and supply relationships across sectors complement and balance the Leontief transmission of sector-specific shocks, thereby revealing the multiple channels through which the vertical and the horizontal structures of sectoral interdependencies shape the distribution and the propagation of economic activity across networked economies.

To conclude, Section 5 examines the policy implications of the network’s horizontal geometry and how incorporating it can improve the design of policy interventions.

Literature.— The objective of this paper is to advance both theoretically and empirically the understanding of how Input-Output economies work. On the theoretical side, it builds on the modern and rapidly expanding literature on production networks. In the wake of Gabaix (2011)’s “granular hypothesis”, the seminal observation of Long and Plosser (1983) – that comovements across sectors are not dictated by a shared disturbance but rather by sectoral interdependencies –, has been modernized through a series of papers of the early 2010s (Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012, Carvalho and Gabaix 2013, Carvalho 2014, Barrot and Sauvagnat 2016). This renewed perspective gave rise to studies on production networks related to efficient economies (e.g., Baqaee and Farhi 2019, vom Lehn and Winberry 2022, Liu and Tsyvinski 2024), monetary policy and nominal rigidities (e.g., La’O and Tahbaz-Salehi 2022, Rubbo 2023, Ghassibe and Nakov 2025), inefficiencies (e.g., Jones 2011, Grassi 2017, Baqaee 2018, Baqaee and Farhi 2020), policy-oriented issues (e.g., Liu 2019, Grassi and Sauvagnat 2019, Lane 2025), endogenous network formation (e.g., Oberfield 2018, Acemoglu and Azar 2020, Ghassibe 2024, Taschereau-Dumouchel 2025), economic growth (e.g., Hausmann and Hidalgo 2011, Gualdi and Mandel 2019, McNerney et al. 2022), and international contexts (e.g., Caliendo et al. 2022, Qiu et al. 2025, Huo et al. 2025). A common mechanism explored in these works emphasizes the vertical propagation of sectoral variations, where shocks originating in

upstream sectors transmit downstream via the Leontief (1936)’s inverse, amplifying their effects and contributing to aggregate outcomes.⁵ My contribution broadens this perspective by introducing horizontal linkages between sectors, defined by their network “economic” distances as measured by common upstream (demand-related) or downstream (supply-related) Input-Output relationships. These linkages forge horizontal complementarities that bind even disconnected sectors, allowing shocks to propagate across the network in ways beyond traditional vertical supply chains.

On the empirical side, relatively few studies examine the role of sectoral production networks on macroeconomic outcomes (*e.g.*, Acemoglu, Akcigit, et al. 2015, Ghassibe 2021, Barattieri and Cacciatore 2023, Barattieri, Cacciatore, and Traum 2023, Monti and Van Keirsbilck 2025). From this standpoint, the paper contributes novel empirical evidence on the role of Input-Output linkages in shaping sectoral dynamics, particularly in explaining the comovement of employment across sectors. Synchronized employment patterns are an important characteristic of business cycles, as most sectors tend to move together over time (Christiano and Fitzgerald 1998). Several studies explore the nature and the sources of this sectoral comovement.⁶ Cooper and Haltiwanger (1990) find that sectoral employment levels are positively correlated, in ways not fully explained by aggregate shocks. Cassou and Vázquez (2014) attribute high employment comovement to similar shock transmission channels. In Yedid-Levi (2016) comovement is stronger along the extensive margin (number of workers) than the intensive margin (hours per worker). Room for structural changes is in Kim (2020), where positive technology shocks in manufacturing raise employment in both manufacturing and services. While these studies provide valuable insights, they do not explicitly address how production networks shape employment comovement. By contrast, my paper focuses on short-run employment variations within a networked framework. Empirically, the paper contributes by (i) advancing the literature on the comprehension of Input-Output linkages and shocks’ transmission via network distances, and (ii) providing novel evidence on sectoral employment comovement from a production network perspective.

1. FOUNDATIONAL THEORY

Preliminaries.— The economy is populated by a finite set of sectors, each labelled as $\{s, s', s'', \dots, S\} \in \Phi(s)$; moreover, denote by Φ_s the set of all sectors not including sector- s . Each of them produces a single good using either labour and a set of circulating intermediate inputs that each sector buys from other sectors. The

⁵ As noted by Shea (2002), a (positive) sectoral shock has a price (decrease in its price level, and reduction in its nominal expenditure for intermediate inputs) and a quantity (its supply to other sectors increase, sector’s production rises, thereby increasing its input demand) effects. These opposing forces affect upstream suppliers but, under Cobb-Douglas production function, they exactly offset each other and leaving intermediate inputs demand unchanged, thereby only affecting downstream suppliers. In general terms, only (final) demand shocks can propagate upstream (*e.g.*, Acemoglu, Akcigit, et al. 2015, Barrot and Sauvagnat 2016, Ferrari 2024).

⁶ Theories beyond employment comovement are in Rogerson (1987) and Boldrin et al. (2001).

whole economic system is thus represented by an $S \times 1$ vector of sectoral outputs, $\mathbf{Y} = [y(s)]$ with general element defined as $y(s) > 0$, an $S \times 1$ vector of sectoral employment levels, $\mathbf{N} = [n(s)]$ with general element defined as $n(s) > 0$, each associated to its output elasticity of labour $\alpha(s)$ in order to deliver $y(s)$, and by an $S \times S$ square matrix, $\mathbf{X} = [x(s, s')]$, indicative of the inter-sectoral trade of intermediate input quantities, with general element given by $x(s, s') \geq 0, \forall s' \in \Phi(s)$. Finally, an $S \times S$ squared matrix, $\mathbf{H} = [\alpha(s, s') \geq 0]$, defines the intensity of the good produced by sector- s' in the total intermediate inputs used by sector- s , with $\alpha(s, s') = 0$ indicating that sector- s does not make use of the good produced by sector- s' in producing its own intermediate good; in addition, denote its Leontief inverse matrix as $\mathbf{H} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{H})^{-1} = [\ell(s, s') \geq 0]$, with $\mathbf{I}$ being an $S \times S$ identity matrix.

Under these specifications, a perfectly competitive final good producer combines outputs from sectors

$$Y = \prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} y(s)^{\beta(s)} \propto \boldsymbol{\beta}' \mathbf{Y}$$

where $\boldsymbol{\beta}$ is a $1 \times S$ vector of $\beta(s) > 0$, a parameter governing the relative importance of each sectoral intermediate good in the definition of aggregate output Y .

A representative firm characterizes each sector, producing its own good, $y(s)$, using either a set of intermediate inputs bought from other sectors, $x(s, s'), \forall s' \in \Phi(s)$, and labour force, $n(s)$. Production function in sector- s is then

$$y(s) = z(s) f^s(n(s), \{x(s, s')\}_{s' \in \Phi(s)})$$

where $z(s)$ is an exogenous Hicks (1932)-neutral sectoral productivity. Under a general perspective, assume the following regularity conditions hold.

ASSUMPTION 1 (Production technology requirements) *As main characteristics of a production function: (i) it has constant returns to scale in either $x(s, s' \in \Phi(s))$ and $n(s)$, so that production inputs shares sum to one, $\alpha(s) + \sum_{s'} \alpha(s, s') = 1$; (ii) it is differentiable, continuous, strictly quasi-concave, homogeneous of degree one, and increasing in $z(s)$, $x(s, s' \in \Phi(s))$, and $n(s)$; (iii) the case $f^s(0, \cdot)$ is ruled out as labour input is essential to production; (iv) at least two elements of $x(s, s' \in \Phi(s))$ has to be positive, thus $f^s(\cdot, 0)$ cannot exist; consequentially, (v) part of the sectoral output is directly produced by the sector, $x(s, s) > 0, \forall s \in \Phi(s)$, that is a production plan with a bundle of intermediate inputs as $f^s(\cdot, x(s, s' \in \Phi_s))$ is precluded.*

The first two sub-assumptions are common in production technology;⁷ the other ones ensure the production function to be consistent with the empirical exploration in Section 4. By way of A1.iii, workers cannot be fully substituted by any combi-

⁷ Constant returns to scale, as well homogeneity of degree one, purely address the technical relation between inputs and output, ruling out any interference of external factors (e.g., relative price changes associated to scalable production, non-homogeneity of degree one due to market dynamics). Continuity and differentiability guarantees well-defined (no “jumps”) and smooth marginal products, while strict quasi-concavity ensures convex technologies and unique optimal input choice.

nation of intermediate inputs (so that sectoral output is finite), and changes in intermediates' quantity will determine subsequent variations in the labour force. The assumptions characterizing the intermediate inputs bundle, *A1.iv* and *A1.v*, ensure the sector not only to participate in the network, but also that part of the production process is roundabout: for sector- s delivering its intermediate good $y(s)$ requires to be at least vertically integrated (buying from one upstream sector), while imposing that a fraction of intermediate inputs must be directly produced within the sector.

Each representative firm is seeking to maximize profits in a perfectly competitive environment, and optimality conditions for both intermediate inputs and demanded labour are then continuous function as $x(s, s') = f_{(s, s')}^s(y(s), p(s), p(s'))$ and $n(s) = f_{(s, s')}^s(y(s), p(s), w(s))$, so that their combination yields

$$x(s, s') = f(\alpha(s, s'), p(s') ; \alpha(s), n(s), w(s)) \quad (1)$$

where $w(s)$ is the sectoral wage rate, chosen as the numeraire. Sector- s 's optimal demand for intermediate inputs of sector- s' is increasing in their inter-sectoral trade intensity, $\alpha(s, s')$, and in labour market variables, $w(s)$ and $n(s)$, while it is decreasing in $\alpha(s)$, and in its purchased intermediates' price, $p(s')$. Effectively, the ratio among factors of production depends on their relative intensity in production, and on their relative price.

Distances.— In a networked economy, comovement of production inputs is endogenously induced: each sector both relies on and supplies to others, so a change in one sector's optimal demand spreads through the network, thus reshaping the relation among factors of production within and between sectors. A rigorous comparison of two sectors can be conducted by examining their relation in the production network, specifically in terms of their trading partnerships with the same set of sectors.

Paraphrasing Conley and Dupor (2003), two types of network “economic” distances between sectors, sketched in Panel 1a of Figure 1, can be defined:

- (a) *factor input demand*, when sectors are *buying* part of their intermediate inputs from similar upstream sectors;
- (b) *factor input supply*, when sectors are *selling* part of their intermediate outputs to similar downstream sectors.

Under this perspective, connections among sectors extend beyond their flows of intermediate inputs. These additional interdependencies highlight the complexity of inter-sectoral dynamics and complement the *Leontief inverse*, a reminiscent result from Leontief (1936): it captures how sectors not directly trading among each others are indirectly related – *e.g.*, a sector buying from an upstream one introjects such sector's purchases as well the other of more upstream sectors –, thus mainly emphasizing the depth of vertical linkages through layers of Input-Output relationships. Network-based economic distances, by contrast, allow to consider how participants are mapped not only vertically, but horizontally as well: sectors can be also closely related because they are relying on the same suppliers or are serving the same cus-

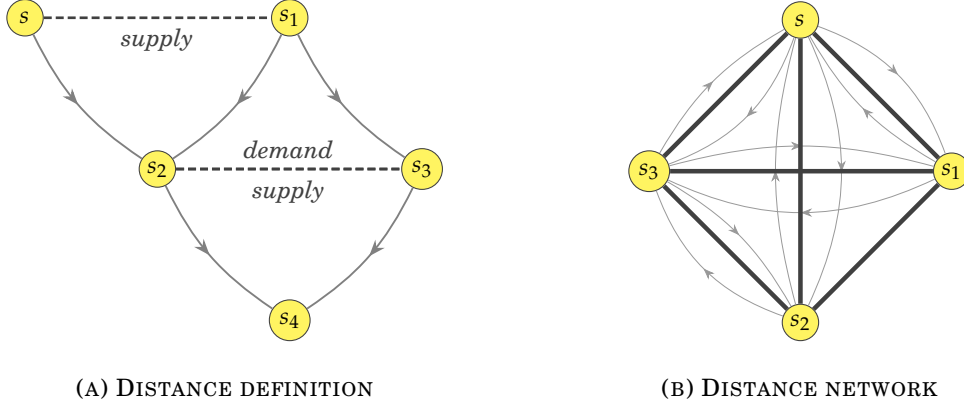


FIGURE 1: HORIZONTAL INPUT-OUTPUT GEOMETRIES

Note: the figure presents a stylized production network and its corresponding network of sectoral distances. Panel 1a illustrates both network distance definitions. Panel 1b highlights the horizontal dimension of the network, where solid thick lines connecting all vertexes indicate the distance relationships between sectors; production network linkages are depicted with oriented thin lines, and represent the inter-sectoral trade flows derived from the Input-Output matrix in Example 1.

tomers. These broader notions of sectoral linkages provide a richer understanding of the structure of production networks and help to explain *horizontal complementarities* in demand and supply that classical Input-Output analysis overlook. They reveal how seemingly unrelated sectors can experience synchronized fluctuations, and how the structure of common upstream or downstream connections shapes the propagation of independent and idiosyncratic shocks. In other words, the notion of sectoral interdependencies is not confined to “who trades with whom”, but also emerges from “who depends on whom”: horizontal complementarities thereby deliver a novel perspective on how sectoral shocks reverberate across a networked economy.⁸

Panel 1b sketches a stylized economy associated to its distance-based network: distances effectively double Input-Output linkages and bound disconnected sectors.

EXAMPLE 1 (Distance in the network) Consider an economy populated by four sectors, $\{s, s_1, s_2, s_3\} \in \Phi(s)$, where some trade with all others, while some do not. The resulting production network of Panel 1b displays an Input-Output matrix, H , where some cells equal zero. Focus on the pair $\{s_1, s_2\}$: they trade with all other sectors but not with each other, so $\alpha(s_1, s_2) = 0 = \alpha(s_2, s_1)$. Nevertheless, their linkages with the remaining sectors generate a common structure of inter-sectoral trade. An Input-Output architecture induces a unique geometry of sectoral distances (both in demand and supply), as depicted in Panel 1b. Yet, while the underlying trade and distance structures are unique, the horizontal metrics between sectors vary under alternative specifications of network distance, as Examples 2-3 clarify.

⁸ This conceptual distinction is further developed in the discussion of Figure 3: the drawn networks clarify how these forms of “economic proximity” can influence the transmission of asymmetric shocks and the synchronization of sectoral dynamics, despite having no direct transactional relationship between sectors.

1.1. STYLIZED ECONOMIES AND HORIZONTAL GEOMETRY

Before turning to technicalities, I illustrate the economic relevance of the network’s horizontal geometry through a set of highly stylized production structures, sketched in Figure 2. I consider three benchmark configurations: (i) *sequential economies*, where transmission occurs purely along a vertical chain (sector-by-sector towards the final consumer) or, alternatively, purely horizontally (distinct sectors supplying only the final consumer); (ii) *rhomboid economies*, where sectors depend on a common upstream supplier while simultaneously selling to the final consumer; and (iii) *star economies*, with all sectors mutually connected while serving the final consumer.

Sequential economies.— Consider the “snake” in the left graph of Figure 2a. Connections are purely vertical, and asymmetric shocks propagate sequentially along the supply chain, with no scope for horizontal interdependencies. By contrast, in the “spider” on the right graph, sectors sell directly to the final consumer without trading among themselves. This represents a purely horizontal structure, characteristic of standard multi-sector models with no inter-sectoral trade. Supply-based horizontal complementarities are central: even without explicit trade linkages, sectors are tied together through their shared exposure to final demand. A shock to one sector reshapes consumers’ expenditure across all others, propagating horizontally through final demand reallocation and generating comovement *absent any network structure*.

Rhomboid economies.— A simple network in Figure 2b combines both sequential economies into a unique structure. This configuration blends vertical and horizontal propagation, as shocks travel vertically (via sector-specific supply chain) and horizontally across sectors simultaneously exposed to common supplier and final demand. Rhomboid economies thus epitomize horizontal complementarities, as even sectors not directly trading with each other become tightly synchronized through their shared dependence on upstream and downstream markets.⁹

Star economies.— Figure 2c classifies three archetypes. In fully symmetric star networks, where all sectors buy and sell with identical intensity, network distances collapse to zero: propagation is only vertical, but the network structure becomes irrelevant as sectoral shocks average out (e.g., Lucas 1977, Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012). In partially symmetric star networks, trade intensities in buying and selling are equal but sector-specific; vertical and horizontal dimensions coexist, though the two distance measures coincide. Finally, under asymmetric star networks (i.e., different trade intensities across sectors) generate parallel vertical and horizontal transmission channels, with amplification and comovement emerging endogenously from network distances: horizontal complementarities in production and shared exposure to final demand weave a dense web of horizontal interdependencies, and sectors with

⁹ The rhomboid structure closely mirrors the configuration underlying the “Keynesian transmission mechanism” (e.g., Guerrieri et al. 2022; see more in Section 5). The horizontal geometry offers a tractable stylization of this logic, as it formalizes how distance-based complementarities in production and final consumption create systemic interdependencies. In doing so, it transforms the Keynesian transmission – traditionally modelled as sectoral spillovers – into a “structural network propagation mechanism”, where amplification and comovement emerge endogenously from the economy’s geometric horizontal interconnections.

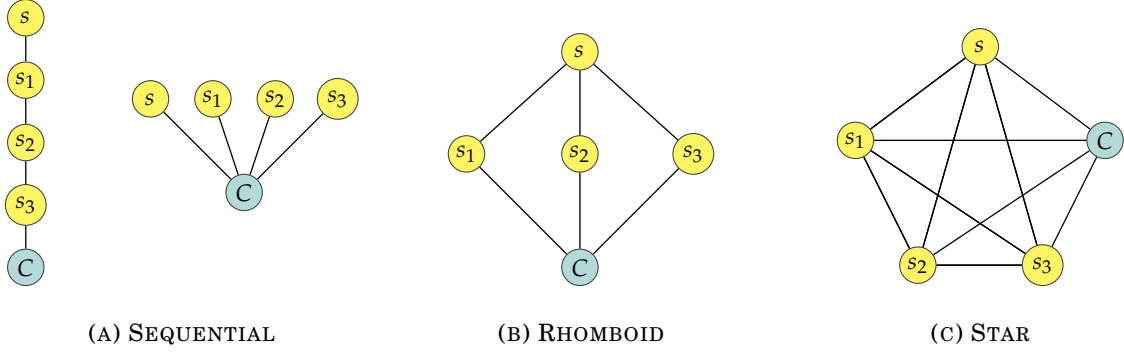


FIGURE 2: BENCHMARK ECONOMIES

Note: the figure illustrates three benchmark economic systems used to highlight the role of horizontal geometry in Input-Output propagation of idiosyncratic shocks. Sectors are in yellow, while the teal circles with C represent the final consumer.

differing upstream and downstream connections experience unrelated effects.

These illustrative examples represent simplified and extreme cases. Yet, horizontal propagation remains a central feature of how shocks diffuse through production systems. In more realistic, highly interconnected systems, the boundaries between these benchmark economies blur: vertical supply chains coexist with horizontal interdependencies through shared buyers and suppliers, and sectors participate simultaneously in multiple propagation layers. Depending on the complex configuration of the network, the horizontal geometry is concentrated more upstream or downstream, with strong implications for idiosyncratic shocks' propagation. Nevertheless, as inter-sectoral linkages densify and the network expands, horizontal complementarities become increasingly important (with more sectors sharing common suppliers and buyers, interdependencies multiply), amplifying the complexity of shock transmission far beyond what purely vertical Input-Output structures would predict.

1.2. RECOVERING DEMAND AND SUPPLY DISTANCE MATRICES

Consider the case in which two sectors, say $\{s, s'\}$, are buying part of their own intermediate inputs from the same sector, say s^* . In this scenario, by substituting out the combined optimality conditions in eq. (1) for such sectors purchasing from the same upstream sector, then one obtains, after total *log*-differentiation, that

$$d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s^*)}{\alpha(s', s^*)} d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s) \quad (2)$$

Given $\gamma_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{B}} = \frac{1}{\log \bar{x}(\cdot, s^*)}$ and $\delta_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{B}} = \frac{\log \bar{n}(\cdot)}{\log \bar{x}^2(\cdot, s^*)}$ being steady-state basis for production inputs, the differential elements $d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s) = \gamma_s^{\mathcal{B}} d \log n(s) - \delta_s^{\mathcal{B}} d \log x(s, s^*)$ and $d_{s^* \rightarrow} \log \mathcal{B}(s') = \gamma_{s'}^{\mathcal{B}} d \log n(s') - \delta_{s'}^{\mathcal{B}} d \log x(s', s^*)$ identify the *log*-difference of employment levels and intermediate inputs in the two sectors buying from the same sector. Subscript “ $s^* \rightarrow$ ” reads as “purchasing from sector- s^* ” by sectors in brackets.

Suppose a shock occurs in sector- s , altering the composition of its production inputs. Propagating vertically along the supply chain, the shock modifies the optimal

input supply of sector- s^* , thereby influencing its trade with sector- s' since both are connected as well. As from the equation, any induced variation in the composition of production inputs within a given sector is horizontally transmitted to another sector in proportion to their relative Input-Output trade intensity with the common upstream sector to which an idiosyncratic shock, originated elsewhere, is transmitted.

Iteratively, the above condition can be rewritten accounting for all sectors to which the pair is buying from:

$$\mathcal{F}[s, s'] = \left(\frac{\alpha(s, s)}{\alpha(s', s)}, \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\alpha(s', s')}, \frac{\alpha(s, s'')}{\alpha(s', s'')}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s, S)}{\alpha(s', S)} \right) = \mathcal{D}^{fd}[s, s']$$

where, given $\mathcal{F}[s, s'] = d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s') / d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s)$, the indicator $\mathcal{F}[s, s']$ is a $1 \times S$ vector of changes in the ratio of any difference in production inputs within the pair of sectors, and $\mathcal{D}^{fd}[s, s']$ is the associated $1 \times S$ vector of their relative intermediate usage intensity when sectors $\{s, s'\}$ are buying from each of the other sectors in the economy, yielding a unique value, $d^{fd}[s, s']$. Stacking such condition across all sectors, then the following Lemma holds.

LEMMA 1 (Factor input demand) *Changes in the ratio of production inputs' quantities across any pair of sectors buying from the same sector(s) is driven by their ratio of intermediate intensities with whom the pair is purchasing from: $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{D}^{fd}$.*

Proof in Appendix A.1.

In other words, the comovement of inputs of production for a pair of sectors is determined by their distance in the production network. In fact, in Lemma 1, each cell of the $S \times S$ matrix $\mathcal{F}$ displays the differential variation across factors of production between the row-sector and the column-sector, while matrix $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ is given by

$$\mathcal{D}^{fd}_{S \times S} = \begin{bmatrix} \left(\frac{\alpha(s, s)}{\alpha(s, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s, S)}{\alpha(s, S)} \right) & \left(\frac{\alpha(s, s)}{\alpha(s', s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s, S)}{\alpha(s', S)} \right) & \dots & \left(\frac{\alpha(s, s)}{\alpha(S, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s, S)}{\alpha(S, S)} \right) \\ \left(\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s', S)}{\alpha(s, S)} \right) & \left(\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s', s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s', S)}{\alpha(s', S)} \right) & \dots & \left(\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(S, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(s', S)}{\alpha(S, S)} \right) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \left(\frac{\alpha(S, s)}{\alpha(s, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(S, S)}{\alpha(s, S)} \right) & \left(\frac{\alpha(S, s)}{\alpha(s', s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(S, S)}{\alpha(s', S)} \right) & \dots & \left(\frac{\alpha(S, s)}{\alpha(S, s)}, \dots, \frac{\alpha(S, S)}{\alpha(S, S)} \right) \end{bmatrix}$$

The greater the value of each cell in the matrix, the closer the considered sectors are within the production network (the stronger is the vertical effect, the stronger will be the horizontal transmission).¹⁰ This concept of “network proximity” will be foundational in the model of Section 2, where distance relationships are further explored. In the empirics, the interpretation of each cell is inverted: as discussed in Section 3, the entries of matrix $\mathcal{D}^j$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, represent a “network distance”

¹⁰ A lower trade intensity ratio in eq. (2) implies that a shock to the common sector- s^* transmits mildly to sector- s . For $\alpha(s, s^*) < \alpha(s', s^*)$, the resulting change in its relative quantities, $d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s)$, then affects that of sector- s' , $d \log \mathcal{B}_{s^* \rightarrow}(s')$, less than proportionally, signaling low horizontal complementarity (and sector- s' is hit relatively more by sector- s^* vertically than by sector- s horizontally). Conversely, if $\alpha(s, s^*) > \alpha(s', s^*)$, then $d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s, s'] > 1$, resulting in a more-than-proportional effect and high horizontal complementarity. Moreover, the higher the number of common linkages, the more sectors are closer. The same logic applies to eq. (3).

(how many steps are necessary for a sector to reach another one), so that larger values denote how dissimilar sectors are in terms of shared (upstream or downstream) Input-Output structure. Henceforth, each $\mathcal{D}^j$ matrix is reflecting the proper “economic” distance between sectors within the production network, whose characterizing element, $d^j[s, s'] > 0, \forall s, s' \in \Phi(s)$, is symmetric outside the main diagonal (the network economic distance from s to s' is the same as from s' to s), and $\text{diag}(\mathcal{D}^j) = 0$.

EXAMPLE 2 (Factor input demand metrics) Consider the pair of sectors $\{s_1, s_2\}$ in an Input-Output matrix mirroring Example 1, where the common sectors from which both are purchasing are $\{s, s_3\}$, and assume fictional trade intensities for sector- s_1 to be $\alpha(s_1, s) = 0.2$ and $\alpha(s_1, s_3) = 0.1$, while that of sector- s_2 are $\alpha(s_2, s) = 0.1$ and $\alpha(s_2, s_3) = 0.2$. Accordingly, the metrics expressing their factor input demand distance relation is composed of $\mathbf{d}^{fd}[s_1, s_2] = (.2, .1), (.1, .2)$ when buying from sector- s and sector- s_3 , respectively. Demand-based distance value is positive even in the absence of direct trade linkage between considered sectors in the pair.

Consider now the case in which two sectors, say $\{s, s'\}$, are selling a part of their own intermediate good as intermediate input to the same sector, say s^* . In this scenario, by substituting out the combined optimality conditions in eq. (1) for such sectors trading to the same downstream sector, total log-differentiation leads to

$$d \log \mathcal{Q}_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \frac{\alpha(s^*, s)}{\alpha(s^*, s')} d \log \mathcal{P}_{\rightarrow s^*}[s', s] \quad (3)$$

Given $\gamma_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{Q}} = \frac{1}{\log \bar{x}(s^*, \cdot)}$, $\delta_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{Q}} = \frac{\log \bar{x}(s^*, \cdot)}{\log \bar{x}^2(s^*, \cdot)}$, $\gamma_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{P}} = \frac{1}{\log \bar{p}(\cdot)}$ and $\delta_{(\cdot)}^{\mathcal{P}} = \frac{\log \bar{p}(\cdot)}{\log \bar{p}^2(\cdot)}$ being steady-state components for intermediate inputs and their associated price levels, then differential elements $d \log \mathcal{Q}_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \gamma_{s'}^{\mathcal{Q}} d \log x(s^*, s) - \delta_{s'}^{\mathcal{Q}} d \log x(s^*, s')$ and $d \log \mathcal{P}_{\rightarrow s^*}[s', s] = \gamma_s^{\mathcal{P}} d \log p(s') - \delta_s^{\mathcal{P}} d \log p(s)$ identify the log-difference of intermediate inputs and price levels between both sectors selling to the same downstream sector. Subscript “ $\rightarrow s^*$ ” reads as “selling to sector- s^* ” by sectors in brackets.

Suppose a shock occurs in sector- s' , altering the composition of its production inputs, and thus its optimal price. Still, when propagating vertically along the supply chain, the shock modifies the optimal input demand of sector- s^* , and thereby its trade with sector- s , as well connected. As from the equation, any induced variation in the relative price, by altering the relative quantity of its circulating intermediate inputs, is horizontally transmitted to another sector in proportion to their relative Input-Output trade intensity with the common downstream sector to which an idiosyncratic shock, originated elsewhere, is transmitted.

Following the previous logic scheme, then the following Lemma must hold.

LEMMA 2 (Factor input supply) Changes in the ratio of intermediate input profits across any pair of sectors selling to the same sector(s) is driven by their ratio of intermediate intensities with whom the pair is purchasing from: $\mathcal{R} = \mathcal{D}^{fs}$.

Proof in Appendix A.1.

In other words, the comovement across (marginal) revenues of production for a

pair of sectors is determined by their distance in the production network. When sectors are selling to the same downstream sector, the change in the revenues of sector- s – i.e., $p(s) x(s^*, s)$ – given a change in those of any sector- s' – i.e., $p(s') x(s^*, s')$ – is scaled by the ratio of their intermediate input intensities.

EXAMPLE 3 (Factor input supply metrics) Consider the pair of sectors $\{s_1, s_2\}$ in an Input-Output matrix mirroring Example 1, where the common sectors to which both are selling are $\{s, s_3\}$, and assume fictional trade intensities for sector- s_1 to be $\alpha(s, s_1) = 0.4$ and $\alpha(s_3, s_1) = 0.3$, while that of sector- s_2 are $\alpha(s, s_2) = 0.6$ and $\alpha(s_3, s_2) = 0.6$. Accordingly, the metrics expressing their factor input demand distance relations is composed of $\mathbf{d}^{fs}[s_1, s_2] = (.4, .3), (.6, .6)$ when selling to sector- s and sector- s_3 , respectively. Supply-based distance value is positive even in the absence of direct trade linkage between considered sectors in the pair.

1.3. SUFFICIENT STATISTICS FOR DISTANCE-LEAD COMOVEMENT

A shadowed implication of the framework developed so far is that intermediate inputs generally function as substitutes, allowing sectors to freely adjust their input mix in response to shocks. However, the horizontal geometry of a network can embed two aspects: (i) vertical propagation through the supply chain may remain the dominant channel, and what may appear as a horizontal transmission can in fact be the by-product of vertical propagation; and (ii) intermediate inputs complementarity in production may alter the transmission of shocks. This tension between horizontal complementarities at the network level and substitutability at the input level sets the stage for a more precise characterization of how sectoral comovement occurs.

In the context of factor input supply, alleviating the tension is straightforward since sectors' competition for common downstream buyers yields a more direct and unambiguous form of horizontal interdependence. Conversely, the dual transmission in factor input demand makes the direction and the strength of induced comovement subtle, emerging the need for sufficient-statistic conditions that systematically identify when positive or negative comovement arises under input substitutability.

The structure of upstream connections, in fact, renders demand-based linkages ambiguous to interpret. Alongside to the overlap of vertical and horizontal transmission,¹¹ pivotal is the way in which upstream sector's price pass-through translates shocks into input reallocation across sectors, potentially inducing negative comovement (substitute away from more expensive suppliers) even when vertical links suggest positive propagation. Considering a *single-input* case (purchasing intermediate inputs from only one upstream supplier, with no substitution possibilities), and an extended *multiple-input* case (allowing substitutability as sectors source from multiple suppliers), and assuming a Constant Elasticity of Substitution (CES) among intermediate inputs, I provide the following sufficient statistics.

¹¹ A shock in sector- s that expands its demand for intermediate inputs alters the input supply composition of sector- s^* ; subsequent adjustments in s^* then spill over to sector- s' ; and the subsequent reactions of s' may again feed back into s^* , thereby completing a cycle of vertical propagation across the interconnected sectors.

PROPOSITION 1 (Sufficient statistics for demand-driven comovement) *In the single-input case, the sufficient statistic for negative comovement in demand implies $\delta_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} \propto -\sigma \tau^{fd}$, with the response largely determined by the upstream pass-through τ^{fd} . In the multi-input CES case, the sufficient statistics augments to*

$$\delta_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} \propto -\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \tau^{fd}$$

with relative intermediate inputs changes from common supplier, $\delta_{s^ \rightarrow [s, s']} = \frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)}$, jointly determined by substitution elasticity, downstream sectoral expenditure share, and upstream pass-through. Negative comovement occurs if $\tau^{fd} > 0$.*

Proof in Appendix B.1.

Negative comovement between downstream sectors arises through upstream adjustments in supply. Intuitively, when s' experiences a positive demand shock, it might bid up the price of inputs from the common supplier- s^* , $\tau^{fd} = \frac{\partial \log p(s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)} > 0$. If this higher input cost makes production more expensive for s , its demand for s^* falls, generating negative comovement. Whether this happens hinges on the degree of complementarity between s^* 's input and the others purchased by s : when $\sigma > 0$, any price increase in s^* alters s 's input mix; in the limit $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$, inputs become perfect substitutes and s fully shifts away from s^* . In the general *multi-input CES* case, the effect is further scaled by sector- s 's expenditure share on s^* , $e(s, s^*)$, so that sectors more reliant on s^* are strongly affected. Thus, demand-driven negative comovement reflects not automatic crowding-out, but the interplay of upstream price pass-through (from vertical propagation), and downstream demand adjustments (indirectly generated by horizontal complementarities).

Considering instead supply-based distances, since shocks to a supplier directly affect its relative price against competitors for common downstream buyers, the induced reallocation of demand across suppliers creates a clear channel for comovement, with horizontal and vertical effects occurring in parallel.

PROPOSITION 2 (Sufficient statistics for supply-driven comovement) *In the single-input case, no sufficient statistic exists for negative comovement in supply due to the absence of competition for downstream markets. Differently, in the multi-input CES case, the sufficient statistic is given by*

$$\delta_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s'] \propto \sigma e(s^*, s') \tau^{fs}$$

with relative intermediate inputs changes to common buyer, $\delta_{\rightarrow s^} [s, s'] = \frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')}$, jointly determined by substitution elasticity, sectoral revenues for upstream supplier, and downstream pass-through. Negative comovement occurs if $\tau^{fs} < 0$.*

Proof in Appendix B.2.

Negative comovement between upstream suppliers mechanically arises from competition for downstream buyers. Intuitively, when s' receives a positive supply shock, it can lower its relative price and capture a larger share of s^* 's demand from the upstream price pass-through $\tau^{fs} = \frac{\partial \log p(s')}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')} < 0$ from competing suppliers. This

revenue reallocation necessarily comes at the expense of competing supplier- s , generating negative comovement. The magnitude depends on two forces: the elasticity of substitution σ across sector- s^* 's inputs controls how easily s^* reallocates spending, while the expenditure share $e(s^*, s')$ scales the importance of s' for sector- s^* .

Discussion.— A networked economy inherently embeds complementarities in intermediate inputs, as sectors depend on overlapping sets of buyers and suppliers. In the demand-distance case, negative comovement between sectors is often ambiguous: it reflects a combination of vertical propagation along the supply chain and horizontal complementarities arising from shared upstream suppliers, making it difficult to disentangle the two overshadowed channels. In the supply-distance case, negative comovement emerges when multiple upstream suppliers compete for the same downstream sectors, and horizontal transmission directly arises from the reallocation of inputs in response to adjustments in relative prices: co-movement is transparent, and the mechanism governing the interaction between vertical and horizontal dimension is mechanically determined.¹²

Importantly, the discrepancy between the ambiguous effects in demand and the clear responses in supply is in accordance with non-linear network theories (e.g., Atalay 2017, Baqaee and Farhi 2019), where downstream complementarities – and hence complementarities between *purchased* intermediate inputs – matter the most. In my framework, this dimension is embodied by supply-based distances, which create horizontal interdependencies among sectors *selling* to the same buyers. Delving into the downstream pass-through effect, when one supplier experiences a positive shock, downstream complementarities of common buyers cause other suppliers to adjust their production in response, and the propagation operates directly through the interdependence of upstream inputs used together in downstream production. Such amplification is largely absent under demand-based distances: the rationale beyond the upstream pass-through effect merely captures how easily a downstream buyer can substitute away from its upstream sellers, without generating true horizontal spillovers among buyers themselves.¹³ In other words, supply-based distances generate genuine horizontal complementarities among sectors whose productions are complementary in downstream buyers, whereas demand-driven horizontal complementarities reflect only substitution patterns across common upstream suppliers.

1.4. AN INSPECTION INTO THE HORIZONTAL TRANSMISSION

An important aspect to consider when introducing distances in the production network is that, under the same configuration of the inter-sectoral trade structure, sec-

¹² These results are consistent with Baqaee and Farhi (2019), who develop a “global” non-linear theory where complementarities can amplify or reverse the impact of idiosyncratic shocks. While their framework emphasizes non-linear amplification, mine linearizes these non-linearities into a tractable reduced form: network “economic” distances naturally capture how vertical and horizontal interdependencies interact so that they summarize the same complementarity forces that drive non-linear dynamics.

¹³ Indeed, considering complementarities between goods from an upstream (common) supplier and those of other horizontally related buyers would mechanically yield a supply-based network distance.

tors can be in a different “network economic distance relation” depending on whether they are buying from or selling to other sectors, with all sectors being simultaneously connected by network distances, that is, by horizontal complementarities in comovement of production factors stemming from common demand and supply linkages.

THEOREM 1 (On the configuration of network “economic” distances) *Let the set of sectors being $\Phi(s)$, and $\alpha^j(\cdot)$, for $j = \{fd, fs, \}$, the normalized Input-Output coefficients. Then, demand- and supply-based distance matrices satisfy: (i) for any $s, s' \in \Phi(s)$ there exists a common neighbour- s^* , so that both $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$ are non-negative and full; (ii) a given Input-Output structure uniquely determines $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$, which differ entrywise unless the corresponding bilateral trade with the common neighbour coincides; and (iii) if $\alpha^j(\cdot)$ ’s are non-symmetric, then all entries of $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$ differ; conversely, if $S \geq 4$, then both share at least one identical entry whenever at least $S - 2$ sectors trade symmetrically with a common sector and at least one additional symmetric trade relation elsewhere in the network exists.*

Proof in Appendix A.1.

The first two clearly emerge in Examples 2-3 and Figure 1. The final property clarifies when the distance between two sectors is uniquely determined: if two sectors buy and sell the same relative quantity of intermediate inputs with a common third sector, then their factor input demand and factor input supply distances coincide. Their actual quantities may differ; what matters is that, for each sector individually, its purchases or sales with the common sector match in relative terms.¹⁴

COROLLARY 1 (Coinciding distances) *For $S \geq 4$, if a common sector trades symmetrically with $m = S - 2$ others, then $\frac{m(m-1)}{2}$ sectors exhibit identical distances.*

Outlined horizontal dimension raises some implications in the transmission of idiosyncratic sectoral shocks to other sectors: the magnitude of the propagation not only depends on the size of the (direct and indirect) connection among sectors, but also by their network distance. For instance, as shown in Figure 3, a shock originating in a particular sector propagates vertically in downstream sectors along different chains while, at the same time, transmitting horizontally to sectors which are characterized by such existing production network linkage – even across any pair of sectors potentially neither directly nor indirectly related – due to the simultaneous presence of demand and/or supply linkages with their common sector.¹⁵

¹⁴ A “normalized” network refers to a matrix once each row or column has been scaled so that the entries express relative rather than absolute quantities, required to build $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$; refer to Appendix C.

¹⁵ The example is presented as the more intuitive and visually transparent case of a supply-side sectoral shock propagating downstream through the production network, affecting sectors that depend on the output of the initially shocked sector. Yet, the same underlying logic of network “economic” distances applies also in the case of a demand-side shock, where the direction of a transmission is reversed, with the sectoral shock propagating upstream as sectors increase demand for intermediate inputs from their suppliers. Finally, even if not graphically shown, in the presence of an already-existing Input-Output linkage between distanced sectors, the transmission of the initial shock is progressively amplified.

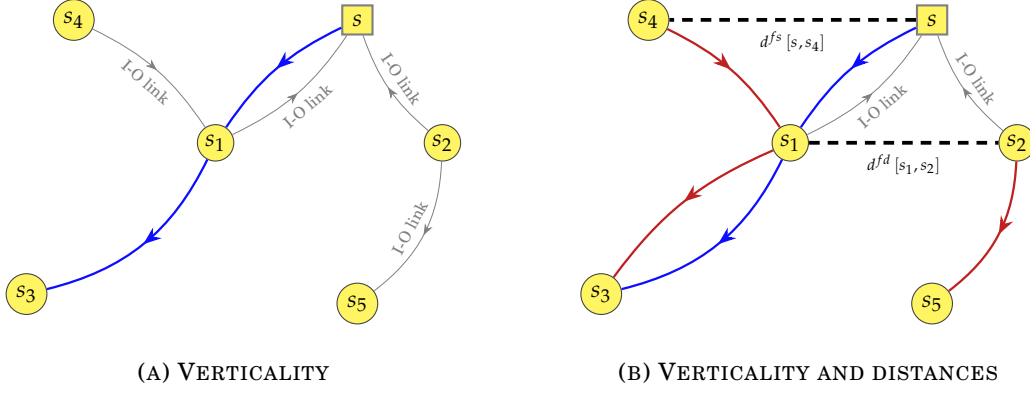


FIGURE 3: HORIZONTALITY OF A TRANSMISSION

Note: stylized example of how a sectoral shock propagates across a production network. Coloured and oriented bold-curves trace the propagation mechanism: vertical transmission is in blue, while additional transmission paths from the horizontal geometry are in red. Oriented thin-grey curves indicate further existing Input-Output (I-O) connections, and network economic distances through common nodes are represented by dashed lines. The underlying network structure is identical in both panels. Panel 3a shows a purely vertical propagation of a shock to sector- s , following standard sectoral supply-chain logics. In contrast, Panel 3b depicts a richer mechanism, where the shock also spreads horizontally through sectors sharing common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers: in this case, even sectors not directly connected through the network, or along the sector- s supply chain, are affected by shared demand or supply relationships.

EXAMPLE 4 (Propagating behaviour under horizontal distances) Consider an economy populated by six sectors, $\{s, s_1, s_2, s_3, s_4, s_5\} \in \Phi(s)$, where some trade with all the others, while some others do not: s_1 is buying from $\{s, s_4\}$ while selling to $\{s, s_3\}$; s_2 trades to $\{s, s_5\}$. Suppose a supply shock to sector- s originates. In Panel 3a, the shock propagates downstream: it directly affects s_1 and indirectly (i.e., Leontief effect) reaches s_3 , yielding a purely vertical transmission, with others unaffected (in linear economies, changes in s_1 do not vertically feed back into s ; see Footnote 5). Unknown remain the potential effects of induced adjustments in s_1 , even though it shares demand and supply trade linkages with others. By contrast, Panel 3b illustrates both vertical and horizontal propagation: a shock to s not only affects its immediate trading connections but also alters its interaction with s_4 : changes in s_1 triggered by the initial shock generate an horizontal effect that links $\{s, s_4\}$ through their common supply-based connection with s_1 . Subsequent adjustments in s_4 then feed back into s_1 , compounding the Leontief propagation towards s_3 ; total effect is thus not unique, but multiple. With due demand-distance adjustments, analogous is the logic underlying $d^{fd}_{[s_1, s_2]}$: the horizontal transmission between $\{s_1, s_2\}$, simultaneously selling to s , is generated. Reverberating the initial shock on s , via s_1 , to s_2 , it additionally generates a vertical effect further downstream, from s_2 to s_5 . All things considered, this extra “horizontal” geometry reinforces or mitigates the strength of vertical propagation, with horizontal complementarities depending on the nature of the demand/supply relationships each sector has with the shocked sector and related ones.

Example 4 illustrates the central message of the paper: incorporating factor input demand and factor input supply network economic distances, and thereby horizontal complementarities between sectors in the production network, fundamentally reshapes the vertical transmission of micro-level shocks canonically occurring

through the Leontief inverse mechanism. The new propagation stems from demand- or supply-driven trade relationships between sectors sharing a similar Input-Output structure (*i.e.*, common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers), and this paper is mostly on the conceptualisation of the $d[\cdot]$ -types of linkages. In a fully-networked economy, the horizontal nexus between already-connected nodes plays a prominent role, as it is uncommon for sectors to be entirely isolated from one another.^{16,17} Stated differently, network distance complementarities that emerge along this horizontal dimension alter the traditional vertical transmission by either compounding or mitigating the effect of a micro-originated shock to the common (demand- or supply-related) sectors, with sizeable magnitude the denser is the network.

Ultimately, along the vertical propagation of sectoral shocks, it is the horizontal geometry of the network structure that leads to positive or negative comovement of economic variables when intermediate inputs are circulating between sectors.

2. A NETWORK MODEL WITH DISTANCES

Once having rationalized network distances in the sense of horizontal demand and supply linkages across sectors in partial equilibrium, I now build a framework to analyse their general equilibrium properties in a static Input-Output economy. The model builds on the seminal contributions by Long and Plosser (1983) and Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. (2012), characterized by a Real Business Cycle (RBC) set-up with an exogenous sector-to-sector production network structure. Given a fairly standard households side, I am going to introduce *factor input demand* and *factor input supply* network-based economic distances, as determined by Lemmas 1 and 2, upon the equilibrium conditions of the model. Then, I turn to analytically characterize how sectoral variations in production input quantities propagate along inter-sectoral linkages. In Subsection 2.1 I explore the effect of changes both in intermediate inputs and other sectors' employment levels on sector-specific employment. I include the notion of network distances to analyse their role in propagating variations in employment levels of nearby and further sectors on sectoral employment; these considerations are discussed in Subsection 2.2. Subsection 2.3 discusses the relation between the vertical and the horizontal network's dimensions (Theorem 2), and present the model's implications for aggregate fluctuations.

Within a unit mass, household- $i \in \mathcal{I}$ is getting utility from consumption of all sectoral goods and dis-utility from working in a given sector

¹⁶ Mitigated isolation might be the prevalent in highly granular production networks. On the complexity of the North-American sectoral production network refer to Slater (1977), Slater (1978), Xu et al. (2011), Choi and Foerster (2017), Fed (2019), and Mungo et al. (2023).

¹⁷ Since horizontal complementarities establish linkages even between otherwise unconnected nodes, the concept of network economic distances is of particular significance for firm-to-firm networks, typically characterised by considerable granularity and high levels of sparsity; their complexity is depicted in Atalay et al. (2011), Pichler et al. (2023), and Bacilieri et al. (2025).

$$\mathcal{U}_i \left(\{c_i(s)\}_{s \in \Phi(s)}, n_i(s) \right) := \prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} c_i(s)^{\beta(s)} - \frac{n_i(s)^{1+\phi}}{1+\phi}$$

where $\beta(s)$ identifies the weight of each sectoral good in household i 's consumption basket and $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \beta(s) = 1$, while the assumption on the inverse Frisch labour supply elasticity, measuring the elasticity of hours worked to the wage rate under a constant marginal utility of income, $\phi \rightarrow \infty$, rules out indivisible labour (Rogerson 1988), as Section 4 examines sectoral employment rather than hours (e.g., Yedid-Levi 2016). Individual sectoral consumption and labour supplied are labelled as $c_i(s)$ and $n_i(s)$, respectively, and each is characterized by a price, $p(s)$ and $w(s)$. Utility maximization, subject to the intra-temporal budget constraint $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} p(s) c_i(s) = w(s) n_i(s) + \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} D_i(s)$, with component $D_i(s)$ being the constant share of sector-specific profits rebated to household- i , reports standard conditions for consumption and labour choices $\frac{p(s) c(s)}{p(s') c(s')} = \frac{\beta(s)}{\beta(s')}$ and $w(s) = n(s)^\phi \frac{c(s)}{\beta(s) C} p(s)$, already aggregated across households. The first condition defines how the total expenditure from households for sectoral goods gives rise to the relative importance of each good in total consumption, C . This is an aggregator over sectoral consumption levels:

$$C = f^c \left(c(s), c(s'), c(s''), \dots, c(S) ; \{\beta(s)\}_{s=1}^S \right)$$

ASSUMPTION 2 (Final consumption requirements) *As main characteristics of a final consumption aggregator: (i) it is strictly quasi-concave, non-decreasing and homogeneous of degree one in each of the sectoral consumption levels; (ii) consumption goods are normal, so that their demand increases with households' income; and (iii) the weight of sectoral goods in total consumption is driven by $\beta(s)$, which is the relative weight that households give in the consumption of the good produced by sector- s .*

Moreover, denote by $\mathbf{C} = [c(s)]$ the $S \times 1$ vector of consumption levels over sectoral goods, with common element defined as $c(s) > 0$. Under this specification and the regularities in Assumption 2, it holds that $C = \prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} c(s)^{\beta(s)} \propto \boldsymbol{\beta}' \mathbf{C}$, as well equivalent to the condition on the final output at the beginning of Section 1.

The production side of the economy is made of a finite set of sectors, $\{s, s', \dots, S\} \in \Phi(s)$, populated by a representative firm whose output is the result of a Cobb-Douglas technology satisfying Assumption 1:

$$y(s) = z(s) \left(n(s) \right)^{\alpha(s)} \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(x(s, s') \right)^{\alpha(s, s')} \varkappa_j(s) \quad (4)$$

where $\varkappa_j(s)$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, is a normalization constant ruling out double counting of intermediate inputs when considering both factor input demand and supply network distances between sectors;¹⁸ absent any of these two cases, then $\varkappa_d(s) = 1$.

Taking factor inputs prices as given, each sectoral representative firm demands labour to households, $n(s)$, and intermediate inputs from other sectors, $x(s, s')$, $\forall s' \in$

¹⁸ Such constant elements are mathematically defined in Appendix A.3.

$\Phi(s)$, to maximize total revenues from a profit function, $D(s) = p(s)y(s)$, net of total costs, $C(s) = w(s)n(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} p(s')x(s, s')$. Optimal competitive factor demands of sector- s relative to sector- s' are given by $n(s) = \alpha(s) \frac{p(s)y(s)}{w(s)}$ and $x(s, s') = \alpha(s, s') \frac{p(s)y(s)}{p(s')}$. Both optimized quantities decrease the higher is their market price and the lower is its analogous in other connected sector, and their optimal combination for sector- s buying from sector- s' is equal to $x(s, s') = \alpha(s, s') w(s) n(s) \frac{1}{\alpha(s) p(s')}$.

According to the structure of the model, equilibrium conditions read as follows.

(Equilibrium) *A competitive equilibrium for this efficient economy is defined by a set of sectoral prices for labour and intermediate inputs, $\{w(s), p(s)\}_{s \in \Phi(s)}$, a set of sectoral production input quantities, $\{n(s), x(s, s')\}_{s, s' \in \Phi(s)}$, exogenous sectoral productivities, $\{z(s)\}_{s \in \Phi(s)}$, and a set of aggregate quantities, $\Omega = (Y, C, N, X, D)$, such that (i) each household satisfies its optimality conditions, (ii) the representative firm of each sector maximizes profits, and (iii) all markets clear, shaping Ω .*

In addition to the equilibrium definition, rearranging optimality conditions for labour market variables from both households and sectors, the following equilibrium condition for sectoral labour force is detected:

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) y(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}} \quad (5)$$

It defines that employment is a positive function of both output and consumption (recall that total consumption C increases with sector-specific consumption).

Equilibrium adjustments in production networks are central to understand the origins of aggregate business cycles. Within this perspective, an important question emerges: to what extent does employment comovement shape the dynamics of aggregate fluctuations in output? In a similar theoretical set-up vom Lehn and Winberry (2022) show that, in equilibrium, the impact of a given sector-specific shock on real Gross Domestic Product (GDP) – exploiting the *Divisia Index* – can be decomposed into its propagation on aggregate Total Factor Productivity (TFP) and its effect on aggregate employment.¹⁹ In Appendix A.2, following closely the authors, I determine that fluctuations in aggregate real GDP growth are the result of

$$d \log Y = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\lambda(s) d \log z(s) + \nu(s) d \log n(s) \right) \quad (6)$$

where $\lambda(s) = \frac{p(s)y(s)}{p^Y Y}$ is the usual *Domar weight* of sector- s , and $\nu(s) = \frac{p^Y(s)y^Y(s)}{p^Y Y}$ its *value-added Domar weight*, with $p^Y(s)y^Y(s)$ being the sector-specific nominal value-added. These components identify the ratio of the gross nominal and value-added intermediate output of sector- s to GDP, respectively, and both define the im-

¹⁹ Upon impact, capital in their *investment network* is fixed. Moreover, fluctuations in sectoral employment arise from the household's valuation of investment goods (investment weakens the income effect on labour supply) rather than the household's valuation of sectoral intermediate goods.

portance of a given sector to aggregate fluctuations and business cycle dynamics.²⁰

Employment comovement thus constitutes a central phenomenon to investigate under inter-sectoral trade network: the cyclical behaviour of the economy originates from both changes in sectoral TFP, $d \log z(s)$, and in sectoral employment, $d \log n(s)$. Focusing on employment comovement offers distinct advantages. It provides a directly observable measure of sectoral activity, avoiding the interpretability (whether there is shock transmission or shocks correlation; see Huo et al. 2025) and the identification challenges associated with productivity.²¹ At the same time, it allows the analysis to remain general, abstracting from the specific nature of shocks while capturing the general-equilibrium adjustments of labour across the production network. Hence, it is possible to separate the “origins” from the “causes” of business cycles.

Consider, then, an economy subject to a supply- or demand-driven idiosyncratic, independent, and asymmetric sectoral disturbance. Section 1 has theoretically shown how different types of network distance generate differential behaviour in changes in primary factors of production. On the same line, next sections are going to argue, both theoretically and empirically, that not only employment levels are subject to comovement across sectors due to Input-Output linkages, but also that the direction of the comovement among paired sectors depends on their demand (supply) relation with their common upstream supplier (downstream buyer) sectors. As a result, besides vertical transmission, depending on the metric of distance relation among horizontally-connected sectors in the network, the propagation of a sector-specific shock will generate different types of aggregate business cycles.

2.1. FIRST-ORDER PROPAGATION OF PRODUCTION INPUTS

Starting from the response of sectoral employment to its own set of intermediate inputs, substitute the production function of eq. (4) into the labour market equilibrium of eq. (5). In such a way it is possible to express how changes in intermediate inputs usage relate to changes in sector-specific employment levels.

PROPOSITION 3 (Propagation of variations to intermediate inputs) *Consider a market economy characterized by Input-Output linkages as in eq. (4), whose labour market equilibrium is eq. (5). Then, the response of sectoral employment to changes in sectoral intermediate inputs is a first-order (log-linear) approximation given by*

²⁰ Note how eq. (6) does not preserve the Hulten (1978)’s theorem – that, under standard neoclassical assumptions and nearby a steady state, fluctuations in aggregate GDP are an approximated linear combination of sectoral productivity shocks, weighted by each Domar weight (*i.e.*, sector’s total sales – to final demand and intermediate users – relative to aggregate GDP, reflecting its direct and indirect contribution to the economy). Shifting the focus from productivity changes (the “origins”) to directly observable labour adjustments (the “causes”), eq. (6) reveals employment as a key channel through which sectoral linkages translate micro-level shocks into macroeconomic dynamics – in the spirit of the vom Lehn and Winberry (2022)’s analysis.

²¹ Identifying the sources of productivity comovement is challenging since TFP changes residually absorb a wide range of measurement errors, making it difficult to isolate and interpret the precise antecedents of productivity comovement between sectors. In contrast, my work focuses on sectoral employment, a directly observable input. This choice enables a more transparent analysis of cross-sectoral comovement, since employment is not subject to the same identification and interpretability challenges as productivity, facilitating a clearer identification of demand and supply forces operating through the production network.

$$d \log \mathbf{N} = \Theta \left\{ d \log C + \underbrace{d \log \mathbf{z} - d \log \mathbf{C}}_{d \log \mathcal{S}} + \mathbf{H} d \log \mathbf{X} \right\} \quad (7)$$

where:

- (a) $\mathbf{N}$ identifies sectoral employment levels;
- (b) $\Theta = \frac{1}{1+\phi+\alpha}$ is a compound of structural parameters, and $\alpha = [\alpha(s), \dots, \alpha(S)]$;
- (c) C is aggregate consumption;
- (d) $\mathcal{S}$ identifies sector-specific changes in productivity and consumption;
- (e) $\mathbf{H}$ is the Input-Output matrix, comprising sectoral weight on other sectors, influencing the elements of $\mathbf{X}$, a matrix with intermediate inputs purchases.

Proof in Appendix A.3.

Such proposition expresses how any change in consumption, sectoral productivities, and a given intermediate input bought by a sector- s from sector- s' , $\forall s, s' \in \Phi(s)$, impacts sectoral employment, and the magnitude of the variations in the set of intermediate inputs is driven by the intensity in the Input-Output relation between these two sectors, drawn from matrix $\mathbf{H}$. Positive changes in $d \log \mathbf{X}$ work through sectoral output: an expansion in intermediates will determine an expansion in output which, as in eq. (5), will determine an increase in employment level of sector- s .

To account for the role of changes to other sectors' employment on sectoral employment level, notice that when sector- s buys intermediate inputs from sector- s' , it is introjecting also the quantities of production inputs in such sector. Henceforth, each element in the intermediate inputs bundle of sector- s can be taught as $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$, $\forall s' \in \Phi(s)$, which states that each intermediate input is just a given share $\vartheta(s, s')$ of other sector's output. Labour market equilibrium in eq. (5) can be thus rewritten as

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) z(s) \left(n(s) \right)^{\alpha(s)} \prod_{s' \in \Phi_s} \left(\vartheta(s, s') y(s') \right)^{\alpha(s, s')} \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}} \quad (8)$$

so that, once plugging in the output of sector- s' , sectoral employment levels are transparently related through the production network structure. As a result, the above labour market condition allows to study the general equilibrium comovement of employment levels across sectors.

PROPOSITION 4 (Direct propagation of variations to sectoral employment)

Consider an Input-Output economy defined by a labour market equilibrium as stated in eq. (8). Then, the response of sectoral employment to other sectors' employment is a first-order (log-linear) approximation given by

$$d \log \mathbf{N} = \Theta \left\{ d \log C + d \log \mathcal{S} + \underbrace{\mathbf{H}(\Psi_{s, s'}) \left[d \log \mathbf{z} + \alpha d \log \mathbf{N} \right]}_{d \log \mathcal{N}} + \mathcal{E} d \log \mathbf{X} \right\} \quad (9)$$

where:

(a) $\mathbf{N}$ identifies sectoral employment levels;

...

(e) $\mathcal{N}$ identifies the production network effect of other sectors' changes in productivities, employment levels, and intermediate inputs usage, where:

- $\mathbf{H}(\Psi_{s,s'})$ is the Input-Output matrix, comprising the weight of each sector on other sectors, whose entries are set to 0 whenever $s = s'$;
- $\mathcal{E} = \mathbf{H}(\Psi_{s,s'})' \mathbf{H}(\Psi_{s',s})$ is a compounded network effect, made of the inner product of the Input-Output matrix, influencing the elements of $\mathbf{X}$.

Proof in Appendix A.3.

Just like Proposition 3, increases in consumption, productivities and intermediate inputs will have a positive effect on sectoral employment. In addition, Proposition 4 predicts that any increase in labour force of other sectors will positively propagate to employment level of a given sector, and the magnitude of the shock transmission would ultimately depend by the intensity of the inter-sectoral trade. This result is in line with the literature, where the impact of an idiosyncratic shock is determined by the elements of its “influence vector”, whose entries are non-negative (Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012). Therefore, positive shocks will positively transmit to vertically-connected sectors, and the change in aggregate employment is just the linear combination of sectoral-originated shocks. In the next section it is shown how the results of Proposition 4 are dampened when considering factor input demand and factor input supply network distances of Section 1.

2.2. COMOVEMENT AND NETWORK DISTANCES

Once inserting the production function of eq. (4) in the labour market equilibrium condition of eq. (8), then optimal quantities of a sector are related to that of the other ones. To incorporate *factor input demand* distance, in Appendix A.2 I show that manipulation in general equilibrium would result in

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) z(s) n(s)^{\alpha(s)} \mathbf{N}^{fd} \mathbf{\Lambda}^{fd} \mathbf{\Xi}^{fd} \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}} \quad (10)$$

where $\mathbf{N}^{fd} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(\prod_{s \in \Phi(s')} x(s', s)^{\alpha(s', s)} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s, s')}{1+\phi}}$ identifies the set of intermediate inputs bought by sector- s and all the other sectors connected to it, $\mathbf{\Lambda}^{fd} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(\vartheta(s, s') z(s') n(s')^{\alpha(s')} \right)^{\alpha(s, s')}$ captures the relevance of other sectors' productivities and employment levels on sector- s working through the production network, and the component $\mathbf{\Xi}^{fd} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\prod_{s \in \Phi(s')} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s, s')} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s')}} \right]$ determines the ratio among the intermediate inputs between sector- s and each of the other sectors, when these are buying from the same upstream sector. Total *log*-differentiation of eq. (10) while integrating the result in Lemma 1 allows to determine how changes in sectoral em-

ployment levels are related in the production network, both vertically (Input-Output matrix) and horizontally (distance matrix), as the following proposition shows.

PROPOSITION 5 (Direct propagation under factor input demand distance)

Consider an Input-Output economy defined by a labour market equilibrium as stated in eq. (10). Then, the response of sectoral employment to other sectors' employment is a first-order (log-linear) approximation given by

$$d \log \mathbf{N} = \Theta \left\{ d \log \mathbf{C} + d \log \mathbf{S} + d \log \mathbf{N} + \underbrace{\mathcal{D}^{fd} \left[d \log \mathbf{N}(\Phi(s)) - d \log \mathbf{N} \right]}_{d \log \mathcal{D}(n)} \right\} \quad (11)$$

where:

- (a) $\mathbf{N}$ identifies sectoral employment levels;
- ...
- (f) $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ identifies all the demand-based distances across any pair of sectors;
- (g.i) $\mathcal{D}(n)$ identifies the production network distance effect of other sectors' variations in employment levels, $d \log \mathbf{N}(\Phi(s))$, when these are buying their intermediate inputs from the same upstream sector(s).

Proof in Appendix A.3.

Proposition 5 extends Proposition 4 by incorporating the Input-Output network distance between sectors in terms of shared upstream suppliers. Beyond the standard effects from aggregate and sector-specific variations, it formalizes how sectoral employment responds to changes in other sectors through demand-based horizontal linkages. Importantly, vertical and horizontal effects are intertwined: employment changes in other sectors appear simultaneously in $\mathcal{N}$ and $\mathcal{D}(n)$, making it ambiguous whether observed comovement is driven primarily by supply-chain spillovers or by common upstream network linkages.²² When sectors are far apart, positive comovement is guaranteed, as the vertical component $\mathcal{N}$ dominates since horizontal interactions in $\mathcal{D}(n)$ are negligible. Prominent horizontal interdependencies materialize when sectors are close (low demand-distance), and comovement patterns depend on the sufficient-statistic conditions identified in Proposition 1: negative or positive comovement depends on how shocks to one sector affect the price of common suppliers and how easily downstream buyers can substitute between inputs. When complementarity is strong, a positive shock in a horizontally related sector raises the cost of inputs from the shared supplier, potentially dampening sector- s 's input demand and generating negative comovement; when substitutability is high, this effect diminishes. The propagation of employment is thus jointly shaped by vertical supply-chain effects, captured in $\mathcal{N}$, and horizontal demand linkages in $\mathcal{D}(n)$,

²² Component $\mathcal{D}(n)$ captures the additional response due to shared suppliers, and its magnitude is increasing with the proximity in the distance matrix $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$: without specifying an exact scaling, a higher value $d^{fd}(s, s')$ indicates that sectors s and s' are closer, as in Section 1. In the empirics (Sections 3 and 4), distances are used to classify sectors along an extensive margin, with values near zero corresponding to closely related sectors.

producing an overlapping pattern that can obscure the exact source of observed comovement, and yielding nuanced sectoral responses that reflect the joint effect of both channels. Indeed, demand-based distances trace connections through shared upstream suppliers but capture mere substitution patterns (Subsection 1.3): they indicate how easily sectors can reallocate demand across common suppliers but do not generate true horizontal spillovers in production. Such demand-based ambiguity emerges clearly in the empirics of Section 4, but dissipates for peripheral sectors.

Manipulation in general equilibrium to include *factor input supply* distance for pairs of sectors would result in

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) z(s) n(s)^{\alpha(s)} \mathfrak{N}^{fs} \Lambda^{fs} \Xi^{fs} \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}} \quad (12)$$

where $\mathfrak{N}^{fs} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(\prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s', s')^{\alpha(s', s')} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s, s')}{1+\phi}}$ is the compounded set of intermediate inputs, $\Lambda^{fs} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(\vartheta(s, s') z(s') n(s')^{\alpha(s)} \right)^{\alpha(s, s')}$ considers sectoral productivities and employment levels, and $\Xi^{fs} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s', s')} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s', s')}} \right]$ determines the ratio among the intermediate inputs of paired sectors, when these are selling to the same downstream sector. Embedding Lemma 2, the following holds.

PROPOSITION 6 (Direct propagation under factor input supply distance)

Consider an Input-Output economy defined by a labour market equilibrium as stated in eq. (12). Then, the response of sectoral employment to other sectors' employment is a first-order (log-linear) approximation given by

$$d \log N = \Theta \left\{ d \log C + d \log \mathcal{S} + d \log \mathcal{N} + \underbrace{\mathcal{D}^{fs} \left[d \log P(\Phi(s)) - d \log P \right]}_{d \log \mathcal{D}(p)} \right\} \quad (13)$$

where:

- (a) N identifies sectoral employment levels;
- ...
- (f) $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$ identifies all the supply-based distances across any pair of sectors;
- (g.ii) $\mathcal{D}(p)$ identifies the production network distance effect of other sectors' variations in employment levels, $d \log P(\Phi(s))$, when these are selling part of their output to the same downstream sector(s).

Proof in Appendix A.3.

Proposition 6 formalizes how sectoral employment responds to changes in other sectors through supply-based horizontal linkages. The role of network supply distances on sectoral employment comovement works through sectoral output $y(s)$: for instance, an increase in the price level of sector- s' , captured in $P(\Phi(s))$, raises its demand for inputs, reduces its own supply of intermediate inputs, and contracts its production; a decrease in intermediate output then translates into lower employment for

s' while, under analogous but reverse logic, the higher relative price simultaneously increases employment in competing supplier sectors. Vertical and horizontal effects are thus parallel: the vertical component $\mathcal{N}$ captures standard supply-chain propagation through downstream production, while the horizontal component $\mathcal{D}(p)$ captures reallocation effects among sectors supplying to common downstream buyers. For sectors close in the supply network (high $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$), the horizontal mechanism dominates, generating negative comovement between nearby suppliers; for sectors far apart (low $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$), horizontal effects are negligible, and positive comovement emerges via vertical mechanism. Consistently with the sufficient-statistic condition in Proposition 2, the supply-based transmission is more transparent than the demand-based case: it gives rise to direct horizontal propagation effects through common demand, linearly embedding intermediate input complementarities in downstream producers. Overall, Proposition 6 highlights that sectoral shocks propagate both vertically along the supply chain and horizontally through competition for downstream markets, with negative comovement being stronger among nearby suppliers and fading with network distance, while more distanced sectors display positive comovement dominated by vertical effects.

2.3. DISCUSSION

In conclusion of this theoretical exploration, the overall production network effects on sectoral comovement of employment can be summarized by the following:

$$d \log \mathbf{N} = \ominus \left\{ d \log C + d \log \mathcal{S} + d \log \mathcal{N} + d \log \mathcal{D}(\cdot) \right\}$$

so that changes in sectoral employment levels are function of aggregate consumption (C), both sector-specific productivity and consumption of its intermediate good ($\mathcal{S}$), other sectors' productivities and their associated households' final consumption levels ($\mathcal{N}$) whose magnitudes depend on the Input-Output matrix, and "economic" distances in the production network architecture ($\mathcal{D}$) for both demand (sectors are closer if they share similar upstream suppliers) or supply (sectors are closer if they share similar downstream buyers) trade relationships among any pair of sectors.

After all the discussions, the following result can be then established.

THEOREM 2 (On the weighting of network "economic" distances) *In an Input-Output economy, the horizontal dimension of a network (defined by demand- and supply-driven distance matrices) is not weighted by its vertical dimension (defined by the direct or Leontief inverse matrix).*

Proof in Appendix A.3.

The theorem postulates that, within an Input-Output economy, the horizontal dimension of the network, captured by demand- and supply-driven distance matrices, remains unweighted and independent by its vertical dimension, encoded in the Input-Output matrix. This distinction is crucial for understanding the economics of production networks: while the vertical structure reflects the intensity of inter-

sectoral trade linkages, the horizontal structure identifies demand/supply complementarities across sectors related through common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers. In other words, by separating the horizontal from the vertical dimension, the theorem clarifies that whatever distance matrix is not merely a transformation of the Input-Output matrix, but a complementary object that reveals otherwise hidden propagation channels within the production network.

Finally, through the lens of eq. (6), changes in sectoral employment would play the same role on aggregate fluctuations, and idiosyncratic magnitude depends on the influence played by a sector in the network: a sector-specific shock that increases sectoral employment will determine a subsequent increase in other sectors' employment, thus leading to fluctuations in both aggregate employment and output. However, as discussed so far and in Subsections 1.2 and 2.2, for different types of network distances the component $d \log \mathcal{D}(\cdot)$ plays an important role in the way in which sectoral shocks propagate to other ones: the direction of changes in employment levels depend on whether any pair of sectors is characterized by high/low distance relations, thus differently influencing the employment component of aggregate fluctuations of GDP. In particular, it can be stated that

$$d \log Y = \begin{cases} \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\lambda(s) d \log z(s) + \nu(s) \Delta \text{comovement} \right) & \text{under major distance} \\ \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\lambda(s) d \log z(s) + \nu(s) \Delta \text{reallocation} \right) & \text{under minor distance} \end{cases}$$

As a summary in terms of sectoral employment and comovement, the following conjectures have been established: (i) positive changes in sectoral intermediate inputs increase the sector-specific employment level; (ii) if sectors are buying from the same upstream sector(s), the strength and clarity of this effect can be ambiguous due to the overlapping of vertical and horizontal propagation, and positive changes in other sectors' employment transmit positively to sectoral employment under low network distance; accordingly, (iii) if sectors are selling to the same downstream sector(s), changes in sectoral employment due to other sectors' changes in employment are driven by the entity of their supply distance relation. These theoretical predictions will be empirically tested in Section 4. Before doing so, however, I shall provide a description of the data and of the characteristics of the U.S. production network.

3. DATA AND NETWORK ANATOMY

From the United States' Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA), available data display information, for 3-digit U.S. 2017 North American Industrial Classification System (NAICS) sectors, on value-added, employment, net exports, and inter-sectoral linkages exploiting Input-Output (I-O) matrices.²³ The (balanced) panel data built is

²³ Row sectors identify supplier (upstream), and column sectors identify buyer (downstream). Hence, row sector is the origin and column sector is the destination of the circulating intermediate input.

made of 65 private sectors over the period 1998-2022.²⁴ Paragraphs below briefly describe the data content related to the production network and its sectoral distances, and their mapping to the outlined theory of Sections 1 and 2; for additional details and an extended discussion of the data refer to Appendix C.

To investigate the network structure, weights for upstream and downstream sectors as well as sectoral distances are pinned down using the *commodity-by-commodity total direct requirements* Input-Output table, whose elements are expressing the amount of intermediate inputs needed to produce the sectoral good in terms of one unit of final consumption. In principle, this object is the equivalent of the H matrix in the model of Sections 1 and 2. However, for what concerns the creation of network distance matrices only, small transactions among sectors are disregarded so that the reader should think of matrix $\mathcal{D}^j$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, in all the derived propositions, as factor input demand (or factor input supply) distance matrix computed from an Input-Output structure in which each inter-sectoral trade linkage is greater than 1% of total purchases (or sales) of the *common* sector – *i.e.*, from an adjusted network matrix $\mathbf{H}^j = [\alpha^j(s, s')]]$ whose generic element is then $\alpha^j(s, s') > 0.01$.²⁵

It is important to emphasize that, hereafter, either network weights and distance measures are derived from the *directed* network, H , rather than from its *Leontief inverse* counterpart, $\mathcal{H}$. Whereas the latter incorporates indirect sectoral exposures as well, and thus amplifies the magnitude of interconnections beyond direct relationships, the directed network isolates the immediate intensity of trade between pairs of sectors, thereby offering a more parsimonious and transparent representation of demand/supply linkages. Employing the directed configuration to characterize the entries of matrices $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$ avoids overstating distance values between sectors, preventing the inflation of horizontal complementarities and instead preserving the strictly observed interdependencies in the Input-Output structure.²⁶

3.1. CHARACTERISTICS OF DISTANCE NETWORKS

Later on, the empirical estimation will consider network distances at their *extensive margin* for sectoral classification purposes (reminiscent from Theorem 2). To avoid notational confusion, extensive margin version of the Input-Output network distance matrices are labelled as $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^j$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, identifying both factor input demand

²⁴ The 3-digit classification is the most granular if one wants to keep track of the evolution in the set of intermediate inputs, and 1998 is the first year in which the NAICS system has been adopted.

²⁵ I adhere to the established literature (*e.g.*, Conley and Dupor 2003, Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012, Carvalho 2014). This approach enables to compute a finite set of network distances at the extensive margin, as it removes any bias stemming from meaningless sectoral interconnections.

²⁶ While *sparsity* is preserved under both representations, the directed network prevents the exaggeration of distance values that would emerge under the Leontief inverse system. From the perspective of Example 4, the directed structure ensures distances to stem from immediate network ties, consistently with the absence of an indirect link: the additional propagation from s_1 to s_3 – *i.e.*, the Leontief inverse mechanism of indirect network effects – would not be artificially introduced to compute network distances, rather based on common upstream and downstream sectors. Put differently, the network distance between s and s_4 , conditional on adjustments in s_1 , would remain contained by overlooking the additional Leontief-based linkage towards s_3 .

and factor input supply cases, whose generic entry is $d_{ext}^j[s, s'] = \{1, 2, \dots, d_{max}\}$.

As a characterization of matrices $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^{fs}$, network distance- d among any two sectors $\{s, s'\}$ is computed as a *shortest path problem* from the *intensive margin* distance matrices, $\mathcal{D}^j$, with $d^j[s, s'] \in [0, 1]$ and $j = \{fd, fs\}$ (for details on their construction, refer to Appendix C), implementing an algebraic version (i.e., using matrix multiplication) of the traditional Dijkstra (1959)'s or Roy (1959)-Floyd (1962)-Warshall (1962)'s types of algorithms, since it is (i) suitable for discrete-value adjacency matrices (as the one pre-built to account for distances at the extensive margin), and (ii) fairly efficient for small to medium-sized sparse graphs (as a sector-level production network). In Appendix C it is reported the technically sophisticated version of the implemented *shortest path algorithm* which, in plain words, reads as follows.

(Shortest path algorithm) *Central idea is to find, for each single node, all the other nodes that can be reached in one step, then in two steps, and so on. Each time a node is reached for the first time, it records the number of steps it took to get there – this is the shortest path approach. In other words, find the shortest number of steps it takes to get from every node to every other node in a network. In particular:*

- (a) *identify the direct connections between any pair of nodes (those that take exactly one step to be connected);*
- (b) *for not-connected pairs, increase the path length by 1 in each round (two steps, then three steps, etc.). Multiply the graph by itself to discover which new pairs of nodes are now connected through longer paths;*
- (c) *if a pair of nodes becomes connected (i.e., only if it has not be already found a shorter path), record the current length as the shortest distance between them;*
- (d) *repeat this process until any new reachable pairs of nodes is found. For any pair of nodes that are still unreachable (i.e., the distance is still zero and they are not linked in the network), set their distance to infinity.*

Outside this routine set to zero all the disconnected nodes (those at ∞). Each matrix $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^j$, whose values are at the extensive margin and identify network distances among any pair $\{s, s'\}$, is built, and the generic element, identifying the existence of a link between node- s and node- s' , is then $d_{ext}^j[s, s'] = \{1, 2, \dots, d_{max}\}$ for $j = \{fd, fs\}$. Unlike in the theoretical framework, values closer to one correspond to shorter horizontal distances. From this perspective, while the elements of the distance matrices in Sections 1 and 2 reflect *network economic proximity* between pairs of sectors (indicating how closely connected pairs of sectors are), the distance matrices used from this point onward are interpreted as measures of *network economic distance* (emphasizing the degree of separation between sectors within the network).

To illustrate the constructed distance matrices Figure 4 displays, for each extensive margin value, the network distance relationships among sectors based on both factor input demand and factor input supply horizontal linkages. Importantly, each connection does not necessarily represent inter-sectoral trade between two sectors,

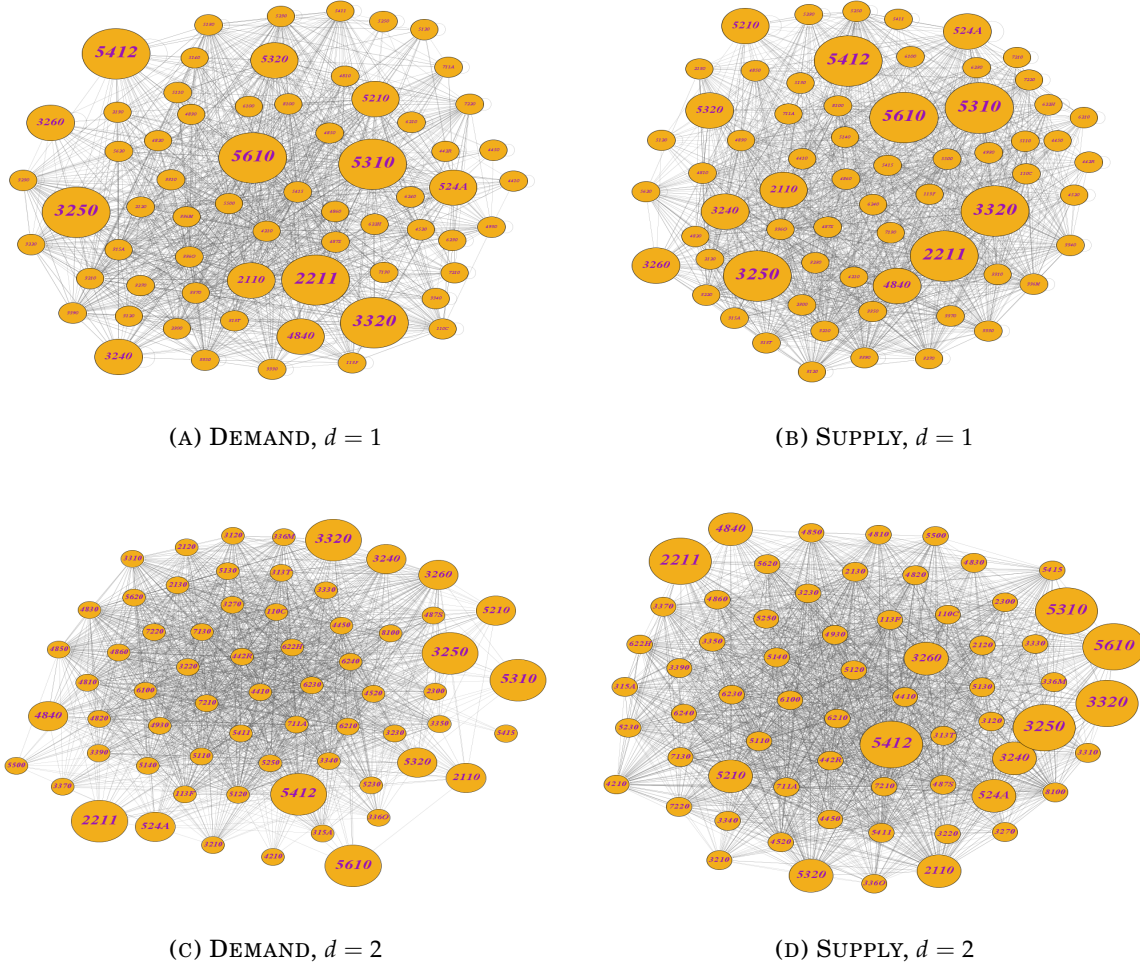


FIGURE 4: VISUALIZATION OF PRODUCTION NETWORK DISTANCES

Note: each panel of the figure represents the distance-based inter-sectoral production network corresponding to the (commodity-by-commodity total direct requirements) U.S. Input-Output matrix in the year 2007. *Factor input demand* and *factor input supply* network distances are computed implementing the *shortest path algorithm* on distance matrices whose values are at the intensive margin, as well derived from the *directed* configuration of the production network. Panels 4a and 4c correspond to the demand-based network distances, with $d = 1$ for low distance (closest sectors) and $d = 2$ for major distance (further sectors), among any pair of sectors; analogously it is for the supply-based network distances in Panels 4b and 4d. There are 65 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS private sectors, and each orange node corresponds to one of them. Two sectors connected under $d = 1$ cannot be linked under $d = 2$, and otherwise; constructed distance matrices are full (Theorem 1). Biggest nodes correspond to top 10% of mostly connected sectors (*i.e.*, major number of inter-sectoral connections), while intermediate ones the additional top 20%. Figure drawn with the software package *Gephi*, version 0.10, exploiting the *ForceAtlas2* layout algorithm. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

but rather it reflects an horizontal linkage based on demand- or supply-driven network distance relationships. A few concatenated points are then worth noting.

First, the distribution of horizontal complementarities is uneven across distance levels. At very short range ($d = 1$), the demand-based network appears slightly denser than the supply-based one, suggesting that sectors are more frequently linked through common upstream suppliers than through shared downstream buyers. However, this asymmetry vanishes as the distance increases ($d = 2$), where both types of horizontal ties spread more diffusely across the network.

Second, sectors with the highest number of Input-Output linkages tend to con-

centrate at the very core of the production system when considering only close connections ($d = 1$). As shown in Panels 4a and 4b, both the largest hubs (top 10% by connectivity) and the mid-sized hubs (top 20%) are similarly central, occupying short distances from the network’s nucleus.

Third, and in contrast with the previous point, these same highly connected sectors tend to become relatively more peripheral once longer distances ($d = 2$) are considered. Panels 4c and 4d show that, at this range, their positions are more evenly distributed across the network, reflecting the fact that their trade structures – both upstream and downstream – are highly similar to those of other sectors. In other words, the most connected sectors are less unique at longer distances, as commonalities in demand and supply linkages become more widespread.

Altogether, these observations highlight that the structure and role of horizontal complementarities depend crucially on the notion of distance. At shorter distances, horizontal linkages cluster around the same set of key sectors, whereas at longer distances, such complementarities are more evenly distributed across the production network. This pattern confirms that sectors typically share both upstream suppliers and downstream buyers at smaller but not at a greater distance, so that the same vertical production system can give rise to distinct horizontal geometries depending on the perspective adopted, as illustrated by Examples 1 to 3, Section 1. The significance of these insights will be examined using U.S. sector-level employment and Input-Output data in the following section.

4. EMPIRICS

In this empirical section I am going to use sector-level data for the United States (U.S.) economy to test the predictions about the sectoral comovement of employment in a production network characterized in Section 2. To do so, estimation relies on the two-stages procedure outlined by Barattieri and Cacciatore (2023): to identify the exogenous variation in a given sectoral series, perform sectoral panel Fixed-Effect (FE) regressions to isolate the exogenous dynamics in a given input of production not due to other (sector-specific, other sectors-specific and aggregate) factors; then, the estimated sector-specific residual is used as an identified structural shock in a Local Projection (LP), consisting in a battery of (predictive) panel regressions of the identified structural shock on the employment series for each sector, in order to assess the short-run cumulative variation in sectoral employment.²⁷

Initially, I estimate variations in sectoral employment due to changes in the set of intermediate inputs (Proposition 3); then, I turn to analyse how network distances (horizontal demand/supply linkages) affect the sectoral comovement of employment through the production network structure, as read by Propositions 4, 5, and 6.

²⁷ Indeed, the identified employment shock is the residual (exogenous) change in a sector’s employment after controlling for its own output dynamics and fixed effects. It is not a pure demand- or supply-side shock; rather, it can result from either (or both) and captures unexpected employment adjustments, thereby tracing how shocks propagate across the production network.

4.1. INTERMEDIATE SHARES AND SECTORAL EMPLOYMENT

Central premise of Sections 1 and 2 is that adjustments in the stock of intermediate inputs lead to analogous shifts in employment levels. This subsection examines how changes in sector-specific employment are induced by own variations in circulating intermediate inputs within the production network, both for its set and that of nearby sectors. In a preliminary step, the building idea is to identify exogenous variations in the share of intermediate inputs that each sector purchases from others, that is changes in the share of production of sector- s bought from sector- s' , $\forall s' \in \Phi_s$, which are plausibly exogenous to employment dynamics. I estimate the following panel fixed-effects regression over $s \in \Phi(s)$ sectors

$$\begin{aligned} x_t(s) = & \beta_n \dot{n}_t(s) + \sum_d \beta_{n(d)} \dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, d) + \sum_k \beta_{n(k)} \dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, k) \\ & + \beta_{z(s)} \mathcal{Z}_t(s) + \beta_{\dot{z}(s)} \dot{\mathcal{Z}}_t(s) + \beta_z \mathcal{Z}_t + \beta_{\dot{z}} \dot{\mathcal{Z}}_t + \psi(s) + u_t^x(s) \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

where $x_t(s)$ identifies the set of intermediate inputs bought via the inter-sectoral trade by sector- s (taken as a share of its intermediate output), $\dot{n}_t(s)$, $\dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, d)$, and $\dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, k)$ represent employment growth for sector- s , employment growth of its closer and further sectors, and employment growth of its associated upstream and downstream sectors, respectively. The latter two measures are defined as

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, d) &= \sum_{s' \neq s \in \Phi_s} \Delta n(s', d) \quad , \quad \forall d \in \mathcal{D}_{ext}^j \quad \text{and} \quad j = \{fd, fs\} \\ \dot{n}_t(\Phi_s, k) &= \sum_{s' \neq s \in \Phi_s} \ell(s, s') \Delta n(s', k) \quad , \quad \forall k = \{up, dw\} \end{aligned}$$

where $\Delta n(\cdot) = n_t(\cdot) - n_{t-1}(\cdot)$. As for vertical propagation, each change in employment is weighted by the Leontief inverse relation, $\ell(s, s') = [1 - \alpha(s, s')]^{-1}$, between sector- s and each of the other sectors whenever these are located upstream or downstream to sector- s . Note that the Input-Output element $\ell(s, s')$ is thus capturing the *direct* and *indirect* exposure to the production network of sector- s when it is buying intermediate inputs from sector- s' , so that the former sector is not impacted only by the latter one, but also by how such sector is impacted by its connected sectors. Differently, changes in employment under network distances are capturing all the horizontal relationships across sectors and, in line with the theory (refer to Theorem 2), they are not leveraged by the Leontief inverse weights. Sectors are classified according to their extensive margin distance, $d = \{1, 2, \dots, d_{max}\}$, relative to sector- s for both factor input demand and factor input supply configurations.

A set of control variables characterizes the second line of eq. (14). Sector-level controls, $\mathcal{Z}_t(s)$ and $\dot{\mathcal{Z}}_t(s)$, comprise the labour force size of the sector, both its level and growth rate of value-added, and net exports that allow to control for changes in demand and supply not due to internal factors but rather due the rest of the world. The set of aggregate controls, $\mathcal{Z}_t$ and $\dot{\mathcal{Z}}_t$, is made of aggregate value-added and aggregate employment in size as well as in growth terms. Finally, while β 's

are coefficients to be estimated, the element $\psi(s)$ imposes sector fixed-effect to control for unobserved heterogeneity across sectors. Standard errors are clustered at sector-level. For any sector, the estimated residual $\hat{u}_t^x(s)$ from eq. (14) identifies the exogenous variation in the share of production of sector- s that is bought from all the other sectors at which it is linked through Input-Output relations.

The study of the response of sectoral employment to changes in the sector-specific set of circulating intermediate inputs relies on the estimation of impulse response functions using the Local Projection method outlined in Jordà (2005), consisting in performing predictive panel regression techniques of the identified structural shock, $\hat{u}_t^x(s)$, on the cumulative difference in sectoral employment levels at different horizons.²⁸ In this way, the resulting Impulse Response Functions (IRFs) are defined by a sequence of estimated coefficients on the identified structural shock (Barattieri and Cacciatore 2023), averaged across sectors.

Given $\bar{h} = \{1, \dots, h\}$ time-horizons, and for all sectors $\{s, s', \dots, S\} \in \Phi(s)$, a battery of panel FE predictive regressions of the form

$$\dot{n}_{t+\bar{h}}^{cum}(s) = \beta_{\hat{u}^x, \bar{h}} \hat{u}_t^x(s) + \psi(t + \bar{h}) + \psi_{\bar{h}}(s) + \nu_{t+\bar{h}}^x(s) \quad (15)$$

is performed, with $\dot{n}_{t+\bar{h}}^{cum}(s) = n_{t+\bar{h}}(s) - n_{t-1}(s)$ denoting the cumulative change in sector- s employment at each horizon. Estimated coefficient $\beta_{\hat{u}^x, \bar{h}}$ has to be interpreted as the response of the variation in the cumulative difference of sectoral employment at time $t + \bar{h}$ given the identified shock hitting in period- t . Prediction error term $\nu_{t+\bar{h}}^x(s)$ is horizon-specific, while standard errors and bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI) of $\beta_{\hat{u}^x, \bar{h}}$ are clustered by sectors. To avoid measurement errors due to unobserved heterogeneity in response, sectoral fixed-effects $\psi_{\bar{h}}(s)$, and horizon fixed-effects $\psi(t + \bar{h})$ that remove common trends across sectors in the comovement of sectoral employment, are imposed.²⁹

Impulse responses from eq. (15) estimate the cumulative response of employment of sector- s to changes in its set of intermediate inputs (as a share of its intermediate output). The same estimation typology is also performed to variations induced by nearby sectors, that is, considering also the d^{th} -distance between sectors:³⁰

$$\dot{n}_{t+\bar{h}}^{cum}(s) = \beta_{\hat{u}^x(d), \bar{h}} \sum_{s' \neq s} \hat{u}_t^x(s', d) + \psi(t + \bar{h}) + \psi_{\bar{h}}(s) + \nu_{t+\bar{h}}^x(s, d) \quad (16)$$

²⁸ Cumulative variables are very likely to be highly correlated with the error term in panel data regressions due to the fact these are a sum of past values of the given variable of interest, thus bequeathing also the past error terms; such endogeneity issue may lead to biased and inconsistent estimates. Taking the difference between cumulative values allows to soothe endogeneity concerns.

²⁹ Differently from the first-stage, where I control common trends over time using aggregate variables, $\psi_{\bar{h}}(t + \bar{h})$ removes the possibility of common trend in the *response* of sector-specific employment to idiosyncratic shocks; the possibility that employment responses of sector- s and sector- s' to sector-specific shocks are influenced by a common trend between the two is ruled out.

³⁰ The analysis does not leverage every distance value but instead categorizes sectors by their relative closeness in the network (in line with Theorem 2). Indeed, the *shortest path algorithm* constructs extensive margin distance matrices, to be then exploited to classify sectors accordingly.

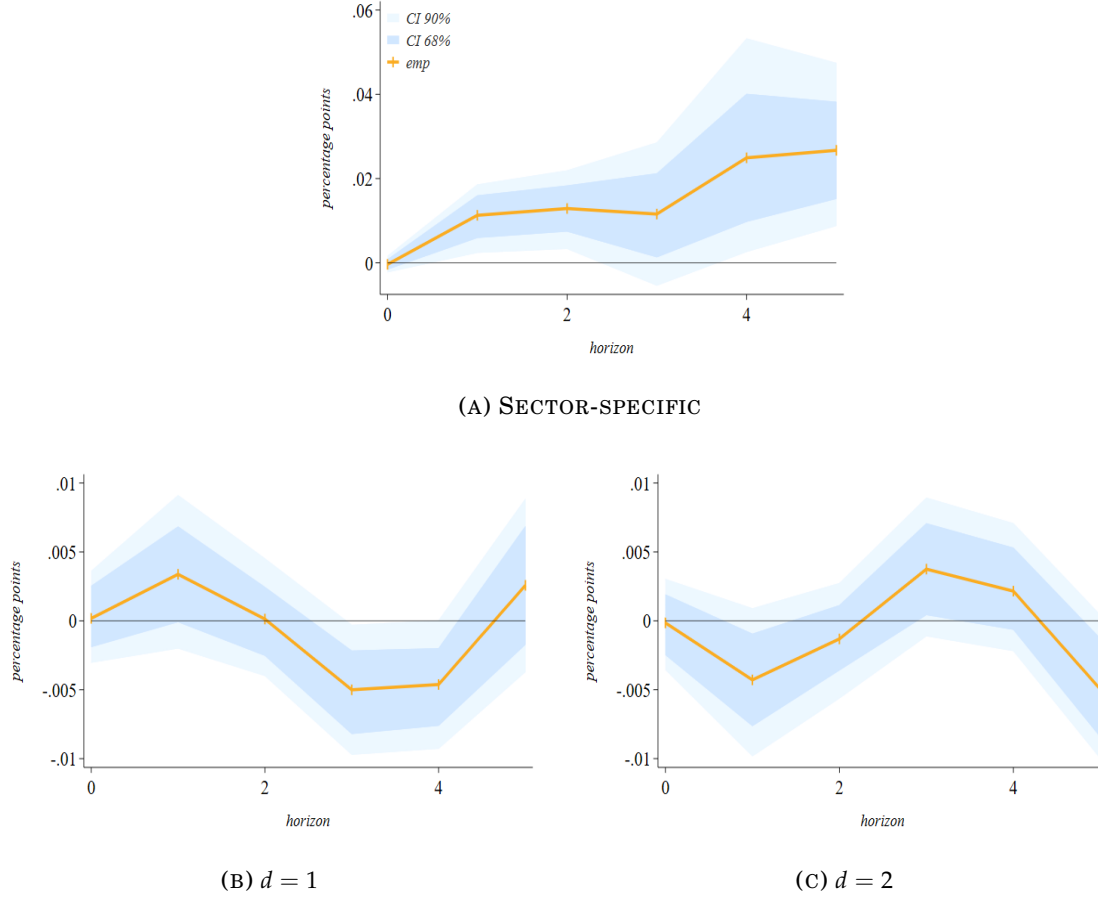


FIGURE 5: SECTORAL EMPLOYMENT RESPONSE TO INTERMEDIATE INPUTS

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (i.e., demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment to a 1% increase in the sector-specific set of intermediate inputs as a share of its value-added for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. In particular, Panel 5a represents the sector-level employment response to changes in its intermediate inputs, while Panel 5b-5c to changes in the set of intermediates in closer (distance equal to 1) and further (distance equal to 2) sectors. The solid-orange line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-blue and shadow-light blue areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eqs. (15)-(16). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

Performed estimation of eqs. (15) and (16), under *Leontief inverse* network structure and *factor input demand* distances, delivers Figure 5. The cumulative (short-term) response of sector-specific employment levels to a 1% change in its set of intermediate input (as a share of its total production) is depicted in the top panel: averaging across sectors, the increase induces a statistically-significant positive change in sectoral employment, in line with Proposition 3. The rationale beyond relies on the output effect, where an increase in intermediates will drive up total production of a given sector. Whether this effect can be attributed to a complementarity between employment level and intermediate inputs is still an open question; however, the magnitude of the change on the y -axis may ratify the Cobb-Douglas specification: an increase in the set of intermediate inputs by 1% induces a positive shift in employment by less than 1% upon impact. This implies that for a given increase in one unit

of intermediates it is required less than one worker so that factors of production may be at least substitute, as the Cobb-Douglas production function instructs.

Results for changes in intermediate inputs of other distance-related sectors are almost always not statistically significant at 90% except when the impact of the shock is fading out, but with a negligible magnitude. However, besides statistical significance which may be due to external market dynamics factors not accounted for my purposes, it is interesting to note the different response between Panel 5b and Panel 5c: for intermediate inputs changes in closer sectors there is an average negative effect, while changes in further sectors are positively related with variations in sectoral employment.³¹ Under *factor input supply* network distances, analogous results are obtained (decrease for closer sectors, increase for further ones).³² Such observations might suggest that certain types of intermediate inputs are more essential than others in production (e.g., Carvalho and Voigtländer 2015), but it is actually the entity of economic distance between sectors what determines their importance both in the production of sectoral intermediate output and in their role of being amplifiers of idiosyncratic and sector-specific shocks.

4.2. SECTORAL COMOVEMENT OF EMPLOYMENT

This section analyses how a sector's employment shifts in response to employment changes in other sectors, depending on their network distance. To this aim, the previous identification and estimation scheme is developed, but now purging the dynamics of sector-specific employment with changes in its and other sectors' value-added, since employment is not exogenous to growth rates of sectoral output.³³

Identification.— To identify exogenous variations in sectoral employment, $n_t(s)$, a panel fixed-effects regression over each sector $s \in \Phi(s)$ is estimated:

$$\begin{aligned} n_t(s) = & \beta_y \dot{y}_t(s) + \sum_d \beta_{y(d)} \dot{y}_t(\Phi_s, d) + \sum_k \beta_{y(j)} \dot{y}_t(\Phi_s, k) \\ & + \beta_{z(s)} \dot{Z}_t(s) + \beta_{\dot{Z}(s)} \dot{\dot{Z}}_t(s) + \beta_z \dot{Z}_t + \beta_{\dot{Z}} \dot{\dot{Z}}_t + \psi(s) + u_t^n(s) \end{aligned} \quad (17)$$

where $\dot{y}_t(s)$ is the value-added growth for sector- s , $\dot{y}_t(\Phi_s, d)$ identifies the value-

³¹ These results align with the demand-based sufficient statistics in Proposition 1: for closely related sectors, changes in their intermediate inputs tend to generate an average negative effect on a given sector. This arises because a positive shock in one sector might raise the prices of shared upstream suppliers, which, through upstream price pass-through (τ^{fd}), dampens the input demand of other downstream sectors, illustrating how horizontal complementarities interact with vertical spillovers to shape sectoral responses.

³² In Appendix D, Panel D.1a of Figure D.1, I show how that the same impact of Panel 5a still holds when network distances in eqs. (15)-(16) are identified under *factor input supply* distance relations. Results for distances' effects (Panels D.1b and D.1c) identify whiter but analogous results.

³³ Hornstein and Praschnik (1997) highlight positive comovement of output and employment across sectors (as strong cross-sectoral employment correlations support the observed comovement in value-added), driven by intermediate inputs in durable goods production. Similarly, Acemoglu, Akcigit, et al. (2015) examine how sectoral shocks propagate through production networks while resulting in output and employment comovement, and Sandqvist (2017) demonstrates that the strength of these linkages on comovement varies over time and intensifies in downturns. More recently, Barattieri, Cacciato, and Traum (2023) find that targeted government spending benefits recipient and upstream sectors but reduces output and employment downstream.

added growth of its related sectors according to network distance, and $\dot{y}_t(\Phi_s, k)$ represents the value-added growth of its upstream and downstream sectors. Each measure is defined as that of eq. (14) but using $y(s)$ instead of employment. Moreover, for this specification, sector-level controls, $Z_t(s)$ and $\dot{Z}_t(s)$, comprise the labour force size of the sector and its value-added level, while aggregate controls, Z_t and $\dot{Z}_t$, are the same of eq. (14). Just like the previous specification (Subsection 4.1), the coefficients to be estimated are the β 's, and I only impose sector fixed-effects, $\psi(s)$.³⁴ Sector-specific estimated residual $\hat{u}_t^n(s)$ from eq. (17) identifies the exogenous variation in sectoral employment. Standard errors are clustered at sector-level.

Local Projection analysis.— Sectoral comovement is defined as the response of employment in a given sector to changes in employment of other sectors. This issue can be addressed using Local Projections with the following form:

$$\dot{n}_{t+\bar{h}}^{cum}(s) = \beta_{\hat{n}(d), \bar{h}} \sum_{s' \neq s} \hat{u}_t^n(s', d) + \psi(t + \bar{h}) + \psi_{\bar{h}}(s) + \nu_{t+\bar{h}}^n(s, d) \quad (18)$$

with $\dot{n}_{t+\bar{h}}^{cum}(s) = n_{t+\bar{h}}(s) - n_{t-1}(s)$ denoting the cumulative change in sector- s employment at each horizon given the identified employment shock in closer or further sectors at the d^{th} -distance. Coefficient $\beta_{\hat{n}(d), \bar{h}}$ is the $\bar{h}$ -step-ahead response of sector-specific employment cumulative difference due to identified shock $\hat{u}_t^n(s', d)$. Still, sector and horizon fixed effects, $\psi_{\bar{h}}(s)$ and $\psi(t + \bar{h})$ respectively, are imposed to remove unobserved heterogeneity and common trends across sectors in the comovement of sectoral employment. Prediction error term $\nu_{t+\bar{h}}^n(s, d)$ is horizon- and distance-specific in each predictive panel regression, and standard errors and bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI) of $\beta_{\hat{n}(d), \bar{h}}$ are again clustered by sectors.

Impulse responses from eq. (18) estimate employment comovement as the average cumulative response of sectoral employment to changes in employment in other sectors, distinguishing between both types of *factor input demand* and *factor input supply* distances. As a preview of the results, the outlined estimation ratifies the theoretical predictions of Proposition 5, as sectors purchasing intermediate inputs from common upstream suppliers do not necessarily exhibit positive comovement of employment levels: responses of closely linked sectors are muted or ambiguous (increase for some, decrease for some others), whereas more distance sectors tend to comove. Results also corroborate Proposition 6, in particular for sectors with the major number of Input-Output connections in the production network: when the distance is low, sectors selling their intermediate output as intermediate inputs to the same downstream buyers are characterized by an opposite comovement in employment levels while, when the distance is substantial, supply linkages among sectors

³⁴ In both identifications I exclude time fixed-effect while controlling for variations in aggregate variables. Comovement between aggregate and sectoral variables is well established in the literature. Stock and Watson (1999) use quarterly data over 1953:I-1996:IV period showing the positive association of the cyclical component of real GDP with aggregate employment and hours worked, and sectoral employment. Strong pro-cyclicality characterizes sectoral hours worked and employment, positively correlated with aggregate output in Huffman and Wynne (1999). As from Rebelo (2005), the correlation between aggregate and sectoral hours worked is .68 to .80. DiCecio (2009) emphasizes the comovement to be driven by sticky wages.

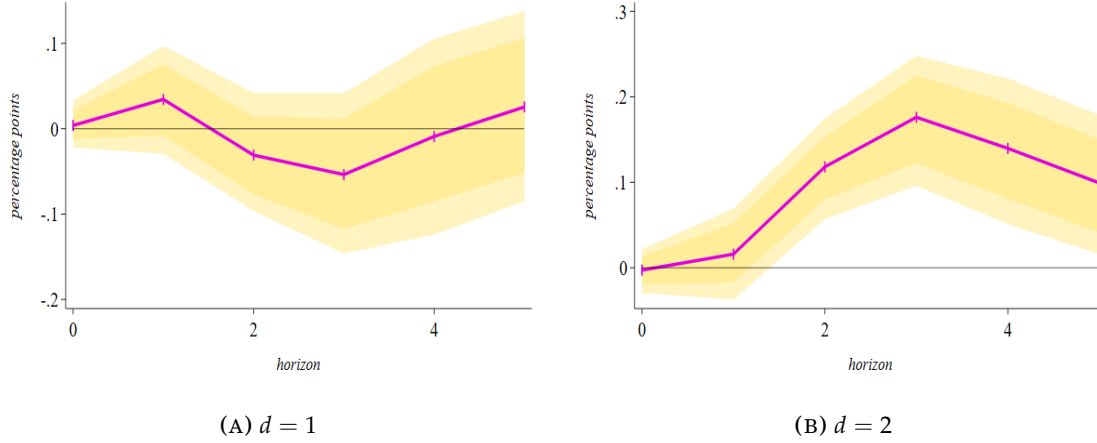


FIGURE 6: EMPLOYMENT COMOVEMENT UNDER DEMAND LINKAGES

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (i.e., demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel 6a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel 6b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

will determine a positive comovement of sectoral employment. Henceforth, at short network distances horizontal propagation takes over, offsetting any positive comovement effect, and eclipsing the standard vertical transmission of idiosyncratic shocks.

Results for factor input demand distances

Considering sectors whose distance is defined in terms of buying from the same set of upstream suppliers, estimating eq. (18) yields Figure 6. As already emphasized in Subsection 1.3, demand-based complementarities are inherently ambiguous to interpret, since they depend on the joint action of vertical propagation and horizontal spillovers. The sufficient-statistic conditions derived in Proposition 1 try to clarify this ambiguity: positive comovement in downstream sectors arises only when the combined effect of upstream price pass-through (transmitted through the common supplier) and downstream substitutability across intermediate inputs works in the same direction. When buyers can easily substitute inputs, an increase in employment in one sector strengthens demand for the shared supplier without crowding out the other sector, producing positive comovement. By contrast, when inputs are strong complements, a positive shock in one sector raises the supplier's price, eroding the competitiveness of the other sector and dampening comovement. Where these forces conflict or remain weak, observed correlations are muted or ambiguous.

These mechanisms echo in observed employment responses. Panels 6a and 6b show that a 1% increase in employment in closely linked sectors ($d = 1$) produces an ambiguous (statistically not significant) response, whereas more distant sectors ($d = 2$) consistently display positive comovement. However, sectoral shocks to em-

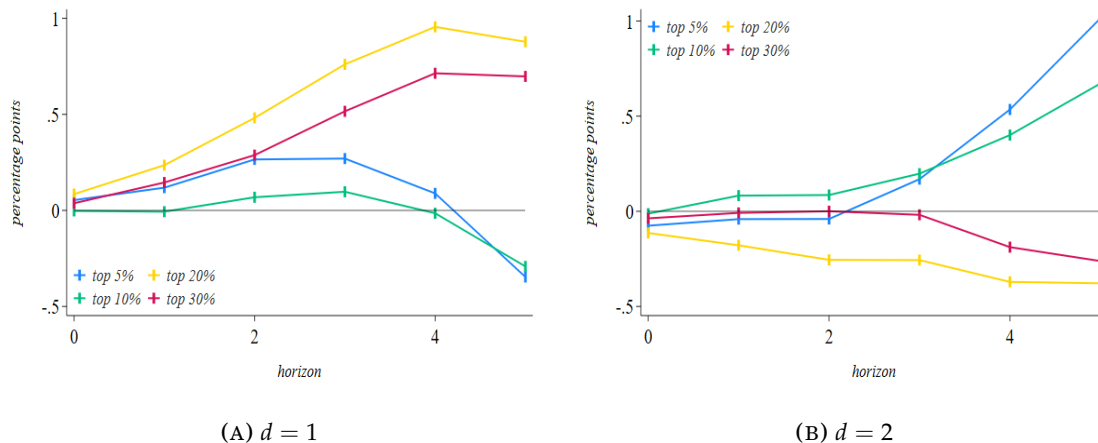


FIGURE 7: DEMAND LINKAGES AND COMOVEMENT IN HIGHLY INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel 7a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel 7b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. Each line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors with different numbers of linkages, robust to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI) computed from eq. (18). If a plot is not appearing, it means there is no response for the specified distance value. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

ployment levels shown in Panel 6a do not produce any statistically significant effects, as the estimated responses fail to reach significance at both the 90% and 68% confidence levels. It is possible that sectors with fewer inter-sectoral linkages introduce noise or bias to the estimation, masking the true magnitude. Put it differently, the lack of a significant effect may be driven by including all sectors indiscriminately, which dilutes the measurable comovement in sectoral employment: restricting the sample to sectors with most Input-Output linkages could reveal more meaningful propagation effects, in line with Subsection 1.1. Given these considerations, the performed analysis is also conducted focusing exclusively on highly interlinked sectors – *i.e.*, those sectors with the highest number of linkages within the considered production network. By concentrating on this subset, I aim to better capture the dynamics of employment propagation where inter-sectoral connections are strongest and thus where network effects are more pronounced.

Nevertheless, ambiguous patterns emerge when sectors are partitioned into finer subsets by the number of Input-Output linkages (Figure 7): comovement depends on the specific subset of sectors considered. This confirms that horizontal complementarities and vertical propagation operate jointly, often obscuring one another. Such mixed evidence ultimately reflects the inherent ambiguity of demand-based distances discussed in Subsection 1.3: because they capture substitution patterns across upstream intermediate goods rather than genuine horizontal complementarities, horizontal propagation remains weak and easily masked by vertical effects.

Observed demand-driven comovement broadly aligns with the theory developed in Subsection 2.2. Positive comovement is most likely to emerge when sectors are

“economically” distant, since vertical effects dominate and the conflicting role of horizontal spillovers is attenuated. For closely connected sectors, however, the balance between vertical and horizontal channels is more delicate, producing the mixed responses observed in the data. This suggests that observed employment comovement mirrors an interplay of vertical and horizontal propagation, thereby highlighting the inherent complexity in interpreting demand-based complementarities. In this sense, factor input demand distances reveal how horizontal geometries can either reinforce or challenge the standard vertical logic of propagation, thereby adding an essential layer of complexity to the interpretation of comovement in production networks.

Results for factor input supply distances

Considering now sectors whose distance is defined in terms of selling to the same set of downstream buyers, Figure 8 plots the responses from the estimation of eq. (18). Interpreting the effect of further ($d = 2$) sectors’ changes in employment yields the same results of the factor input demand case: from Panel 8b, a 1% increase in their employment increases sectoral employment as well, thus determining positive comovement and a positive transmission of the sector-idiosyncratic shock. Different is the case of closer ($d = 1$) sectors, where it appears a positive and then a negative cumulative effect on sector-specific employment under a small impact magnitude.

The lack of significance in Panel 8a might have two complementary interpretations: (i) changes in employment in nearby sectors have no measurable impact on others when the sectors are linked through a common set of downstream buyers; and (ii) the factor input supply network distance seems to dampen the vertical propagation of shocks across the production network, thereby weakening the expected comovement in production inputs across sectors. As discussed in Subsection 2.2, this attenuation effect arises due to what can be interpreted as an intermediate output effect, $y(s)$. Specifically, when sectors share the same downstream buyers, a change in the relative revenues received from the common buyer leads to opposite changes in their relative supply of intermediate inputs (Lemma 2). This generates an inverse comovement in sectoral outputs and, consequently, an opposite comovement in sectoral employment levels. In the context of Panel 8a, these opposing forces roughly cancel each other out when averaged across all sectors, resulting in the non-significant response. Accordingly, in analogy with the demand distances, clearer effects might be correctly identified when considering highly interlinked sectors.

Impulse responses for this analysis are presented in Figure 9. The results for major network distances, shown in Panel 9b, largely mirror those found using the full sample, but with a notably higher magnitude in the point estimates responding to the structural employment shock. This suggests that shocks in highly interconnected sectors generate stronger propagation effects through the production network, amplifying the employment response among these sectors. More strikingly, the results under minor supply distances, depicted in Panel 9a, fully confirm Proposition 6: any positive increase in employment levels within closely linked sectors

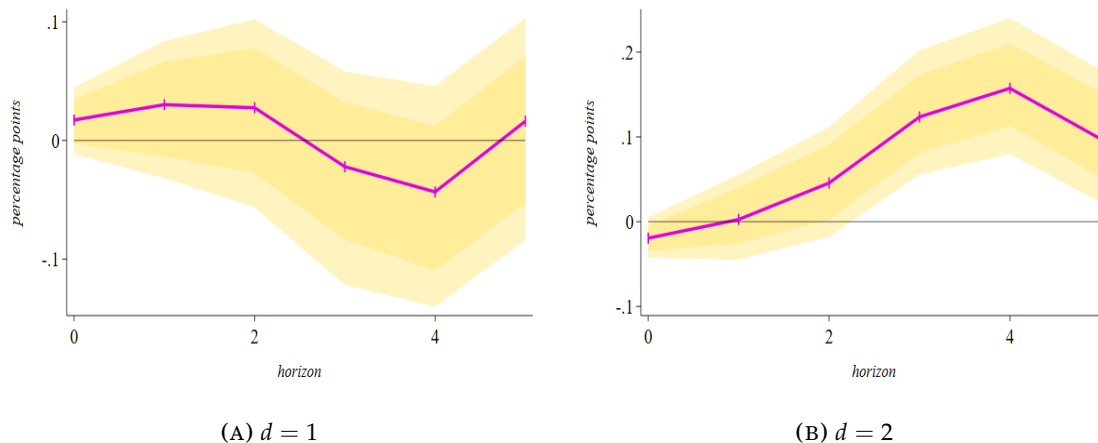


FIGURE 8: EMPLOYMENT COMOVEMENT UNDER SUPPLY LINKAGES

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (i.e., supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel 8a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel 8b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

induces a negative transmission effect on employment in other nearby sectors, resulting in an opposite comovement in sectoral employment levels. This inverse relationship highlights the counter-intuitive dynamics of factor input supply distance networks, where shocks do not simply propagate in a uniform positive manner but can generate divergent employment responses depending on network proximity and the structure of interdependencies. Importantly, this negative comovement effect grows stronger as the analysis narrows to an even smaller group of sectors with increasingly dense linkages: the closer the sectors are in the production network (under supply-based horizontal relationships) the more pronounced these opposing employment responses become. In sum, restricting the analysis to highly interlinked sectors provides a clearer picture of how employment shocks travel through the production network, revealing that network structure and horizontal proximity fundamentally condition either the direction and the strength of sectoral comovement in employment levels.

Interpreting these results through the sufficient-statistic of Proposition 2 clarifies when negative comovement arises: a positive shock to a sector contracts production in other closely supply-linked sectors, thereby reflecting the take over of supply-driven horizontal interdependencies (adjustments in upstream relative prices) on the vertical propagation (increase in downstream demand). Yet, downstream pass-through is weaker when sectors have dissimilar Input-Output structure in supply.

Summary.— The theoretical insights of Sections 1 and 2 find empirical support. Sectoral employment shocks propagate differently depending on the types of “economic” distance in the production network. For factor input demand distances,

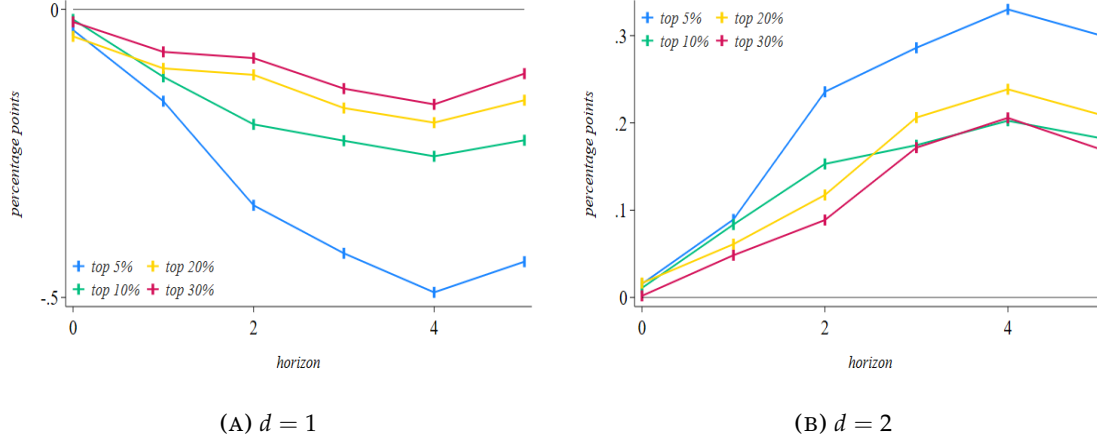


FIGURE 9: SUPPLY LINKAGES AND COMOVEMENT IN HIGHLY INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (i.e., supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel 9a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel 9b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. Each line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors with different numbers of linkages, robust to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI) computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

sector-specific changes in employment generate positive comovement in other sectors' employment when far apart, though responses for closely linked sectors remain ambiguous and muted due to the overlapping interplay of vertical and horizontal propagation through shared upstream suppliers. By contrast, supply-driven distances tend to produce negative comovement among closely linked sectors, effectively counteracting the standard vertical propagation mechanism and illustrating how competition for common downstream buyers can dampen or reverse the expected positive transmission. While minor demand-based distances attenuate vertical supply chain mechanisms, these findings underscore how it is the factor input supply distance that majorly disrupts standard vertical propagation: shocks in closely linked sectors often produce opposite employment responses, as competition for shared downstream buyers counteracts the usual (and even) transmission along the production network; in other words, the downstream demand pass-through is accordingly generating negative comovement. All these results are in line with the non-linear theories in Atalay (2017) and Baqaee and Farhi (2019): downstream complementarities in intermediate inputs are crucial to generate opposite responses from an idiosyncratic shock (thus pivotal is the downstream pass-through effect, as in Proposition 2). Finally, the empirics ratify the notion that as sectors are increasingly connected, horizontal complementarities matter the most.

4.3. ROBUSTNESS

Results on comovement hold along different “economically-based” robustness checks, sequentially presented in Appendix D. Initially, I shift the focus towards peripheral

sectors within the production network. Much of the existing literature holds on the role of central sectors, typically measured using Bonacich-Katz centrality (e.g., Carvalho 2014). The underlying premise is that a positive shock in a central sector transmits outward, potentially inducing broader economic expansions – *i.e.*, microeconomic shocks can scale up to macroeconomic consequences through network centrality. From a comovement perspective, periods of economic expansion (contraction) are expected only when a positive (negative) shock in a central sector effectively propagates to more peripheral sectors: fluctuating aggregate activity is not merely a direct realization of shocks to central nodes, but rather it stems from the manner in which such asymmetric shocks ripple across the network to other, more peripheral sectors.³⁵ If network distances were irrelevant, comovement would be expected universally. However, should demand- and supply-side linkages prove significant, the comovement patterns ought to remain consistent with those documented thus far.

I then test the robustness of the presented findings by employing alternative base years for the U.S. production network. My main analysis is anchored at the 2007 Input-Output structure, which conveniently divides the sample period into two equal sub-periods. Theoretically, the results should remain valid provided that the production network structure exhibits limited evolution over time.³⁶ Empirically, I replicate the full set of analyses using network data from other benchmark years.

Centrality scores.– Figures D.6 and D.7 present the impulse responses of employment to factor input demand and supply distances, respectively, considering only the peripheral sectors of the U.S. production network. Results are broadly consistent with those discussed in earlier sections: opposite comovement under supply distances, and positive comovement for shocks originated in further sectors. The only noteworthy exception concerns the response of employment to changes in closer sectors under demand-based distances: rather than exhibiting the ambiguity observed for all sectors (overlapping of vertical and horizontal dimensions), inspecting horizontal complementarities in demand for more peripheral sectors generate effects that resemble those observed under supply-based distances, with negative comovement occurring across sectors sharing the same network structure in terms of buying from common suppliers. This refines the observed pattern under direct demand-based measures of Figure 6, suggesting that negative employment comovement among sectors purchasing from similar upstream suppliers largely occurs in sectors not playing a key role in the propagation of shocks.³⁷

Different base years.– All the documented results, derived using the 2007 U.S.

³⁵ Stated differently, it is not the initial shock itself that generates business cycle fluctuations, but the subsequent consequences it produces as it transmits across the network to less central nodes.

³⁶ A condition broadly supported in the empirical literature. For instance, Carvalho (2014) and Acemoglu, Ozdaglar, et al. (2016) document relative stability of U.S. sectoral production network and its role on shock propagation. Classical Input-Output analysis (Leontief 1986, Miller and Blair 2009) also emphasises the persistence of production linkages in the short to medium run.

³⁷ In line with the discussion in Baqaee and Farhi (2019): within a sector, complementarities (“horizontal” in my framework) across intermediate inputs attenuate the aggregate effects of a positive idiosyncratic shock.

tables, remain robust if replicated for alternative benchmark years (2002 and 2012), as depicted in Figures D.8, D.9, and D.10. This temporal consistency suggests that the structural features of the U.S. production network have remained remarkably stable over time, in line with the academic debate. Such outcomes document the enduring nature of Input-Output linkages and the slow-moving evolution of production networks, thus lending further credibility to the proposed horizontal mechanisms.

5. FUTURE POLICY PERSPECTIVES

The Input-Output structure of the economy shapes how shocks propagate and contributes to business cycle dynamics. This paper has explored how the structure of production networks shapes sectoral comovement, moving beyond the traditional focus on vertical transmission to emphasize the role of horizontal economic relationships. By analysing both the demand- and supply-driven dimensions of sectoral interconnections, the analysis reveals that shocks do not propagate solely along upstream or downstream chains. Instead, sectors that share common suppliers or buyers experience intertwined vertical and horizontal effects. Overall, sectoral comovement arises not only from direct or indirect vertical production network linkages, but also from horizontal distances defined by shared inter-sectoral trade structure. By highlighting this additional dimension, the paper offers a new perspective on how idiosyncratic shocks propagate in networked economies: it is not merely the existence of Input-Output connections, but rather the demand and supply geometry of these linkages that fundamentally governs the transmission of micro-originated shocks and the resulting macroeconomic comovement patterns. Several are the contributions that horizontal complementarities can provide to the ongoing literature exploiting a production network perspective to form and deliver policy prescriptions.³⁸

Fiscal policy.— A positive government-spending shock works through an increase in its demand of goods and services; affected sectors thus face an increase in their supply, stimulating an expansion of sectoral output. Enlarged production that meets the increased demand from the government then spread through Input-Output linkages as sectors rely on intermediate inputs sourced from their suppliers. In this regard, a micro-originated shock generates upstream effects (*e.g.*, Acemoglu, Akgigit, et al. 2015, Barattieri, Cacciatore, and Traum 2023). It is thus essential the horizontal dimension of a network since changes in demand and supply relationships – neglected in standard analysis – are at the core of mechanism triggered by an increased government demand. Moreover, horizontal effects play a critical role when

³⁸ On the theory side, horizontal complementarities can provide valuable insights into: (i) the functioning of global production networks (*e.g.*, Caliendo et al. 2022, Huo et al. 2025), extending beyond merely vertical supply chains; (ii) the complexity of firm-to-firm production networks (*e.g.*, di Giovanni et al. 2018, Boehm et al. 2019), as demand- and supply-based distance networks help to reveal relationships between nodes that would otherwise appear unconnected; (iii) the endogenous formation of production networks, since “economically” closer sectors tend to share similar Input-Output structures and might rely on common intermediate inputs that are more essential than others (*e.g.*, Carvalho and Voigtländer 2015); and (iv) the contribution of sectoral shocks to aggregate outcomes (*e.g.*, Acemoglu, Carvalho, et al. 2012, Atalay 2017, Baqaee and Farhi 2019).

considering the specific composition of public expenditure since certain sectors may be disproportionately exposed to changes in demand:³⁹ while the vertical transmission mechanism only depends on the intensity of inter-sectoral trade, incorporating measures of demand- and supply-driven network distances allows for a more accurate weighting in the propagation of sectoral shocks. Tariff policies operate through similar network mechanisms, not by raising demand directly, but rather altering relative prices (*e.g.*, Barattieri and Cacciatore 2023, Antonova et al. 2025, Clausing and Obstfeld 2025), effectively acting as revenue reallocation shocks, effectively lending further perspectives from network’s horizontal geometries.

Industrial policy.— Two contemporaneous papers analyse how production networks amplify the impact of industrial policies supporting strategic sectors to promote sustained economic growth: essentials are the notions of “distortionary effects” (market imperfections accumulate through backward demand linkages; Liu 2019) and “downstream spillovers” (positive effects on buyers of targeted sectors; Lane 2025), and both perspectives exploit the verticality of sectoral connections.⁴⁰ Yet, how do industrial policies affect untargeted sectors exhibiting similar Input-Output structures to the targeted ones? This is where the horizontal dimension matters.

Keynesian transmission mechanism.— Complementarities (either in consumption or production) might turn an asymmetric supply shock, affecting a subset of sectors and reducing their demand for other sectors, into a demand-like shock at the aggregate level (the “Keynesian supply shock”; see Guerrieri et al. 2022). Production network is a natural field to study this mechanism (*e.g.*, Cesa-Bianchi and Ferrero 2021) and, reminiscent from Subsection 1.1 (Figure 2b), horizontal complementarities among sectors can help to clearly, easily and linearly identify demand and supply forces within the network that guide the Keynesian transmission. This extended mechanism is important for interventions aimed at stabilizing business cycles, acting as a suitable extension of the production network framework for monetary policy (*e.g.*, Pasten et al. 2020, Kalemli-Özcan et al. 2025).

Finally, by embedding sectoral similarities through common structures of Input-Output linkages, the horizontal dimension transcends the confines of production networks rendering it applicable to a broader class of economic interdependencies, including studies analysing investment (*e.g.*, vom Lehn and Winberry 2022) or financial (*e.g.*, Acemoglu, Ozdaglar, et al. 2015, Huremovic et al. 2025) networks.

It is along these avenues that I intend to orient my future research agenda.

³⁹ For example, a large-scale infrastructure program would boost demand for construction, cement, and steel sectors, in turn strongly engaging with closely connected suppliers (such as mining, heavy machinery manufacturing, and architectural or engineering services). By contrast, weakly connected sectors with core infrastructure-related sectors (such as apparel manufacturing, publishing, residential cleaning services, or artisanal food production) would be only marginally affected.

⁴⁰ Explanations related to cross-country income differences, Input-Output economies and industrialization are presented in Ciccone (2002) and Fadinger et al. (2022). Conley and Ligon (2002) study how cross-country dependence and GDP growth rates are shaped by “economic distance”.

CONCLUDING REMARKS

Initial inquiries into production networks chiefly centred on how disaggregation induced by inter-sectoral trade generates comovement of macroeconomic variables. Reviving this foundational perspective, this paper moves beyond traditional vertical linkages by theoretically introducing and empirically validating the horizontal dimension of Input-Output economies, measured through network “economic” distances reflecting similarities between sectors in terms of common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers. Constitutive premise is that sectors are densely interconnected not only by their direct trade flows but also through shared inter-sectoral relationships, providing a richer understanding of the complex architecture underlying any capitalist economy. Demand-based distances promote an overlap of horizontal and vertical propagation, as shocks transmitted through shared upstream suppliers interact with vertical supply-chain effects. By contrast, supply-based distances directly threaten the design of vertical transmission, as revenue reallocation among sectors selling to the same downstream buyers counteracts the standard vertical propagation of shocks. These mechanisms operate independently of inter-sectoral trade intensities, offering a powerful refinement to prevailing network analysis. By conceptualising horizontal complementarities, which linearly encode non-linear intermediate input complementarities, the paper enriches the understanding of how independent and idiosyncratic shocks propagate from one sector to another. Ultimately, it reveals that the demand/supply geometry of an Input-Output structure and its horizontal dimension critically shape sectoral shocks’ transmission and comovement, offering novel insights into the networked nature of economic activity.

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APPENDIX

(Outline) *In this appendix I report all the material complementary to the main text; it is made of additional tables and figures, and of discussions on further analytical results. Section A deepens further all the theoretical findings; in particular, Subsection A.1 derives all the salient elements of the partial equilibrium results on production network distances of Section 1; Subsection A.2 derives all the characterizing features of the Input-Output general equilibrium model outlined in Section 2, whose propositions are proved in Subsection A.3. Section B proves and provides intuition on the sufficient statistics for sectoral comovement in Subsection 1.3. Section C consolidates and further discusses the data presented in Section 3. Finally, Section D complements and enriches the exposition of the empirical findings in Section 4. Part of this appendix is not intended for publication purposes.*

A. THEORETICAL RESULTS AND MODEL DERIVATION

A.1. Proofs for theoretical results on network economic distances

(Proof of Lemma 1) *Consider a Cobb-Douglas economy as stated in Section 2. The combination of optimal demand for both labour and intermediate inputs would yield*

$$x(s, s') = \alpha(s, s') w(s) n(s) \alpha(s)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s')}$$

Then, consider the case in which two sectors $\{s, s'\}$ are buying their own intermediate inputs from the same sector- s^ . Associated system of equations is*

$$\begin{cases} x(s, s^*) = \alpha(s, s^*) w(s) n(s) \alpha(s)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s^*)} \\ x(s', s^*) = \alpha(s', s^*) w(s') n(s') \alpha(s')^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s^*)} \end{cases}$$

$$\rightarrow \begin{cases} x(s, s^*) = \alpha(s, s^*) \left[x(s', s^*) \frac{1}{\alpha(s', s^*) n(s')} \alpha p(s^*) \right] n(s) \alpha^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s^*)} \\ w = x(s', s^*) \frac{1}{\alpha(s', s^*) n(s')} \alpha p(s^*) \end{cases}$$

where I exploit the fact that wage is the numeraire of the economy, so that $w(s) = w$, $\forall s \in \Phi(s)$, and, without any loss of generality (to simplify notation and build better intuition), $\alpha(s) = \alpha$, $\forall s \in \Phi(s)$ as well. The above substituted equation will result in

$$\frac{x(s, s^*)}{x(s', s^*)} = \frac{\alpha(s, s^*) n(s)}{\alpha(s', s^*) n(s')} \equiv \frac{n(s')}{x(s', s^*)} = \frac{\alpha(s, s^*) n(s)}{\alpha(s', s^*) x(s, s^*)} \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Now, note that solving the representative firm's problem with log-quantities will report exactly the same optimality conditions. Henceforth, it is not necessary to take logs in total log-differentiation. In other words, consider the following expression, in

which both $n(\cdot)$ and $x(\cdot)$ are already expressed in logarithmic form:

$$\frac{\log n(s')}{\log x(s', s^*)} = \frac{\alpha(s, s^*)}{\alpha(s', s^*)} \frac{\log n(s)}{\log x(s, s^*)}$$

Let me define the following for notational convenience: $N(s) := \log n(s)$, $X(s, s^*) := \log x(s, s^*)$, and $d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} := \frac{\alpha(s, s^*)}{\alpha(s', s^*)}$. The expression becomes

$$\frac{N(s')}{X(s', s^*)} = d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} \frac{N(s)}{X(s, s^*)}$$

I proceed by performing a first-order Taylor expansion around the steady state. Let $\bar{N}(s)$ and $\bar{X}(s, s^*)$ denote the steady-state values of $N(s)$ and $X(s, s^*)$, respectively, and let $dN(s)$ and $dX(s, s^*)$ denote their log-deviations. Using the total differential of a ratio, it is possible to obtain

$$d \left(\frac{N(s)}{X(s, s^*)} \right) = \frac{1}{\bar{X}(s, s^*)} dN(s) - \frac{\bar{N}(s)}{\bar{X}^2(s, s^*)} dX(s, s^*)$$

and similarly for sector- s' , $d \left(\frac{N(s')}{X(s', s^*)} \right) = \frac{1}{\bar{X}(s', s^*)} dN(s') - \frac{\bar{N}(s')}{\bar{X}^2(s', s^*)} dX(s', s^*)$. Since $d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']}$ is a constant parameter, it is possible to differentiate both sides of the original equation, $\frac{N(s')}{X(s', s^*)} = d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} \frac{N(s)}{X(s, s^*)}$:

$$d \left(\frac{N(s')}{X(s', s^*)} \right) = d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} d \left(\frac{N(s)}{X(s, s^*)} \right)$$

Inserting differentials, I derive the following first-order log-linearized expression

$$\frac{1}{\bar{X}(s', s^*)} dN(s') - \frac{\bar{N}(s')}{\bar{X}^2(s', s^*)} dX(s', s^*) = d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} \left(\frac{1}{\bar{X}(s, s^*)} dN(s) - \frac{\bar{N}(s)}{\bar{X}^2(s, s^*)} dX(s, s^*) \right)$$

which, given $d_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} = \frac{\alpha(s, s^*)}{\alpha(s', s^*)}$, will deliver the two-sector condition in Subsection 1.2. This result illustrates that the log-linearized response of the ratio between logged employment and logged intermediate inputs in sector- s' is proportional to that of sector- s , with the scaling factor given by their relative intensity of intermediate input usage, $\alpha(s, s^*) / \alpha(s', s^*)$. Steady-state values $\bar{N}(\cdot)$ and $\bar{X}(\cdot, s^*)$ cannot be avoided in this log-linearization due to the non-linear nature of the ratio between logarithms.

Stacked across all sectors, the above condition yields Lemma 1. Note that the same would have been obtained under Constant Elasticity of Substitution (CES) technology between $n(s)$ and $x(\cdot)$, and for any production function satisfying Assumption 1. $\square$

(Proof of Lemma 2) Consider a Cobb-Douglas economy as stated in Section 2. The combination of optimal demand for both labour and intermediate inputs would yield

$$x(s, s') = \alpha(s, s') w(s) n(s) \alpha(s)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s')}$$

Then, consider the case in which two sectors $\{s, s'\}$ are selling their own intermediate inputs to the same sector- s^* . Associated system of equations is

$$\begin{cases} x(s^*, s) = \alpha(s^*, s) w(s^*) n(s^*) \alpha(s^*)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s)} \\ x(s^*, s') = \alpha(s^*, s') w(s^*) n(s^*) \alpha(s^*)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s')} \end{cases}$$

$$\rightarrow \begin{cases} x(s^*, s) = \alpha(s^*, s) \left[x(s^*, s') \frac{1}{\alpha(s^*, s') n(s^*)} \alpha(s^*) p(s') \right] n(s^*) \alpha(s^*)^{-1} \frac{1}{p(s)} \\ w(s^*) = x(s^*, s') \frac{1}{\alpha(s^*, s') n(s^*)} \alpha(s^*) p(s') \end{cases}$$

The above substituted equation will result in

$$\frac{x(s^*, s)}{x(s^*, s')} = \frac{\alpha(s^*, s) p(s')}{\alpha(s^*, s') p(s)} \quad (\text{A.2})$$

which, if log-linearized around its steady state (note that solving the representative firm's problem with log-quantities will report exactly the same optimality conditions; thus, not necessary to take logs in total log-differentiation), closely following the proof for Lemma 1, will deliver the two-sector condition in Subsection 1.2 which, stacked across all sectors, delivers the result in Lemma 2. Note that the same result would have been obtained under Constant Elasticity of Substitution (CES) technology between $n(s)$ and $x(\cdot)$, and for any production function satisfying Assumption 1.

For completeness, consider the following expression

$$\frac{\log x(s^*, s)}{\log x(s^*, s')} = \frac{\alpha(s^*, s) \log p(s')}{\alpha(s^*, s') \log p(s)}$$

and define the following for notational convenience: $P(s) := \log p(s)$, $X(s^*, s) := \log x(s^*, s)$, and $d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] := \frac{\alpha(s^*, s)}{\alpha(s^*, s')}$. Thus, the expression becomes

$$\frac{X(s^*, s)}{X(s^*, s')} = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] \frac{P(s')}{P(s)}$$

Proceed by performing a first-order Taylor expansion around the steady state. Let $\bar{X}(s^*, s)$ and $\bar{P}(s)$ denote the steady-state values of $X(s^*, s)$ and $P(s)$, respectively, and let $dX(s)$ and $dP(s)$ to denote their log-deviations. Using the total differential of a ratio, then

$$d \left(\frac{X(s^*, s)}{X(s^*, s')} \right) = \frac{1}{\bar{X}(s^*, s')} dX(s^*, s) - \frac{\bar{X}(s^*, s)}{\bar{X}(s^*, s')^2} dX(s^*, s')$$

In the same manner the right-hand side can be manipulated, $d \left(d(s^* | s, s') \frac{P(s')}{P(s)} \right) = d(s^* | s, s') \left(\frac{1}{\bar{P}(s)} dP(s') - \frac{\bar{P}(s')}{\bar{P}^2(s)} dP(s) \right)$, since $d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s']$ is not changing. Differentiating both sides of the original equation, $\frac{X(s^*, s)}{X(s^*, s')} = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] \frac{P(s')}{P(s)}$, one obtains

$$\frac{1}{\bar{X}(s^*, s')} dX(s^*, s) - \frac{\bar{X}(s^*, s)}{\bar{X}(s^*, s')^2} dX(s^*, s') = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] \left(\frac{1}{\bar{P}(s)} dP(s') - \frac{\bar{P}(s')}{\bar{P}(s)^2} dP(s) \right)$$

This result demonstrates how the log-linearized relationship between price and quantity ratios in sectors $\{s, s'\}$ depends on their relative intensity $d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \frac{\alpha(s^*, s)}{\alpha(s^*, s')}$. Similar to the previous proof, the steady-state values $\bar{X}(s^*, \cdot)$ and $\bar{P}(\cdot)$ appear due to the non-linear nature (i.e., the ratio of logarithms) of the initial expression. $\square$

(Proof of Theorem 1) Let $\Phi(s)$ denote the finite set of sectors in the economy. Each sector can buy intermediate inputs from other sectors and, simultaneously, can sell its output to other sectors. Define this Input-Output bilateral trade intensity as

$\alpha(\cdot) : \Phi(s) \times \Phi(s) \rightarrow [0, \infty)$, $\alpha(s, s')$ is the amount of inputs purchased by s from s'

Express each fixed coefficient $\alpha(\cdot)$'s in terms of share of sectoral total purchases or sales – i.e., $\alpha^{fd}(s, s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in \text{row}} \alpha(s, s')}$ and $\alpha^{fs}(s, s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in \text{column}} \alpha(s, s')}$,⁴¹ these values allow to know not only “who trades with whom” but how much in relative terms.

Define the upstream (buying intermediate input from) and downstream (selling output to) sets of neighbours of sector- s^* as

$$\mathcal{N}^{up}(s^*) := \{s \in \Phi(s) : \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s) > 0\} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{N}^{dw}(s^*) := \{s \in \Phi(s) : \alpha^{fd}(s, s^*) > 0\}$$

Simplify temporarily with $\Phi(s) = \{s, s', s^*\}$: the upstream set points for the share of purchases of the common sector- s^* from sectors $\{s, s'\}$, and the downstream set represents the share of sales of the common sector- s^* to sectors $\{s, s'\}$. These are the same information in the Input-Output matrix, but now fully abstract. For any pair of sectors $\{s, s'\} \in \Phi(s)$, let the set of common neighbours be

$$\mathcal{S}_{s, s'} := \left\{ s^* \in \Phi(s) : s^* \in \mathcal{N}^{up}(s) \cap \mathcal{N}^{up}(s') \quad \text{or} \quad s^* \in \mathcal{N}^{dw}(s) \cap \mathcal{N}^{dw}(s') \right\}$$

for any common sector- s^* . These common neighbours are the sectors that can horizontally connect two already-connected or otherwise unconnected sectors vertically. Indeed, define the horizontal linkage (or network “economic” distance) metrics

$$d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s, s'] := f\left(\alpha^{fd}(s, s^*), \alpha^{fd}(s', s^*)\right) \quad \text{and} \quad d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] := f\left(\alpha^{fs}(s^*, s), \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s')\right)$$

for $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'}$. Relative to sectors in brackets, subscript “ $s^* \rightarrow$ ” reads as “purchasing from sector- s^* ”, while subscript “ $\rightarrow s^*$ ” reads as “selling to sector- s^* ”. Define further the vectors of factor input demand and supply distances for the pair $\{s, s'\}$ as

⁴¹ Row-normalized values show each sector's sales share to other sectors, highlighting how similarly sectors source from common upstream suppliers; analogously, column-normalized values show each sector's input share from other sectors, highlighting how similarly sectors sell to common downstream buyers. For further references, refer to Appendix C.

$$d^{fd} [s, s'] := \left\{ d_{s^* \rightarrow} [s, s'] : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'} \right\} \quad \text{and} \quad d^{fs} [s, s'] := \left\{ d_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s'] : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'} \right\}$$

Part 1: horizontal linkage exists even if two sectors are not connected.

Assume $\alpha^j (s, s') = 0$ and $\alpha^j (s', s) = 0$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$. If there exists $s^* \in \Phi (s)$ such that $s^* \in \mathcal{N}^{up} (s) \cap \mathcal{N}^{up} (s')$ or $s^* \in \mathcal{N}^{dw} (s) \cap \mathcal{N}^{dw} (s')$, then

$$d^{fd} [s, s'] > 0 \quad \text{and} \quad d^{fs} [s, s'] > 0$$

quantify the horizontal linkages between $\{s, s'\}$ in common upstream demand or downstream supply, respectively. Therefore, these sectors are horizontally connected through a common neighbour sector- s^* : even though $\{s, s'\}$ don't trade directly within the production network, the fact that they both interact with s^* makes them economically connected; this is the “horizontal complementarity” concept.

Part 2: factor input demand and supply distances are generally different.

Let $\{s, s'\} \in \Phi (s)$ and let $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'}$ be a common neighbour. By definition, the network “economic” distance metrics are $d_{s^* \rightarrow} [s, s']$ and $d_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s']$. Unless the trade is symmetric (next part of the proof), that is when $\alpha^{fd} (s, s^*) = \alpha^{fs} (s^*, s) \quad \forall s \in \Phi (s)$, then $d_{s^* \rightarrow} [s, s'] \neq d_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s']$. Extending to all common neighbours $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'}$, it follows that

$$d^{fd} [s, s'] := \left\{ d_{s^* \rightarrow} [s, s'] : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'} \right\} \neq d^{fs} [s, s'] := \left\{ d_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s'] : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'} \right\}$$

The network “economic” distance between two sectors depends on whether one looks at it from the perspective of demand or supply between one sector and the common one, and they usually don't match; these two sets of numbers are different because buying and selling patterns are usually not symmetric. Hence, the same Input-Output structure always generates two distinct factor input demand and factor input supply distance metrics unless trade linkages with common sectors are perfectly symmetric.

Part 3: symmetric interactions imply coinciding distances for at least one common neighbour. Suppose that for some common sector- s^* , the trade is perfectly symmetric: s buys the same relative amount from s^* as it sells to s^* , and same for s' . In other words, if it exists a common $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s, s'}$ such that $\alpha^{fd} (s, s^*) = \alpha^{fs} (s^*, s)$ and $\alpha^{fd} (s', s^*) = \alpha^{fs} (s^*, s')$, then

$$d_{s^* \rightarrow} [s, s'] := f \left(\alpha^{fd} (s, s^*), \alpha^{fd} (s', s^*) \right) = f \left(\alpha^{fs} (s^*, s), \alpha^{fs} (s^*, s') \right) =: d_{\rightarrow s^*} [s, s']$$

and therefore $d^{fd} [s, s'] \cap d^{fs} [s, s'] \neq \emptyset$. In this case, the distance metrics are exactly equal: demand-based distance is the same of the supply-based distance for that neighbour – or distance vectors $\forall s^* \in \Phi (s)$. If two sectors trade symmetrically with a common sector, then their economic distance looks the same whether it is measured by demand or supply. The building intuition is that symmetry in relative trade “aligns” the two perspectives of network “economic” distance, which would otherwise differ.

Finally, it is left to prove the minimum number of sectors required for such coinciding distances to exist. Suppose the economy has S sectors, $\Phi(s) = \{s, s', s'', \dots, S\}$, and consider a sector- s^* acting as the common neighbour. To construct a pair of sectors $\{s, s'\}$ whose factor input demand and supply distances coincide via s^* , it is required: (i) the common neighbour s^* itself, and (ii) at least two distinct sectors s and s' that trade with s^* symmetrically. Now, compare two network sizes.

Three-sector network. Let the sectors be $\{s, s', s^*\} \in \Phi(s)$ with $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s,s'}$, so that the minimum number of sectors is $S = 2 + 1 = 3$. Under trade symmetry, I have already claimed that the two distance metrics coincide: $d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s, s'] = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s']$. But a general condition also asks for an additional symmetric entry between another pair of sectors (distinct from the pair linked by s^*). With only three sectors there is no distinct third pair available that is disjoint from $\{s, s'\}$ and uses a different sector: the only other possible symmetric entries would involve the same sectors $\{s, s', s^*\}$ as well. Therefore, a case with $S = 3$ does not provide an independent additional symmetric entry: any symmetric pair must involve these three sectors and cannot be both an extra independent symmetric pair and keep the structure non-degenerate. Concretely, with $S = 3$ one may obtain a single coinciding distance metric via a common neighbour, but it is not general enough to satisfy the hypothesis requiring a separate additional symmetric entry independent of the same three nodes. Thus, a three-sector network is insufficient to guarantee a general statement of the theorem as formulated.

Bigger network. To allow the existence of an additional symmetric entry between another pair of sectors, at least one more sector is required. Let $\{s, s', s^*, \dots, t\} \in \Phi(s)$ with $s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s,s'}$, and with at least one extra sector- t . Therefore, the absolute minimum network size to guarantee that there exists at least one coinciding distance vector is $S \geq 4$. Usual trade symmetry delivers $d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s, s'] = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s']$. Because there is at least one additional sector- t , it is possible also to impose an additional symmetric entry between some other pair: this additional symmetric entry can be chosen so it is not the same symmetry used at $\{s, s'\}$ and s^* – i.e., it provides a distinct symmetric pair in the network. Thus, both ingredients required by the general theorem can be satisfied in a non-degenerate way when $S \geq 4$: a common neighbour symmetric with (at least) two sectors, and at least one independent symmetric pair elsewhere. In such a way, the network has enough nodes to realize the general hypothesis (common neighbour symmetric with $S - 2$ sectors and a separate symmetric pair), thereby guaranteeing the existence of at least one distance vector that coincides in the constructions of demand and supply distances.

General formulation. Let $\Phi(s)$ be the set of sectors, with $|\Phi(s)| = S$, and let the set of common neighbours of s and s' to be

$$\mathcal{S}_{s,s'} := \left\{ s^* \in \Phi(s) \setminus \{s, s'\} : s^* \text{ is a common neighbour of } s \text{ and } s' \right\}$$

Define the demand- and supply-based network “economic” distance multi sets as $d^{fd}[s, s'] := \left\{ f\left(\alpha^{fd}(s, s^*), \alpha^{fd}(s', s^*)\right) : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s,s'} \right\}$ and, analogously, $d^{fs}[s, s'] := \left\{ f\left(\alpha^{fs}(s^*, s), \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s')\right) : s^* \in \mathcal{S}_{s,s'} \right\}$. Assume it exists a subset $\mathcal{T}_{s,s'} \subseteq \mathcal{S}_{s,s'}$ such that

all sectors in $\mathcal{T}_{s,s'}$ satisfy bilateral symmetry with both $\{s, s'\}$: $\alpha^{fd}(s, s^*) = \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s)$ and $\alpha^{fd}(s', s^*) = \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s')$, $\forall s^* \in \mathcal{T}_{s,s'}$. Then, the set of coinciding distances is

$$\mathcal{C}_{s,s'} := d^{fd}[s, s'] \cap d^{fs}[s, s'] = \left\{ f\left(\alpha^{fd}(s, s^*), \alpha^{fd}(s', s^*)\right) : s^* \in \mathcal{T}_{s,s'} \right\}$$

Thus, $\mathcal{C}_{s,s'} \neq \emptyset$ if $\mathcal{T}_{s,s'} \neq \emptyset$: the demand-based and supply-based distance between two sectors $\{s, s'\}$ coincide if and only if there is at least one sector $s^* \in \mathcal{T}_{s,s'}$ that both trade with symmetrically. For the general statement of the theorem: if $|\mathcal{T}_{s,s'}| \geq S - 2$ and there exists at least one additional symmetric pair $\{s, t\} \in \Phi^2(s)$, then

$$\exists s, s' \in \Phi(s) : \mathcal{C}_{s,s'} \neq \emptyset$$

□

(Proof of Corollary 1 for Theorem 1) The task is to determine how many coinciding distances should appear when $S \geq 4$. Let

$$\mathcal{S}_{|s^*} = \{s, s', \dots, s^m\} \subset \Phi(s) \setminus \{s^*\}, \quad m = S - 2$$

denote the set of sectors that trade symmetrically with the common sector s^* . Symmetry means that for every $s \in \mathcal{S}_{|s^*}$, $\alpha^{fd}(s, s^*) = \alpha^{fs}(s^*, s)$, and similarly for any other directional equality required by the construction of $d^{fd}[\cdot]$ and $d^{fs}[\cdot]$. Recall that these equalities must hold after Input-Output matrix normalization (divide by rows for demand distance, by columns for supply distance). Which distances coincide and how many? For any unordered pair $\{s, s'\} \subset \mathcal{S}_{|s^*}$, the distances defined through the common neighbour s^* satisfy, as usual, $d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s, s'] = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s']$. Thus each unordered pair inside $\mathcal{M}$ generates one coinciding demand- and supply-based network “economic” distance. Now, the idea is to count all pairs of sectors within the set of symmetric neighbours $\mathcal{S}_{|s^*}$ that share the common sector- s^* . Suppose that $\mathcal{S}_{|s^*}$ contains $m = S - 2$ sectors that trade symmetrically with s^* . To find the coinciding distances, I consider unordered pairs $\{s, s^*\} \in \mathcal{S}_{|s^*}$ because each pair corresponds to one entry in the distance matrix (which is symmetric). The number of ways to pick two sectors from among the m -sectors is given by the binomial coefficient $\binom{m}{2} = \frac{m(m-1)}{2}$. It counts all distinct pairs of symmetric neighbours: each pair “shares” the same symmetric relation with the common sector, so that their demand- and supply-based network “economic” distances coincide.⁴² Intuitively, for a common sector symmetric with $S - 2$ neighbours, every unordered pair of those neighbours has matching demand- and supply-based distances, giving $\binom{S-2}{2}$ coinciding distance values; the formula comes from counting all distinct pairs among the $S - 2$ symmetric sectors.

□

⁴² If one sector s^* is symmetric with exactly $m = S - 2$ other sectors, then, for $S = 5$ one gets $\binom{3}{2} = 3$ distinct unordered sector-pairs whose demand- and supply-based distances coincide – equivalently, 6 equal off-diagonal distance matrix entries, since each pair corresponds to (s, s') and (s', s) . In fact, as $m = S - 2 = 3$, then $\binom{m}{2} = \frac{3(3-1)}{2} = \frac{3 \times 2}{2} = 3$.

A.2. Model derivation

(Households problem) The household- i 's utility problem is to maximize utility function subject to its budget constraint:

$$\begin{aligned} \max_{c_i(s), n_i(s)} \quad & \mathcal{U}_i \left(\{c_i(s)\}_{\forall s \in \Phi(s)}; n_i(s) \right) := \prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} c_i(s)^{\beta(s)} - \frac{n_i(s)^{1+\phi}}{1+\phi} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} p(s) c_i(s) = w(s) n_i(s) + \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} D_i(s) \end{aligned}$$

where sectoral consumption and labour supplied are $c_i(s)$ and $n_i(s)$, respectively, and each is determined by a price, $p(s)$ and $w(s)$. Parameter $\beta(s)$ identifies the weight of each sectoral good in household i 's consumption basket and $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \beta(s) = 1$, ϕ is the inverse Frisch labour supply elasticity, measuring the elasticity of hours worked to the wage rate under a constant marginal utility of income. Finally, $D_i(s)$ is the constant share of sector-specific profits flowing from sector- s to household- i .

Utility maximization implies the Lagrangian function to be

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}_{c_i(s), n_i(s)} &:= \prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} c_i(s)^{\beta(s)} - \frac{n_i(s)^{1+\phi}}{1+\phi} + \\ &- \psi^{\mathcal{L}} \left[\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} p(s) c_i(s) - \left(w(s) n_i(s) + \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} D_i(s) \right) \right] \end{aligned}$$

with $\psi^{\mathcal{L}}$ being the penalty multiplier. Optimality conditions are in order

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{p(s) c_i(s)}{\beta(s)} &= \frac{p(s') c_i(s')}{\beta(s')} \\ w(s) &= n_i(s)^{\phi} p(s) c_i(s) [\beta(s) c_i(s)]^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

which, once aggregated across all households, $\frac{p(s) \int_i c_i(s) di}{\beta(s)} = \frac{p(s') \int_i c_i(s') di}{\beta(s')}$ and $w(s) = \int_i n_i(s)^{\phi} di p(s) \int_i c_i(s) di [\beta(s) \int_i c_i di]^{-1}$, would report the optimality conditions for consumption and labour supply in Section 2.

□

(Sectoral optimization) A perfectly competitive representative firm in sector- s maximizes total revenues from production net of costs of inputs of production:

$$\begin{aligned} \max_{n(s), x(s, s')} \quad & y(s) = z(s) \left(n(s) \right)^{\alpha(s)} \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left(x(s, s') \right)^{\alpha(s, s')} \varkappa_j(s) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \mathcal{C}(s) := w(s) n(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} p(s') x(s, s') \end{aligned}$$

where $\alpha(s) + \sum_{s'} \alpha(s, s') = 1$, and $\varkappa_d(s) = 1$ for $j = \{fd, fs\}$. Profit maximization then implies

$$\max_{n(s), x(s,s')} D(s) := p(s)y(s) - C(s)$$

Optimality conditions for demand of intermediate inputs and labour demand, and their combination, are those in Section 2. □

(Equilibrium characterization) In equilibrium, the model should specify the clearing conditions of labour, circulating intermediate inputs, and goods markets. Starting from the labour market, equating labour demand and labour supply would deliver the labour market equilibrium condition, $n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) y(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}}$, i.e., eq. (5) in Section 2. Moreover, total labour demand is found by aggregating labour optimality condition of sectors, $N^{dem} = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} n^{dem}(s)$, and total labour supply is found by aggregating labour optimality condition of households, $N^{sup} = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} n^{sup}(s)$. Labour market clearing then requires that $N^{dem} = N^{sup}$.

For what concerns equilibrium in the circulating intermediate inputs market, total demand of intermediates from sectors is $x^{dem}(s) = \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s, s')$. Analogously, its total supply of intermediate inputs is $x^{sup}(s) = \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s', s)$ so that, in equilibrium it must be true that $x^{dem}(s) = x^{sup}(s)$ which, in aggregate, simply states that $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} x^{dem}(s) = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} x^{sup}(s) \equiv X^{sup} = X^{dem}$.

The equilibrium in the good market is given by summing over all sectors the sectoral equilibrium in which total production must equal its total final consumption (by households) and its circulating intermediate input bought by other sectors: $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} y(s) = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\int_i c_i(s) di \right) + \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s, s') \right)$.

Finally, by aggregating the households' budget constraints over households and sectors, and imposing the clearing conditions so far, the aggregate resource constraint for this economy reads as

$$P^c C = WN + D$$

which equals total output, defined by $Y \propto \beta_s Y$ of Section 1. Equilibrium conditions are described in Section 2. □

(Derive aggregate fluctuations result of eq. (6)) Following exactly the same operating steps in vom Lehn and Winberry (2022), to characterize the dynamical changes in aggregate Gross Domestic Product (GDP), first it is necessary to determine the existing relation between sectoral intermediate output, $y(s)$, and the Divisia Index.⁴³

⁴³ This indicator provides a theoretically consistent measure of growth. It is a composite index, particularly suited to analyse variables made of multiple and differentiated elements, measuring changes in certain aggregate quantity of a given variable, and weighting all its defining components according to their relevance on that variable, that is it expresses the overall rate of output change as a weighted average of the growth rates

Notice that constant returns to scale and homogeneity of degree one in Assumption 1 and in the production function in eq. (4) implies the following zero-profit condition

$$p(s)y(s) = w(s)n(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} p(s')x(s, s')$$

where $p(s)y(s)$ is the (gross) nominal output of sector- s , and from where the national accounting definition of nominal value added is just $p(s)y(s) - p^s x^s = w(s)n(s)$, where I define $p^s x^s = \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} p(s')x(s, s')$ the total expenditure of sector- s for intermediate inputs from other connected sectors. Define the left-hand side of the previous equation as $p^Y(s)y^Y(s) \equiv p(s)y(s) - p^s x^s$, i.e., the nominal value-added.

In order to construct a single, aggregate measure of real output (or value added) across multiple sectors, I use a Divisia index. This index combines the growth rates of individual sectoral outputs into an overall growth rate, but does so in a way that accounts for each sector's economic importance – measured by its share in total nominal value added. Specifically, the Divisia index computes a weighted average of the growth rates of sectoral real outputs, where the weights are each sector's share in total nominal value added. This allows us to track how the economy's output is changing over time, adjusting dynamically as the composition of output across sectors evolves.

Henceforth, the Divisia Index requires to differentiate the nominal value added under constant price levels associated to variables:

$$\begin{aligned} p^Y(s) d \log y^Y(s) &= p(s) d \log y(s) - p^s d \log x^s \\ \rightarrow p^Y(s) y^Y(s) d \log y^Y(s) &= p(s) y(s) d \log y(s) - p^s x^s d \log x^s \\ \rightarrow \alpha(s) d \log y^Y(s) &= d \log y(s) - \alpha^s d \log x^s \\ \rightarrow \alpha(s) d \log y^Y(s) &= \left(d \log z(s) + \alpha(s) d \log n(s) + \alpha^s d \log x^s \right) - \alpha^s d \log x^s \\ \rightarrow d \log y^Y(s) &= \frac{1}{\alpha(s)} d \log z(s) + d \log n(s) \end{aligned}$$

where $\alpha^s = \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s')$. Plug the above sector-level nominal value added growth, $d \log y^Y(s)$, into the Divisia Index, $d \log Y = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{p^Y(s)y^Y(s)}{P^Y Y} \right) d \log y^Y(s)$, so that it is possible to obtain a non-complete equation for real GDP growth:

$$d \log Y = \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{p^Y(s)y^Y(s)}{P^Y Y} \right) \left[\frac{1}{\alpha(s)} d \log z(s) + d \log n(s) \right] \quad (\text{A.3})$$

Summing over all sectors the sectoral optimality conditions for intermediate in-

of individual components, with time-varying weights corresponding to each component's share in total output. Conceptually, it captures the notion that aggregate GDP growth reflects both the differential growth of its components and their evolving relative importance within the economy. This formulation offers an improvement over fixed-weight indices by accommodating structural changes in the composition of economic activity over time. Refer to Oulton (2022) for further details.

puts, $\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s, s') = \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') [p(s) y(s)] (p(s'))^{-1}$, noticing that $\alpha(s) = 1 - \alpha^s$, and inserting the zero-profit condition would yield $\alpha(s) = \frac{p^Y(s) y^Y(s)}{p(s) y(s)}$, which is the ratio of sectoral value-added to sectoral intermediate (gross) output.

By plugging into the eq. (A.3) the condition for $\alpha(s)$, and making all the adjustments to simplify the elements multiplying the sectoral productivity it is then possible to get eq. (6), which determines the drivers of real aggregate GDP fluctuations. $\square$

(Derive labour market equilibrium of eqs. (10) and (12)) Start from the sector-level equilibrium definition of the labour market, $n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) y(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}}$. Including the condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$ would imply eq. (8), that is

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) z(s) \left(n(s) \right)^{\alpha(s)} \prod_{s' \neq s} \left(\vartheta(s, s') y(s') \right)^{\alpha(s, s')} \kappa_j(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}} \quad (\text{A.4})$$

where it should be inserted the production function of eq. (4) for sector- s' , and $\kappa_j(s) \neq 1$, with $j = \{fd, fs\}$, for the purpose of this derivation. The resulting equation can be simplified by imposing an infinite inverse Frisch elasticity of labour, $\phi \rightarrow \infty$. In fact, in the model of Section 2, only the extensive margin of employment (i.e., total number of workers) is important, while it is not the intensive margin (i.e., total hours worked), which is ruled out under $\phi \rightarrow \infty$; refer to Rogerson (1988). However, for the sake of generality, I will proceed with $\phi \in [0, \infty)$.

Factor input demand.— Assume the non-common (constant) element in the production function to be given by⁴⁴

⁴⁴ In eq. (A.5), the component $\tau_{fd}(s) = \Pi_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\Pi_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s, s)} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s)}} \right]^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s, s')}}$ allows to ensure that, in Section

2.2, the distance effects are not influenced by the Leontief inverse weight. Specifically, incorporating the condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$ in the labour market equilibrium of eq. (A.4) would result in a double counting of the values from the Input-Output matrix: one of them is used to capture sectoral distances, while the other would have been multiplied by distance matrix $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ when analysing the effect of sectoral propagation in Proposition 5. Within this context, it is essential to highlight that, starting from the baseline labour market equilibrium in eq. (5), and deriving the results presented in this section and in Proposition 5 without including the exogenous condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$ would produce an outcome reflecting the effect of network distances *without* the influence of the Input-Output Leontief inverse weights. In other words, as discussed in the main text (Theorem 2), the effect of the network “economic” distance across pairs of sectors is independent of inter-sectoral trade intensities characterizing the production network; imposing the $\tau_{fd}(s)$ term due to the condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$ allows to avoid that such concept is violated. Otherwise, without $\tau_{fd}(s)$, the component Ξ^{fd} in eq. (10) would be equal to

$$\Xi^{fd} = \prod_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\prod_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s, s)} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s)}} \right]^{\alpha(s, s')}$$

Analogous is the rationale beyond component $\tau_{fs}(s) = \Pi_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\Pi_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s', s')} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s', s')}} \right]^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s', s')}}$, proper of eq.

$$\varkappa_{fd}(s) = \tau_{fd}(s) \prod_{s'} \left[\frac{\Pi_s x(s', s)^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s, s)} + \alpha(s', s)}}{\Pi_s x(s, s)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s)}}} \right]^{\frac{\alpha(s, s')}{1+\phi}} \quad (\text{A.5})$$

Then, multiply and divide both sides of the above labour market equilibrium, including the production function, by $\Pi_{s'} \left\{ \left[\Pi_s x(s', s)^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s, s)}} \right] / \left[\Pi_s x(s, s)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s, s)}} \right] \right\}^{\frac{\alpha(s, s')}{1+\phi}}$. Finally, making all the required adjustments once including $\varkappa_{fd}(s)$, the resulting condition will deliver eq. (10). All the multiplications are over $\Phi(s)$.

Factor input supply.– Assume now the non-common (constant) element in the production function to be given by

$$\varkappa_{fs}(s) = \tau_{fs}(s) \prod_{s'} \left[\frac{\Pi_s x(s', s)^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s, s)}}}{\Pi_{s'} x(s', s')^{\frac{\alpha(s', s')}{\alpha(s', s')}} - \alpha(s', s')} \right]^{\alpha(s, s')} \quad (\text{A.6})$$

Multiply and divide both sides of the above labour market equilibrium, including the production function, by $\Pi_{s'} \left\{ \left[\Pi_s x(s', s)^{\frac{1}{\alpha(s', s')}} \right] / \left[\Pi_{s'} x(s', s')^{\frac{\alpha(s', s')}{\alpha(s', s')}} \right] \right\}^{\frac{\alpha(s, s')}{1+\phi}}$. Making all the required adjustments once including $\varkappa_{fs}(s)$, the resulting condition will deliver eq. (12). All the multiplications are over $\Phi(s)$. □

A.3. Proofs for theoretical results on distance-based propagation

(Proof of Proposition 3) The interest is in characterizing the way in which sectoral employment changes in response to variations in sector-specific intermediate inputs usage. In order to inspect these changes, it is necessary to express the equilibrium conditions in terms of log-linear conditions. Starting from the sector- s labour market equilibrium of eq. (5), i.e.,

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) y(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}}$$

the associated log-linear form is $\tilde{n}(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \tilde{y}(s) + \tilde{C} - \tilde{c}(s) \right\}$, with tilded variables, $\tilde{\cdot}$, expressing the deviation from their respective steady state. Such log-linearized equation contains the log-linearized output, obtained by log-differentiating the pro-

(A.6) that delivers Proposition 6. Avoiding to consider it, the component Ξ^{fs} in eq. (12) is

$$\Xi^{fs} = \Pi_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left[\prod_{s \in \Phi(s')} \left(\frac{x(s', s)}{x(s', s')} \right)^{\frac{\alpha(s', s)}{\alpha(s', s')}} \right]^{\alpha(s, s')}.$$

duction function in eq. (4): $\tilde{y}(s) = \tilde{z}(s) + \alpha(s) \tilde{n}(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \tilde{x}(s, s')$. Substituting out these two equations, one easily gets that log-linearized sectoral employment is a function of

$$\tilde{n}(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \tilde{z}(s) + \alpha(s) \tilde{n}(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \tilde{x}(s, s') + \tilde{C} - \tilde{c}(s) \right\}$$

expressing the elements whose variations induce changes in employment level of sector- s . In vectorial notation, one can rewrite the summation as

$$\tilde{n}(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \tilde{z}(s) + \alpha(s) \tilde{n}(s) + \mathbf{h}(s) \tilde{\mathbf{x}}(s) + \tilde{C} - \tilde{c}(s) \right\}$$

which, stacked over all sectors can be written in matrix form:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{N}} = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \tilde{\mathbf{C}} - \tilde{\mathbf{C}} + \tilde{\mathbf{z}} + \boldsymbol{\alpha} \tilde{\mathbf{N}} + \mathbf{H}' \tilde{\mathbf{X}} \right\}$$

where $\tilde{\mathbf{N}}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of changes in sector-specific employment levels, identifies changes in aggregate consumption, $\tilde{\mathbf{C}}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of changes in sector-specific final consumption by households, $\tilde{\mathbf{z}}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of changes in sectoral productivities, $\mathbf{H}$ is an $S \times S$ squared Input-Output matrix identifying the structure of intersectoral trade, and $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of changes in sector-specific set of intermediate inputs bought within the production network. Finally, ϕ is a scalar for aggregate inverse Frisch elasticity of labour supply to wage level, and $\boldsymbol{\alpha} = [\alpha(s), \alpha(s'), \dots, \alpha(S)]$ comprises sector-specific labour force as a share of its intermediate output.

Bringing the vector of sectoral employments, $\tilde{\mathbf{N}}$, on the left-hand side, then rewriting $\tilde{\cdot} = d \log(\cdot)$, and rearranging terms, then one obtains eq. (7) in Proposition 3. $\square$

(Proof of Proposition 4) The interest is in characterizing the way in which sectoral employment changes in response to variations in other sectors' employment levels. In order to inspect these changes, it is necessary to express the equilibrium conditions in terms of log-linear conditions. Starting from the sector- s labour market equilibrium of eq. (5), i.e.,

$$n(s) = \left[\alpha(s) \frac{C}{c(s)} \beta(s) y(s) \right]^{\frac{1}{1+\phi}}$$

the associated log-linear form is $\tilde{n}(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \tilde{y}(s) + \tilde{C} - \tilde{c}(s) \right\}$, with tilded variables, $\tilde{\cdot}$, expressing the deviation from their respective steady state. Then, use the condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$, which states that each intermediate input is just a given share $\vartheta(s, s')$ of other sector's output. Inserting its log-linearized form $\tilde{x}(s, s') = \tilde{y}(s')$, together with the log-differentiation of the production function in eq. (4), $\tilde{y}(s) = \tilde{z}(s) + \alpha(s) \tilde{n}(s) + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \tilde{x}(s, s')$, into the log-linear condition for labour market equilibrium one gets

$$\tilde{n}(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \begin{aligned} &\tilde{C} - \tilde{c}(s) + \tilde{z}(s) + \alpha(s) \tilde{n}(s) + \\ &+ \sum_{s' \in \Phi_s} \alpha(s, s') \left[\tilde{z}(s') + \alpha(s') \tilde{n}(s') + \sum_{s \in \Phi_{s'}} \alpha(s', s) \tilde{x}(s', s) \right] \end{aligned} \right\}$$

expressing the elements whose variations induce changes in employment level of sector- s . Note that using the above condition $x(s, s') = \vartheta(s, s') y(s')$ implies that summations are not over the whole set of sectors, but rather it should be excluded the sector whose one is summing for. To this aim, denote $\Phi(s)$ the set of all sectors; then, both Φ_s and $\Phi_{s'}$ denotes improper subsets of $\Phi(s)$, since they are excluding sector- s and sector- s' , respectively. In other words, all the elements in $\{\Phi_s, \Phi_{s'}\}$ are contained in $\Phi(s)$ but $\{\Phi_s, \Phi_{s'}\}$ and $\Phi(s)$ are not equal, $\Phi_s \subseteq \Phi(s)$ with $\Phi_s \subsetneq \Phi(s)$, and $\Phi_{s'} \subseteq \Phi(s)$ with $\Phi_{s'} \subsetneq \Phi(s)$. This implies that, when stacking the above condition over all sectors expressing it in matrix notation, the Input-Output matrix from $\alpha(s, s')$ and $\alpha(s', s)$ are not full but rather are set to zero whenever $s = s'$, i.e., using the $\Psi_{s, s'}$ as a matrix indicator.

Using such notation, and expressing the above log-linearized labour market equation in vectorial form and then in matrix form (as in the Proof of Proposition 3), and solving for $d \log n(s)$, one obtains eq. (9) of Proposition 4. □

(Proof of Proposition 5) The interest is in characterizing the way in which sectoral employment changes in response to variations in other sectors' employment levels according to their factor input demand network distance relationships. Taking the logarithm of eq. (10) would result in

$$\log n(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \begin{aligned} &\log \alpha(s) + \log C + \log z(s) + \alpha(s) \log n(s) - \log c(s) + \\ &+ \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \left[\log \vartheta(s, s') + \log z(s') + \alpha(s') \log n(s') \right] + \\ &+ \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \left\{ \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s', s) \log x(s', s) \right\} + \log \beta(s) + \\ &+ \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \left\{ \frac{\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s', s)}{\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s)} \log \left(\frac{\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} x(s', s)}{\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} x(s, s)} \right) \right\} \end{aligned} \right\}$$

Inserting the condition in eq. (A.1) used to derive Lemma 1 in the $\log[\cdot]$ component in the last row, compute the associate total differentiation, following closely the steps to derive Proposition 4, and using the notation associated to network distance matrix $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$, then one obtains eq. (11) characterizing Proposition 5. □

(Proof of Proposition 6) The interest is in characterizing the way in which sectoral employment changes in response to variations in other sectors' employment levels according to their factor input supply network distance relationships. Taking the logarithm of eq. (12) would result in

$$\log n(s) = \frac{1}{1+\phi} \left\{ \begin{aligned} & \log \alpha(s) + \log C + \log z(s) + \alpha(s) \log n(s) - \log c(s) \quad + \\ & + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \left[\log \vartheta(s, s') + \log z(s') + \alpha(s') \log n(s') \right] \quad + \\ & + \sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s, s') \left\{ \sum_{s'' \in \Phi(s')} \alpha(s', s'') \log x(s', s'') \right\} + \log \beta(s) \quad + \\ & + \sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \left\{ \frac{\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s', s)}{\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} \alpha(s', s')} \log \left[\frac{\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s', s)}{\sum_{s' \in \Phi(s)} x(s', s')} \right] \right\} \end{aligned} \right\}$$

Inserting the condition in eq. (A.2) used to derive Lemma 2 in the $\log[\cdot]$ component in the last row, compute the associate total differentiation, following closely the steps to derive Proposition 4, and using the notation associated to network distance matrix $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$, then one obtains eq. (13) characterizing Proposition 6. □

(Proof of Theorem 2) This part provides a purely intuition-driven mathematical proof of Theorem 2, as it relies on a structural distinction between horizontal and vertical operators on production. In this sense, the theorem is proved as a “structural impossibility result”. I then provide some elements for the proof.

Economic intuition as a mathematical principle. The economic intuition underlying Theorem 2 can be summarized as follows: horizontal interactions capture network similarity across peers (shared upstream suppliers and downstream buyers), whereas vertical interactions capture production inputs flows along idiosyncratic supply chains. Economically, horizontal effects operate within a layer of the production network, while vertical effects operate across layers. Mathematically, this implies that

“horizontal effects depend on similarity of local neighbourhoods, whereas vertical effects depend on paths of arbitrary length”.

Theorem 2 is therefore a structural statement: operators that measure similarity of neighbourhoods cannot be weighted by operators that aggregate along paths.

Minimal graph-theoretic setup. Let $G = (n, E)$ be a finite directed weighted graph with n , representing the number of nodes in the network, and $E = \{(i, j) \in n \times n : \alpha_{ij} > 0\}$ is the set of directed edges representing non-zero linkages between nodes. Let $\mathbf{H} = [\alpha_{ij}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ denote the adjacency (Input-Output) matrix of G , with α_{ij} representing the inputs that node- i sources from node- j . When the spectral radius $\rho(\mathbf{H}) < 1$, the Leontief inverse $\mathcal{H} := (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{H})^{-1}$ exists. Production is sequential at the k -th round of input requirements, $\mathbf{H} \equiv \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathbf{H}^k$ and $\mathcal{H} \equiv \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathcal{H}^k$.

Then, the need is to define what horizontal and vertical operators are. Matrix $\mathcal{D} = [d_{ij}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is called an “horizontal (distance) operator” if $d_{ij} = \varphi(\alpha_{\cdot i}, \alpha_{\cdot j})$, where

$\alpha_{\cdot i}$ denotes the immediate neighbourhood of node- i (common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers, that is the entire input shares / sales of node- i), and φ is a function that depends only on the overlap or similarity of these neighbourhoods (i.e., a fixed similarity or distance functional): horizontal effects are thus defined as finite-profile (column / row) dependence.⁴⁵ Differently, vertical effects are fundamentally different from profile comparison and involve repeated application of $\mathbf{V} = \{\mathbf{H}, \mathbf{H}\}$. Indeed, an operator is called “vertical” if it aggregates information along paths of length greater than or equal to one, as it depends on recursive compositions of the Input-Output matrix – i.e., if it can be written as $\sum_{k \geq 1} \mathbf{V}^k \mathbf{A}$ for some non-negative matrix $\mathbf{A}$. The network matrix indicator $\mathbf{V}$ is the canonical vertical operator: it sums contributions from all (directed and undirected) paths in the network, thereby aggregating the effects of shocks along all production chains of arbitrary length: vertical effects are thus defined as recursive composition of production technologies.

Locality versus propagation. Here is the mathematical statement. In particular, through a series of lemmas, I am going to define the nature of both vertical and horizontal anatomies, and then prove the theorem by contradiction.

LEMMA 3 (Locality of horizontal operators) If a certain horizontal entry is $d_{ij} = \varphi(\alpha_{\cdot i}, \alpha_{\cdot j})$, then horizontal matrix $\mathcal{D}$ depends only on a finite-dimensional representation of $\mathbf{V}$ and does not involve recursive application of $\mathbf{V}$.

Proof: each entry d_{ij} is constructed from the vectors $\alpha_{\cdot i}$ and $\alpha_{\cdot j}$ through a fixed functional φ . No term involves powers $\mathbf{V}^k$ with $k \geq 2$, nor any infinite series.

LEMMA 4 (Non-locality of the Input-Output weights) Any vertical operator involving $\mathbf{V}$ depends on all powers $\mathbf{V}^k$, for $k \geq 0$.

Proof: by definition, $\mathbf{V} \equiv \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathbf{V}^k$. Each power $\mathbf{V}^k$ represents k -fold composition of technologies. Hence, any object involving $\mathbf{V}$ depends on recursively propagated Input-Output relations.

LEMMA 5 (Incompatibility) No local operator contains a global path operator.

Proof: assume by contradiction that a local operator $\mathcal{D}$ could be written as an equilibrium object $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{V}' \tilde{\mathcal{D}}$ for some $\tilde{\mathcal{D}}$, so that horizontal effects enter the equilibrium multiplied by the Input-Output weights.⁴⁶ By contrast, given the non-locality of $\mathbf{V}$, the object $\mathbf{B}$ depends on arbitrarily long production paths on all recursive compositions $\mathbf{V}^k$, besides the local neighbourhood similarity of $\mathcal{D}$. Then, $\mathbf{B}$ would inherit the non-local dependence of $\mathbf{V}$, contradicting the locality established above: by the incompatibility lemma, such a representation is impossible.

⁴⁵ Horizontal distances therefore depend on *finite-dimensional technological profiles*. They compare how two sectors source inputs (or sell outputs), but they do not involve repeated application of the Input-Output matrix.

⁴⁶ By construction, each entry of $\mathcal{D}$ depends only on finite-dimensional technological profiles $\{\alpha_{\cdot i}, \alpha_{\cdot j}\}$. Therefore, $\mathbf{V}' \tilde{\mathcal{D}}$ depends on recursive compositions of production technologies, while $\tilde{\mathcal{D}}$ itself depends only on static comparisons of production technologies. However, horizontal effects arise from substitutability across technologies, not from iterated production chains: there is no economic or algebraic mechanism that generates higher-order compositions of $\mathbf{V}$ inside φ . As a result, $\mathbf{V}' \tilde{\mathcal{D}}$ cannot arise from the equilibrium derivation.

A re-written version of the incompatibility lemma delivers **Theorem 2**: horizontal distance operators cannot be multiplicatively weighted by the Input-Output weights.

Characterizing intuition. Turning to a conceptual part of the proof, it is essential to recall that the horizontal dimension of the network, as captured by its network “economic” distances, is not confined to sectors already connected – directly or indirectly – through inter-sectoral trade. Rather, it also encompasses sectors without such direct or indirect linkages, which are nonetheless related through similar demand or supply relationships arising from common upstream suppliers or downstream buyers, as discussed in Subsection 1.4 and elaborated throughout the main text. This reasoning implies that certain sectors may exhibit a strictly positive distance linkage despite the absence of any Input-Output connection. In other words, considers two sectors, say $\{s, s'\}$, with zero (direct and Leontief inverse) inter-sectoral trade intensity – $\alpha(s, s') = \alpha(s', s) = 0$ and $\ell(s, s') = \ell(s', s) = 0$ –, held together by their demand / supply relationship with a common sector, say s^* , so that $d_{s^* \rightarrow}[s', s''] = d_{\rightarrow s^*}[s', s''] > 0$. In this case, the Input-Output matrix and the distance matrix would be given by $\mathbf{H} \equiv \mathcal{H} = \begin{bmatrix} \cdot & 0 \\ 0 & \cdot \end{bmatrix}$ and $\mathcal{D}^j = \begin{bmatrix} \cdot & > 0 \\ > 0 & \cdot \end{bmatrix}$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$. Accordingly, multiplying the distance matrix by the production network matrix would effectively neutralise the role of network distances. This is the rationale underpinning **Theorem 2**. □

(Corollary to Theorem 2) To make the result transparent to a broader theory, I now reformulate the “structural impossibility” argument to prove **Theorem 2** using: (i) the language of Spectral Graph theory; and (ii) Green’s functions / resolvent operators.

Spectral Graph theory interpretation. In Spectral Graph theory, powers of the adjacency matrix $\mathbf{V}^k$ encode walks of length- $k \in [0, \infty)$ on the network, and is therefore a global spectral object sensitive to the full eigenvalue distribution of $\mathbf{V}$. Horizontal distance operators, by contrast, are kernel operators defined on the space of columns (or rows) of $\mathbf{V}$. They depend only on first-order technological profiles and do not involve eigenvalue amplification or long-run diffusion. **Theorem 2** therefore states that a kernel on the column / row space of $\mathbf{V}$ cannot be composed multiplicatively with the resolvent of $\mathbf{V}$ without changing its mathematical nature.

Green’s functions and resolvents. The Input-Output indicator $\mathbf{V}$ is the Green’s function (or resolvent) associated to a linear operator. It solves propagation problems of the form $\mathbf{V}'\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x}$, by transmitting shocks through all production chains. An horizontal operator $\mathcal{D}$ is not a Green’s function. They do not solve propagation problems and do not correspond to inverses of linear operators. Instead, they define a metric or similarity structure on the space of technologies. From this perspective, **Theorem 2** asserts that a metric kernel on technologies (horizontal geometry) cannot appear inside a Green’s function propagator (i.e., a vertical production dynamics). The two objects live in distinct mathematical categories: one is a similarity kernel, the other a resolvent of a linear operator. □

B. SUFFICIENT STATISTICS FOR SECTORAL COMOVEMENT

B.1. Factor Input Demand network distance

Analytical conditions for sufficient statistics under which demand-based network distances between sectors generate negative comovement highlight as key driver the interaction between (i) the elasticity of substitution across intermediate inputs, and (ii) the upstream sector's price response to demand shocks. The derivation covers both the single-input case and the more general setting in which buyer sectors aggregate multiple intermediate inputs via a Constant Elasticity of Substitution (CES) function, illustrating how substitution elasticities and upstream price pass-through jointly determine the sign and magnitude of the induced responses to downstream demand shocks.⁴⁷ Formal proofs and economic intuitions are provided.

Derivation of the Sufficient Statistic

Consider a buyer sector- s that demands an intermediate input supplied by an upstream sector- s^* . The buyer's technology follows a CES aggregator with elasticity of substitution $\sigma > 0$. From cost minimization, the log-demand elasticity of the intermediate with respect to its own price is given by $\frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log p(s^*)} = -\sigma$. Suppose a shock in sector- s' increases demand for the input produced by s^* . Let the upstream price respond according to $\frac{\partial \log p(s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)} = \tau^{fd}$. By the chain rule, the effect of the demand shock on sector- s 's input demand is then

$$\underbrace{\frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)}}_{\delta_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']}} = -(\sigma \cdot \tau^{fd}) \quad (\text{B.1})$$

Thus, the sign of the comovement depends on the product $\sigma \cdot \tau^{fd}$. If $\sigma \cdot \tau^{fd} > 0$, the comovement is negative. This condition serves as a **sufficient statistic** for identifying negative comovement in demand-based distances, and the mechanism operates through two key channels: (i) the price channel, where a shock to sector- s' increases demand for inputs from s^* and, if upstream supply is inelastic, the price $p(s^*)$ rises, so that $\tau^{fd} > 0$; and (ii) the substitution channel, where the buyer sector- s responds by substituting away from the now more expensive input, and the magnitude of this effect depends on the elasticity of substitution σ .

The above expression captures a marginal elasticity, i.e., the infinitesimal log-response of sector- s 's conditional demand for the input of s^* with respect to a small perturbation transmitted via the upstream pass-through τ^{fd} . It does not describe the

⁴⁷ The single-input case considers each sector as purchasing intermediate inputs from only one upstream supplier, with no substitution possibilities. In this benchmark, a shock in one sector that affects the upstream supplier propagates vertically, and any resulting negative comovement in downstream sectors depends solely on the upstream price pass-through. The multi-input CES case generalizes this setup by allowing sectors to source from multiple suppliers, with the elasticity of substitution σ determining the magnitude of reallocation away from the affected input. Here, the negative comovement emerges only when substitution and expenditure shares align with the upstream price effect, thereby illustrating the interplay and potential ambiguity between vertical and horizontal propagation channels in production networks.

global reallocation of demand after a finite shock. In particular, $\sigma = 1$ corresponds to the Cobb-Douglas case, not to a corner solution: the effect remains finite and negative, reflecting that sector- s marginally substitutes away from s^* , but never shifts all of its purchases. Complete reallocation can only occur in extreme cases (e.g., $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$, where intermediate inputs are perfect substitutes) or when analysing large shocks beyond the range of the linearization, in which case the log-derivative approximation breaks down.⁴⁸ Hence, for finite σ the formula correctly implies a finite marginal adjustment, while corner solutions require either infinite elasticity or a fully non-linear analysis of the exact CES demand system.

When both effects are active (positive τ^{fd} and sizeable σ), sector- s reduces demand, creating negative comovement with the shocked sector. This sufficient statistic captures the interplay between substitution and upstream constraints, providing a tractable criterion to guide both theoretical and empirical work.

Extending the set-up: multi-intermediate input CES aggregator

Consider a downstream sector- s that buys a finite set of intermediate inputs supplied by upstream sectors. Let the composite intermediate input be a CES aggregator:

$$x(s) = \left(\sum_{s^* \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s, s^*)^{\frac{1}{\sigma}} x(s, s^*)^{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma}} \right)^{\frac{\sigma}{\sigma-1}}$$

where $x(s, s^*)$ is the quantity of the intermediate supplied by upstream sector- s^* used by downstream buyer- s , while $\lambda(s, s^*) \in (0, 1)$ are share parameters, and $\sigma > 0$ is the (constant) elasticity of substitution across intermediate inputs.

Define the associated (unit) price index for the composite intermediate by the usual CES formula, $P(s) = \left(\sum_{s^* \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s, s^*) p(s^*)^{1-\sigma} \right)^{\frac{1}{1-\sigma}}$, where $p(s^*)$ is the price of the intermediate supplied by upstream sector- s^* .

Under cost minimization, for a given level of composite intermediate $X(s)$, the conditional demand for intermediate input s^* is given by the standard CES demand system. Define the expenditure share of variety s^* in the composite intermediate by $e(s, s^*) = \frac{\lambda(s, s^*) p(s^*)^{1-\sigma}}{\sum_{s^* \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s, s^*) p(s^*)^{1-\sigma}}$, with $\sum_{s^* \in \Phi(s)} e(s, s^*) = 1$. A well-known property of the CES demand system is the (log) price elasticities for conditional demands:

$$\frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log p(s^*)} = -\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \quad (\text{B.2})$$

$$\frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log p(s^{**})} = \sigma e(s, s^{**}), \quad \forall s^{**} \neq s^* \quad (\text{B.3})$$

Conditions (B.2)-(B.3) are standard results for CES demand systems: the former, own-price elasticity depends on the substitution parameter and on the expenditure

⁴⁸ Below, in the multi-input CES system, the presence of expenditure shares $e(s, s^*)$ attenuates the response: the own-price elasticity is $-\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)]$, so that large shares dampen substitution.

share, while the latter, cross-price elasticity is proportional to the share of the other intermediate input considered.

Shock propagation through a common supplier.– Focus on a particular upstream sector- s^* that supplies an intermediate used by several downstream buyers. Consider an idiosyncratic positive demand shock in some sector- s' that increases aggregate demand for the good produced by s^* . Let $x(s', s^*)$ denote the demand shifter (or demand level) associated with the shocked sector- s' from sector- s^* .

Assume the upstream price of the good produced by s^* responds to the shock according to a (log) pass-through parameter $\tau^{fd} = \frac{\partial \log p(s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)}$ of demand changes into prices. If $\tau^{fd} > 0$, the common supplier's price rises when downstream demand increases; if $\tau^{fd} < 0$, demand shocks lower prices; when $\tau^{fd} \approx 0$, upstream supply is effectively perfectly elastic at the relevant margin.

The interest is in the log-response of buyer sector- s 's demand for the intermediate supplied by s^* , i.e., $\partial \log x(s, s^*) / \partial \log x(s', s^*)$. By the chain rule, and noting that only $p(s^*)$ changes in response to the shock (holding other upstream prices fixed in this partial equilibrium exercise), one obtains

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)} &= \frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log p(s^*)} \cdot \frac{\partial \log p(s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)} \\ &= \frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log p(s^*)} \cdot \tau^{fd} \end{aligned}$$

Using the CES own-price elasticity in eq. (B.2) for sector- s^* , whose expenditure share is $e(s, s^*)$:

$$\underbrace{\frac{\partial \log x(s, s^*)}{\partial \log x(s', s^*)}}_{\delta_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']}} = -\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \tau^{fd} \quad (\text{B.4})$$

Equation (B.4) makes three points: (i) the elasticity of substitution, σ , magnifies the response – the larger σ , the stronger buyer s substitutes away from an input whose price rises; (ii) the expenditure share, $e(s, s^*)$, attenuates the own-price effect – if buyer s spends only a small fraction on the input from s^* , then $[1 - e(s, s^*)] \approx 1$ and the full $-\sigma$ factor operates, while if the share is large, the own-price sensitivity is mechanically smaller in magnitude; and (iii) the upstream pass-through, τ^{fd} , transmits the original downstream demand shock into a price change at the supplier – without such pass-through ($\tau^{fd} = 0$) the substitution channel vanishes.

Hence the sign of the log-response in eq. (B.4) is the sign of $-\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \tau^{fd}$. Because $\sigma > 0$ and $1 - e(s, s^*) > 0$ (for an interior share), the sign is governed by τ^{fd} : if $\tau^{fd} > 0$ (upstream price rises) and $\sigma > 0$, buyer s reduces its demand for s^* 's input, thereby delivering negative comovement; by contrast, if $\tau^{fd} \approx 0$ (perfectly elastic upstream supply), the price channel is absent and do not expect negative comovement via this substitution mechanism.

Sufficient-statistic condition (multi-input case).– Combining the above, a convenient sufficient-statistic condition for negative comovement of buyer s 's usage of the intermediate produced by s^* (and plausibly of buyer s 's employment if that input

matters for labour demand) following a positive shock in sector- s' is

$$-\underbrace{\sigma}_{\text{elasticity}} \times \underbrace{[1 - e(s, s^*)]}_{\text{residual expenditure share}} \times \underbrace{\tau^{fd}}_{\text{upstream pass-through}} < 0 \quad (\text{B.5})$$

Equivalently, because $\sigma(1 - e(s, s^*)) > 0$ for interior shares, negative comovement arises whenever $\tau^{fd} > 0$. In words: whenever the common supplier's price rises in response to the shock and the downstream buyer is substitution-prone (positive σ), the result is a fall in the buyer's demand for that input and hence potential negative co-movement between the shocked sector and other buyers of the same supplier.

Summary and discussion

Single-input case.— Suppose a shock occurs in sector- s' , altering its demand for intermediate inputs. If both s and s' rely on the same upstream supplier- s^* , then the increased demand from s' modifies the optimal input supply of s^* . This, in turn, raises the marginal cost of production in s^* , transmitting vertically along the supply chain. Sector- s , facing higher input prices, reduces its own demand, generating a potential negative comovement in employment. Formally, letting $\tau^{fd} > 0$ denote the price impact of the shock transmitted from s' to s^* , the reaction of sector- s is unambiguously negative. The sufficient statistic in this case is the pass-through parameter τ^{fd} : whenever $\tau^{fd} > 0$, demand-based distances generate negative comovement. This establishes a simple benchmark: competition for a unique common input induces substitution effects that overturn positive complementarities.

Multi-input CES case.— The single-input setting is restrictive, since most sectors source from multiple suppliers. By contrast, considering a CES aggregator of intermediate inputs for sector- s , with elasticity of substitution σ and expenditure share on the common input s^* , a shock from s' still propagates through s^* , raising its price by τ^{fd} . Sector- s reacts by reallocating its input mix, reducing demand for s^* and increasing demand for substitutes. The change in relative demand for the common input is given by $-\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \tau^{fd}$, which generalises the single-input benchmark. This expression highlights two key forces: (i) a higher elasticity of substitution ($\sigma \gg 1$) amplifies the negative response, since sector- s can more easily substitute away from the expensive input; and (ii) a larger expenditure share $e(s, s^*)$ attenuates the response, because the scope for substitution is smaller when the common input dominates the production structure. When $\sigma \rightarrow 0$ (Leontief case), substitution is impossible and the negative effect vanishes, aligning horizontal transmission with standard vertical propagation. Conversely, when $e(s, s^*) \rightarrow 0$, the sufficient statistic reduces to $-\sigma \tau^{fd}$, recovering the single-input case as a limiting outcome.

Interpretation and ambiguity.— The analysis reveals that negative comovement under demand-based distances is not a universal feature, but a contingent one: it crucially depends on the interaction between substitution elasticity and input shares. The ambiguity arises because the same empirical pattern of sectoral co-movement may be driven either by a (i) vertical propagation, where shocks pass through suppliers

along the Input-Output structure, or by a (ii) horizontal substitution effects, where sectors sharing the same upstream input reallocate their demand in opposite directions. This overlapping between vertical and horizontal mechanisms complicates the identification of genuine demand complementarities. What may appear as a horizontal spillover between sectors s and s' could, in fact, be the indirect by-product of vertical adjustments working through s^* .

Taking stocks.– The distinction between the single-input and multi-input CES frameworks clarifies the mechanisms through which demand-based distances can induce negative comovement. In the single-input benchmark, any positive shock to a common supplier transmits negatively to other connected sectors via higher costs. In the CES setting, the sufficient statistic $\delta_{s^* \rightarrow [s, s']} = -\sigma [1 - e(s, s^*)] \tau^{fd}$ captures how substitution elasticity and expenditure shares modulate this effect. Strong substitutability magnifies negative comovement, while heavy reliance on the common input mutes it. Ultimately, these results underscore that observed sectoral comovement may reflect a complex interplay of vertical propagation and substitution-driven horizontal effects. This inherent ambiguity, especially acute under demand-based distances, contrasts with the clearer patterns observed in supply-based distances, where competition for downstream markets yields more direct forms of negative interdependence. As such, disentangling these two channels remains a central challenge in interpreting the propagation of shocks across production networks.

B.2. Factor Input Supply network distance

Analytical conditions for sufficient statistics under which factor input supply-based network distances generate negative comovement highlight the interaction between (i) the elasticity of substitution across factor inputs in the production technology of a common downstream buyer, and (ii) the response of that downstream buyer's output to a shock in one of its suppliers. As in the demand-based case, the derivation proceeds separately for the single-input case and the multi-input CES case.⁴⁹

Derivation of the Sufficient Statistic

Consider an upstream supplier- s that sells a finite set of intermediate inputs to a downstream sector- s^* . Let the composite intermediate input be a CES aggregator:

$$x(s^*) = \left(\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s^*, s)^{\frac{1}{\sigma}} x(s^*, s)^{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma}} \right)^{\frac{\sigma}{\sigma-1}} \quad (\text{B.6})$$

where $x(s^*, s)$ is the quantity of the intermediate supplied by upstream sector- s

⁴⁹ The single-input case assumes that the downstream sector employs only one factor input from each upstream supplier, so that a shock to one supplier transmits mechanically to all others through the downstream buyer's production. Negative comovement is then governed solely by the elasticity of substitution between factors within the downstream production function. The multi-input CES case generalizes this to allow multiple factors, so that the effect of a shock in one supplier on the demand for another supplier's input depends on substitution elasticity and expenditure shares.

used by downstream buyer sector- s^* , while $\lambda(s, s^*) \in (0, 1)$ are share parameters, and $\sigma > 0$ is the (constant) elasticity of substitution across intermediate inputs.

Define the associated (unit) price index for the composite intermediate by the usual CES formula, $P(s^*) = \left(\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s^*, s) p(s)^{1-\sigma} \right)^{\frac{1}{1-\sigma}}$, with $p(s)$ denoting the price of input from upstream supplier- s .

Under cost minimization, for a given level of composite intermediate $X(s^*)$, the conditional demand for intermediate input s is given by the standard CES demand system. Define the expenditure share of variety s in the composite intermediate by $e(s^*, s) = \frac{\lambda(s^*, s) p(s)^{1-\sigma}}{\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} \lambda(s^*, s) p(s)^{1-\sigma}}$, with $\sum_{s \in \Phi(s)} e(s^*, s) = 1$.

A well-known property of the CES demand system is the (log) price elasticities for conditional demands:

$$\frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log p(s)} = -\sigma [1 - e(s^*, s)] \quad (\text{B.7})$$

$$\frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log p(s')} = \sigma e(s^*, s'), \quad \forall s' \neq s \quad (\text{B.8})$$

Conditions (B.7)-(B.8) are standard results for CES demand systems: the former, own-factor demand elasticity is decreasing in own price, scaled by substitution elasticity and expenditure share, while the latter, cross-price elasticities says demand for s rises if another input s' becomes more expensive, proportional to s' 's share.

Shock propagation through a common buyer.— Focus on a particular downstream sector- s^* that buys an intermediate used by several upstream sellers. Consider an idiosyncratic positive demand shock in some sector- s' that increases aggregate supply for the good purchased by s^* . Let $x(s^*, s')$ denote the supply shifter (or supply level) associated with the shocked sector- s' to sector- s^* .

Assume the upstream price of the good produced by s' responds to the shock according to a (log) pass-through parameter $\tau^{fs} = \frac{\partial \log p(s')}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')}$ of supply changes into prices. If $\tau^{fs} > 0$, the supplier's price rises when downstream demand increases; if $\tau^{fs} < 0$, supply shocks lower prices; when $\tau^{fs} \approx 0$, upstream supply is effectively perfectly elastic at the relevant margin.

The interest is in the log-response of buyer sector- s^* 's demand for the intermediate supplied by s , i.e., $\partial \log x(s^*, s) / \partial \log x(s^*, s')$. By the chain rule, and noting that only $p(s)$ changes in response to the shock (holding other upstream prices fixed in this partial equilibrium exercise), obtaining

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')} &= \frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log p(s')} \frac{\partial \log p(s')}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')} \\ &= \frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log p(s')} \cdot \tau^{fs} \end{aligned}$$

Using the CES price elasticity in eq. (B.7) for sector- s , whose revenues from s^* are $e(s^*, s)$, I obtain

$$\delta_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \left[\sigma e(s^*, s') \right] \tau^{fs} \quad (\text{B.9})$$

where $\delta_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log x(s^*, s')}$. Equation (B.9) makes three points transparent: (i) the elasticity of substitution, σ , magnifies the response – a larger σ amplifies the substitution away from s and toward s' when $p(s')$ falls; (ii) the expenditure share of the common downstream sector, $e(s^*, s')$, attenuates the price effect – the cheaper input s' represents a bigger share of s^* 's bundle; and (iii) the downstream pass-through, τ^{fs} , transmits the original upstream supply shock into a price change at the buyer – without such pass-through ($\tau^{fs} = 0$) the substitution channel vanishes.⁵⁰

Hence the sign of the log-response in eq. (B.9) is the sign of $\sigma e(s^*, s') \tau^{fs}$. Because $\sigma > 0$ and $e(s^*, s') > 0$ (for an interior share), the sign is governed by τ^{fs} : if $\tau^{fs} < 0$, the product $\sigma e(s^*, s') \tau^{fs}$ is negative, implying negative comovement between s and s' through their common buyer; by contrast, if $\tau^{fs} \approx 0$ (perfectly elastic downstream demand), the price channel is absent and do not expect negative comovement via this substitution mechanism.

Sufficient-statistic condition (multi-input supply case). Consider two upstream sectors, s and s' , both selling intermediate inputs to the same downstream buyer s^* . Combining the derivation above, a convenient sufficient-statistic condition for negative comovement of seller s 's supply to s^* (and plausibly of s 's employment if labour is proportional to output) following a positive shock in sector- s' is

$$\underbrace{\sigma}_{\text{elasticity}} \times \underbrace{e(s^*, s')}_{\text{expenditure share}} \times \underbrace{\tau^{fs}}_{\text{downstream pass-through}} < 0 \quad (\text{B.10})$$

Equivalently, because $\sigma e(s^*, s') > 0$ for interior shares, negative comovement arises whenever $\tau^{fs} < 0$. In words: whenever the common buyer's willingness-to-pay rises in response to the shock from s' and the upstream seller is substitution-prone across buyers (positive σ), the result is a fall in the other seller's marginal supply or allocation to that buyer, generating potential negative comovement between the upstream sectors competing for the same downstream market.

Downgrading the set-up: single-input case

If the downstream sector s^* uses only a single input from an upstream supplier (i.e. no possibility of substitutability across inputs), the elasticity of substitution is effectively

⁵⁰ Again, this condition represents a *marginal* elasticity: it captures the infinitesimal log-change in revenues from sales to s^* in response to a small perturbation in relative prices, mediated by the supply-side pass-through τ^{fs} . It should not be interpreted as implying a complete diversion of sales under $\sigma = 1$. In fact, $\sigma = 1$ corresponds to Cobb-Douglas preferences of the downstream buyer, in which expenditure shares remain constant, and the negative effect merely reflects marginal substitution toward competing suppliers. Full reallocation of demand away from s occurs only in the limiting case $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$ (perfect substitutes) or for large shocks where the log-linear approximation ceases to hold. In the multi-input CES case, sectoral sales are scaled by expenditure shares $e(s, s^*)$, so that the effective elasticity is $\sigma e(s, s^*)$, ensuring finite adjustments for all finite σ . Thus, the sufficient statistic provides a valid local description of marginal reallocation, but corner outcomes require infinite substitution or an exact analysis of the non-linear CES demand system.

zero ($\sigma = 0$). In this case, there is no scope for reallocation of expenditures across inputs: a price change in s' does not alter the demand for s :

$$\frac{\partial \log x(s^*, s)}{\partial \log p(s')} = 0$$

Hence, unlike the demand-driven case, the single-input supply case does not yield a sufficient statistic, as there is no mechanism generating comovement.

Summary and discussion

Single-input case.— If the common downstream sector s^* purchases only a single unit of input from each upstream supplier (no substitution, $\sigma = 0$), then a positive shock to s' increases s^* 's demand for s' 's input, transmitting vertically along the supply chain. However, because there is no substitution possibility, sector s cannot reallocate its supply away from s^* 's demand, and hence no negative comovement arises. A negative supply-driven channel appears only when $\sigma > 0$: the upstream sectors can reallocate their supply across buyers, so that an increase in demand for s' 's input induces a reduction in s 's allocation to s^* , generating negative comovement.

Multi-input CES case.— Consider an upstream sector- s that supplies multiple inputs to a downstream sector- s^* , which aggregates these inputs via a CES function with elasticity of substitution $\sigma > 0$. By the CES demand system, sector- s can reallocate its supply across buyers in response to relative price changes. The log-change in s 's supply to s^* induced by the shock to s' is $\delta_{\rightarrow s^*}[s, s'] = \sigma e(s^*, s') \tau^{fs}$, where $e(s^*, s')$ is the expenditure share of s^* 's input in the composite demand of s' . This expression provides a sufficient statistic for negative comovement: a positive shock to sector- s' changes the demand for its input, generating a price response in the upstream allocation, captured by the pass-through parameter $\tau^{fs} = \partial \log p(s) / \partial \log x(s', s^*)$. If $\tau^{fs} < 0$ (i.e. the price of s' 's input falls), the upstream sector reallocates supply away from s towards the cheaper s' , generating negative comovement mechanically. The magnitude of this effect is amplified by a larger elasticity of substitution σ and a higher expenditure share $e(s^*, s')$. Conversely, if $\sigma = 0$ (Leontief aggregation), no substitution is possible and negative comovement does not arise.

Intuition.— Negative comovement under factor-input supply distances is driven by downstream substitution: upstream suppliers respond strategically to changes in downstream demand across multiple buyers: cheaper inputs from s' attract more allocation, crowding out other suppliers. Both the ability to substitute across buyers (σ) and the relative importance of the shocked buyer in the downstream expenditure share (e) determine the strength of the effect. This mechanism highlights that supply-driven distances produce negative comovement only when upstream allocation is flexible and responsive, contrasting with demand-driven distances where even single-input scenarios can generate negative co-movement via price pass-through. In contrast to the demand-driven case, the sign depends on whether supplier's shocks lower prices ($\tau^{fs} < 0$). Observed co-movements thus reflect the extent of substitution possibilities and the composition of the downstream buyer's input bundle.

C. DATA, FIGURES AND TABLES

(Data details) *In order to build the main dataset with a panel of 65 private 3-digit U.S. 2017 North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) sectors used in Sections 3-4, I rely on different data sources from the Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA).⁵¹ For years from 1998 to 2022, the features of these information are:*

- (a) employment (Table 6.8D. - Persons Engaged in Production by Industry, in thousands. Last revised on: September 29, 2023);*
- (b) value-added (Value-Added by Industry, in billions of dollars. Last revised on: December 19, 2024);*
- (c) inter-sectoral trade and Input-Output linkages, in particular:*
 - sectoral share of own production, and thus the sectoral share of intermediate inputs from other sectors (Industry-by-Commodity Market Share Matrix, After Redefinitions - Summary, in producers' prices);*
 - total inputs required (directly and indirectly) in order to deliver one dollar of output to final users (Commodity-by-Commodity Total Requirements, After Redefinitions - Summary, in producers' prices);*
 - sector-specific imports and exports of goods and services (The Use of Commodities by Industries, Before Redefinitions - Summary, in producers' prices and in millions of dollars).*

Note that “Summary” defines the level of sectoral disaggregation considered in the analysis (3-digit). The BEA also provides information on Input-Output matrices to a more detailed level (6-digit), but these are on a five-yearly basis (thus it would be impossible to run the analysis in Subsection 4.1), and data on other variables are not collected. Moreover, the sample begins in 1998 so to have all sectors classified given the NAICS system, and ends in 2022, the last year available when I started this project.⁵² Last time I accessed this online data was in March 2025.

Turn to the manipulation of Input-Output matrices. To recover the production share of intermediate inputs of a given sector coming from the production of other sectors, each cell of the yearly squared matrix contains the intermediate output share from a given sector to another and, on the main diagonal, the share of intermediate output of a given sector directly produced by that sector. Henceforth, labelling by $\mathbf{X} = [x(s, s')]$, with $x(s, s') \geq 0$, this Input-Output matrix I compute, for each sector, $x(s) = 1 - x(s, s)$. In other words, to extract the total share of intermediate output that sector- s buys from other sectors, I compute $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{1} - \text{diag}(\mathbf{X})$, where $\mathbf{1}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of ones; the resulting $S \times 1$ vector $\mathbf{x}$ reports, for every considered year, the total

⁵¹ Note that I refer to 3-digit, but four sectors are at 2-digit (“construction”, “management of companies and enterprises”, “educational services”, and “other services, except government”), while five sectors related to finance and insurance are at 4-digit level.

⁵² Before 1998, classification follows the U.S. Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system.

production of a sectoral good which is due to intermediate inputs bought through Input-Output relationships.

For what concerns the production network structure, I investigate its characteristics through the main Input-Output matrix (Commodity-by-Commodity Total Requirements, After Redefinitions) which, consistently with the main text, I label as $\mathbf{H} = [\alpha(s, s') \geq 0]$. Leontief inverse matrix (labelled with $\mathbf{H}$ in the main text), upstream and downstream sectors, and the weight associated to each of them (as in Subsections 4.1-4.2) are identified through it.⁵³

Differently, in order to compute sectoral distances, I follow the literature (e.g., Acemoglu et al. 2012, Carvalho 2014) and disregard small transactions across sectors: this allows me to compute a finite set of production network distances at the extensive margin due to the removal of bias from meaningless inter-sectoral trade intensity. Such adjusted matrix is labelled as $\mathbf{H}^j = [\alpha^j(s, s')]]$ whose generic element is then $\alpha^j(s, s') > 0.01$ for $j = \{fd, fs\}$ identifying whether the matrix allows to compute factor input demand or factor input supply network distances. In particular, I set to 0 all the linkages which are below 1% of sector's total purchases (in case of factor input demand distance) and total sales (in case of factor input supply distance). Disregarding small transactions implies that

$$\alpha^j(s, s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\tilde{v}(s)} \quad \text{is set to } 0 \quad \text{if } \alpha^j(s, s') \leq 0.01$$

where $\tilde{v}(s) = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in \text{column}} \alpha(s, s')}$ is sector- s 's total input purchases (i.e., column sum of matrix $\mathbf{H}$) for factor input demand distance, or $\tilde{v}(s) = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in \text{row}} \alpha(s, s')}$ is sector- s 's total input sales (i.e., row sum of matrix $\mathbf{H}$) for factor input supply distance. It follows that, by defining $\tilde{\mathbf{V}} = [\tilde{v}(1), \dots, \tilde{v}(s), \dots, \tilde{v}(S)]'$, the considered Input-Output structure is

$$\mathbf{H}^j_{S \times S} = \mathbf{H}'_{S \times S} \tilde{\mathbf{V}}_{S \times 1}$$

in which each cell, $\alpha^j(s, s')$, is greater than 0.01, i.e., larger than 1%.

(Shortest path algorithm, technical but suitable for coding) Given element $\mathcal{G}$ being an $S \times S$ adjacency matrix with discrete values larger than 1, the idea is to compute a matrix $\mathcal{D}$ where each cell $d[s, s']$ is the length of the shortest path between node- s and node- s' . The numerical algorithm is as follows:

- (a) from the Input-Output matrix $\mathbf{H}$, build an associated identity matrix, $\mathbf{I}$;
- (b) set the initial length of the path, $n = 1$, and build a length matrix $\mathcal{G}_n = \mathcal{G}$;
- (c) build a Boolean matrix, $\mathcal{L}$, whose elements are $l(s, s') = 1$ if $\mathcal{G}_n \neq 0$;

⁵³ Row sectors identify (upstream) suppliers, and column sectors identify (downstream) buyers. Basically, in matrix $\mathbf{H}$ each entry in the upper-triangular part corresponds to the dollar value of one unit of sector- s that is bought by sector- s' , while each entry in the lower-triangular part identifies the dollar value of sector- s in order to buy one unit from sector- s' .

TABLE C.1: LIST OF CONSIDERED SECTORS AND THEIR CODES

<i>denomination</i>	<i>codes</i>	
	<i>NAICS 2017</i>	<i>BEA</i>
<i>Farms</i>	111, 112	111CA
<i>Forestry, Fishing and Related Activities</i>	113, 114, 115	113FF
<i>Oil and Gas Extraction</i>	211	211
<i>Mining, except Oil and Gas</i>	212	212
<i>Support Activities for Mining</i>	213	213
<i>Utilities</i>	22	22
<i>Construction</i>	23	23
<i>Wood Products</i>	321	321
<i>Nonmetallic Mineral Products</i>	327	327
<i>Primary Metals</i>	331	331
<i>Fabricated Metal Products</i>	332	332
<i>Machinery</i>	333	333
<i>Computer and Electronic Products</i>	334	334
<i>Electrical Equipment, Appliances, and Components</i>	335	335
<i>Motor Vehicle, Bodies and Trailers, and Parts</i>	3361-3	3361MV
<i>Other Transportation Equipment</i>	3364-9	3364OT
<i>Furniture and Related Products</i>	337	337
<i>Miscellaneous Manufacturing</i>	339	339
<i>Food and Beverage and Tobacco Products</i>	311, 312	311FT
<i>Textile Mills and Textile Product Mills</i>	313, 314	313TT
<i>Apparel and Leather and Allied Products</i>	315, 316	315AL
<i>Paper Products</i>	322	322
<i>Printing and Related Support Activities</i>	323	323
<i>Petroleum and Coal Products</i>	324	324
<i>Chemical Products</i>	325	325
<i>Plastics and Rubber Products</i>	326	326
<i>Wholesale Trade</i>	42	42
<i>Motor Vehicle and Parts Dealers</i>	441	441
<i>Food and Beverage Stores</i>	445	445
<i>General Merchandise Stores</i>	452	452
<i>Other Retail</i>	442-4, 446-8, 45 ex.	452 4A0
<i>Air Transportation</i>	481	481
<i>Rail Transportation</i>	482	482
<i>Water Transportation</i>	483	483
<i>Truck Transportation</i>	484	484
<i>Transit and Ground Passenger Transportation</i>	485	485
...		

Sectors are defined according to the nomenclature used by the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA).

TABLE C.1: LIST OF CONSIDERED SECTORS AND THEIR CODES (*continued*)

<i>denomination</i>	<i>codes</i>	
	<i>NAICS 2017</i>	<i>BEA</i>
...		
<i>Pipeline Transportation</i>	486	486
<i>Other Transportation and Support Activities</i>	487, 488, 492	487OS
<i>Warehousing and Storage</i>	493	493
<i>Publishing Industries, except Internet (includes Software)</i>	511	511
<i>Motion Picture and Sound Recording industries</i>	512	512
<i>Broadcasting and Telecommunications</i>	515, 517	513
<i>Data Processing, Internet Publishing, and Other Information Service</i>	518, 519	514
<i>Federal Reserve Banks, Credit Intermediation, and Related Activities</i>	521, 5221, 5222, 5223	521CI
<i>Securities, Commodity Contracts, and Investments</i>	523	523
<i>Insurance Carriers and Related Activities</i>	5241, 5242	524
<i>Funds, Trusts, and Other Financial Vehicles</i>	525	525
<i>Housing</i>	.	HS
<i>Other Real Estate</i>	531	ORE
<i>Rental and Leasing Services and Lessors of Intangible Assets</i>	532, 533	532RL
<i>Legal Services</i>	5411	5411
<i>Computer Systems Design and Related Services</i>	5415	5415
<i>Miscellaneous Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services</i>	541 ex. 5411, 5415	5412OP
<i>Management of Companies and Enterprises</i>	55	55
<i>Administrative and Support Services</i>	561	561
<i>Waste Management and Remediation Services</i>	562	562
<i>Educational Services</i>	61	61
<i>Ambulatory Health Care Services</i>	621	621
<i>Hospitals</i>	622	622
<i>Nursing and Residential Care Facilities</i>	623	623
<i>Social Assistance</i>	624	624
<i>Performing Arts, Spectator Sports, Museums, and Related Activities</i>	711, 712	711AS
<i>Amusement, Gambling, and Recreation industries</i>	713	713
<i>Accommodation</i>	721	721
<i>Food Services and Drinking Places</i>	722	722
<i>Other Services, except Government</i>	81	81

Sectors are defined according to the nomenclature used by the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA).

(Network distances at the intensive margin) In Section 3 of the main text I characterize distance matrices at their “extensive margin”, $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{ext}^{fs}$ whose values are $d_{ext}^j[s, s'] = \{1, 2, \dots, d_{max}\}$ for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, considering the directed production network, $\mathcal{H}$, that accounts for direct sectoral connections only.

Instead, to characterize the “intensive margin” matrix distances $\mathcal{D}^{fd}$ and $\mathcal{D}^{fs}$ I follow Conley and Dupor (2003). Given $\alpha^{fd}(s, s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in row} \alpha(s, s')}$, the generic element of factor input demand distance matrix is computed as follows:

$$d^{fd}[s, s'] = \left\{ \sum_{k \in \Phi(s)} \left[\alpha^{fd}(s, k) - \alpha^{fd}(s', k) \right]^2 \right\}^{\frac{1}{2}} \quad (\text{C.1})$$

which defines the length of the line segment (i.e., the Euclidean distance) connecting sectors s and s' when both are buying from the same other sector- k , $\forall k \in \Phi(s)$, so that $\mathcal{D}^{fd} = [d^{fd}[s, s']]$ with generic element $d^{fd}[s, s'] > 0$.⁵⁴ Demand distance is constructed by dividing each cell by its row sum. Why? A row sum represents the total sales of the sector in question, so dividing each entry by its associated row sum yields the share of that (row) sector’s output purchased by each of the column sectors. This normalization allows for a meaningful comparison across dyads of sectors: by examining these shares, one can assess the relative distance between two (column) sectors in terms of their purchases from common upstream suppliers.

In an analogous way, given $\alpha^{fs}(s, s') = \frac{\alpha(s, s')}{\sum_{s' \in column} \alpha(s, s')}$, the generic element of factor input supply distance matrix is shaped by

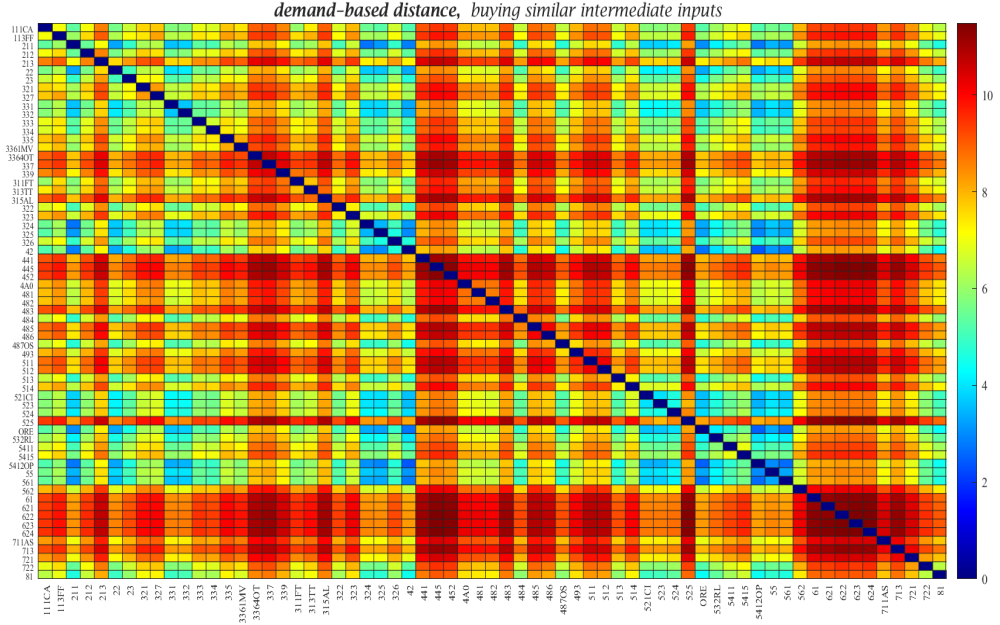
$$d^{fs}[s, s'] = \left\{ \sum_{k \in \Phi(s)} \left[\alpha^{fs}(k, s) - \alpha^{fs}(k, s') \right]^2 \right\}^{\frac{1}{2}} \quad (\text{C.2})$$

tracing a Euclidean distance between sectors $\{s, s'\}$ when both are selling to the same sector- k , $\forall k \in \Phi(s)$, so that $\mathcal{D}^{fs} = [d^{fs}[s, s']]$ with $d^{fs}[s, s'] > 0$. Supply distance is constructed by dividing each cell by its column sum. Why? A column sum represents the total purchases of the sector in question, so dividing each entry by its associated column sum yields the share of that (column) sector’s input purchased from each of the row sectors. This normalization allows for a meaningful comparison across dyads of sectors: by examining these shares, one can assess the relative distance between two (row) sectors in terms of their traded quantities to common downstream buyers.

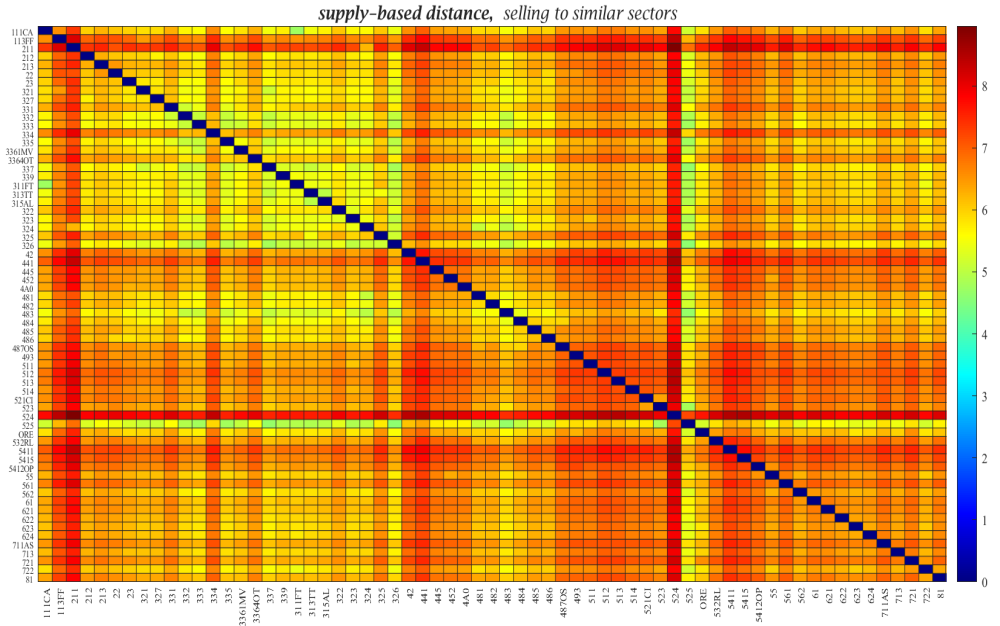
Both the distance matrices at the intensive margin are developed from the directed production network, $\mathbf{H} = [\alpha(s, s') \geq 0]$.⁵⁵

⁵⁴ Note how, to be consistent with the main text’s notation, in eqs. (C.1)-(C.2) I am flipping the way sectors are defined when writing $d^j[\cdot]$, for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, compared to that in Conley and Dupor (2003), yet maintaining unaltered the main theoretical and empirical predictions.

⁵⁵ Recall that distance matrices are computed from an Input-Output structure in which each inter-sectoral trade linkage is greater than 1% of total purchases (or sales) of a sector.



(A) FACTOR INPUT DEMAND



(B) FACTOR INPUT SUPPLY

FIGURE C.2: INTENSIVE MARGIN PRODUCTION NETWORK DISTANCE MATRICES

Note: heatmaps of sectoral distances characterizing the U.S. production network in year 2007 for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors. Entry (s, s') represents the intensive marginal value, $d^j[s, s'] \geq 0$ for $j = \{fd, fs\}$, of the horizontal relationship between sector- s and sector- s' under *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers, Panel C.2a) and *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers, Panel C.2b). Diagonal sparsity (*i.e.*, lots of 0s), is a direct consequence of the fact that the difference of inter-sectoral trade intensities between a sector and itself is zero. Distance matrices are at the *intensive margin*, as in eqs. (C.1)-(C.2), computed from the *directed* sectoral production network. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

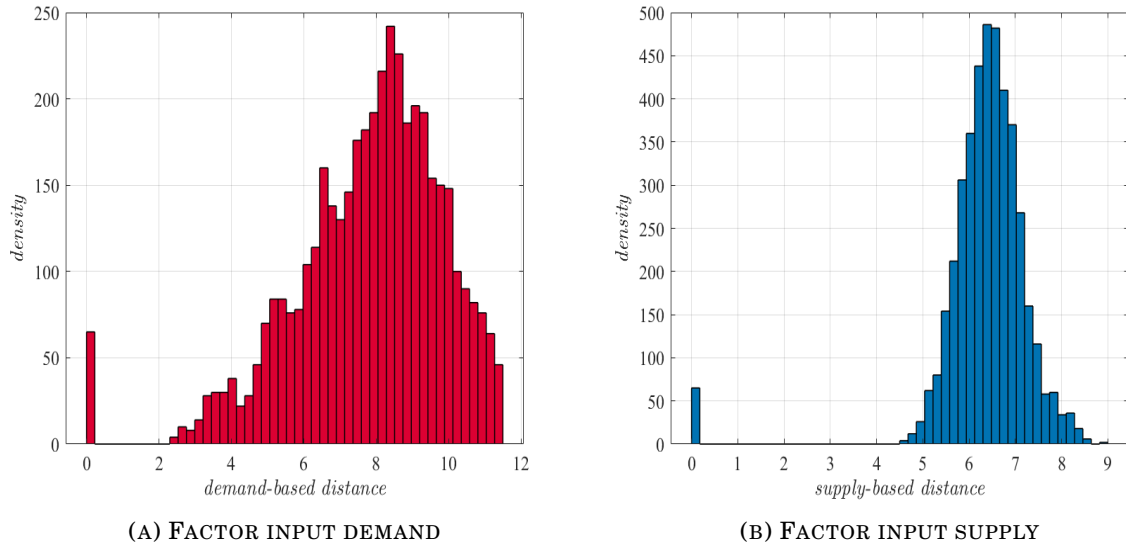


FIGURE C.3: DISTRIBUTION OF NETWORK ECONOMIC DISTANCES

Note: these figures depict the distributions for *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers, Panel C.3a) and *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers, Panel C.3b). Distance values on the *x*-axis are at the *intensive margin*, as in eqs. (C.1)-(C.2), computed from the *directed* sectoral production network *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

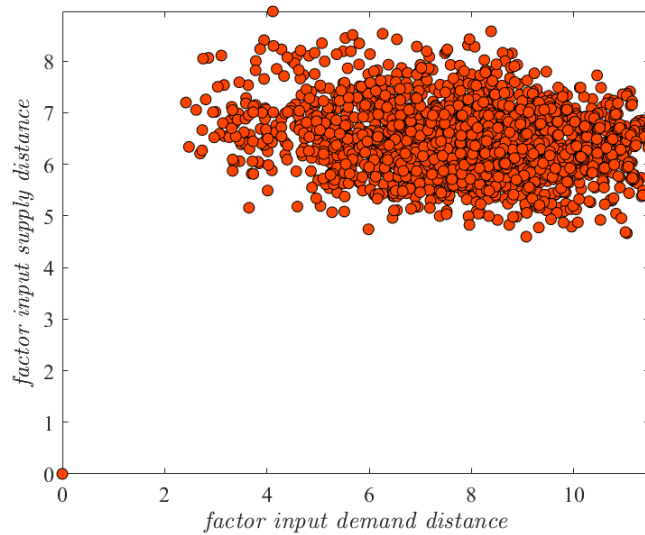
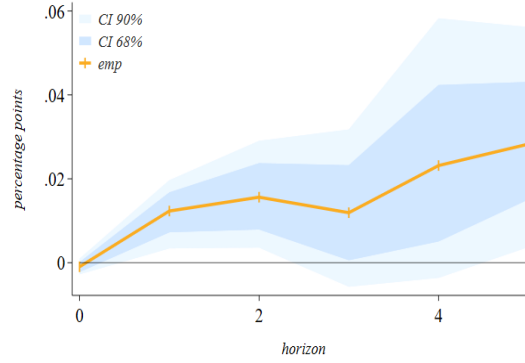


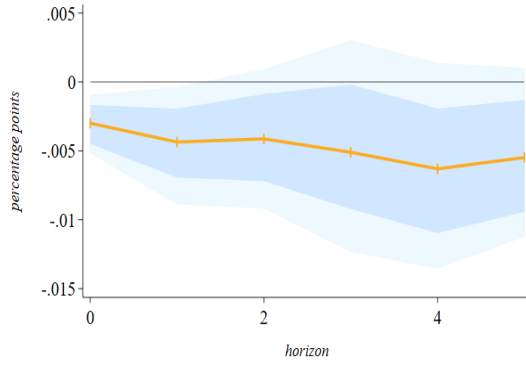
FIGURE C.4: CORRELATION OF NETWORK ECONOMIC DISTANCES

Note: the figure shows the correlation between the measures for *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers, *x*-axis) and *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers, *y*-axis). Distances are at the *intensive margin*, as in eqs. (C.1)-(C.2), computed from the *directed* sectoral production network *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

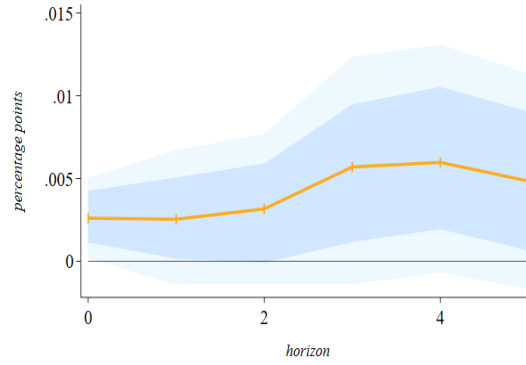
D. COMPLEMENTARY EMPIRICAL RESULTS



(A) SECTOR-SPECIFIC



(B) $d = 1$



(C) $d = 2$

FIGURE D.1: SECTORAL EMPLOYMENT RESPONSE TO INTERMEDIATE INPUTS

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment to a 1% increase in the sector-specific set of intermediate inputs as a share of its value-added for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. In particular, Panel D.1a represents the sector-level employment response to changes in its intermediate inputs, while Panel D.1b-D.1c to changes in the set of intermediates in closer (distance equal to 1) and further (distance equal to 2) sectors. The solid-orange line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-blue and shadow-light blue areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eqs. (15)-(16). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

(Plotting separated results for highly interlinked sectors) Unpacking all the combined plots, below I report the estimated Local Projection (LP) dynamics for top 5%, top 10%, top 20%, and top 30% of more connected sectors in the production network (i.e., major number of Input-Output linkages) separately. The purpose is to show the significance of the responses appearing in Panels 9a-9b of Figure 9 in Subsection 4.2 of the main text, and in Panels 7a-7b of Figure 7 in Appendix D.

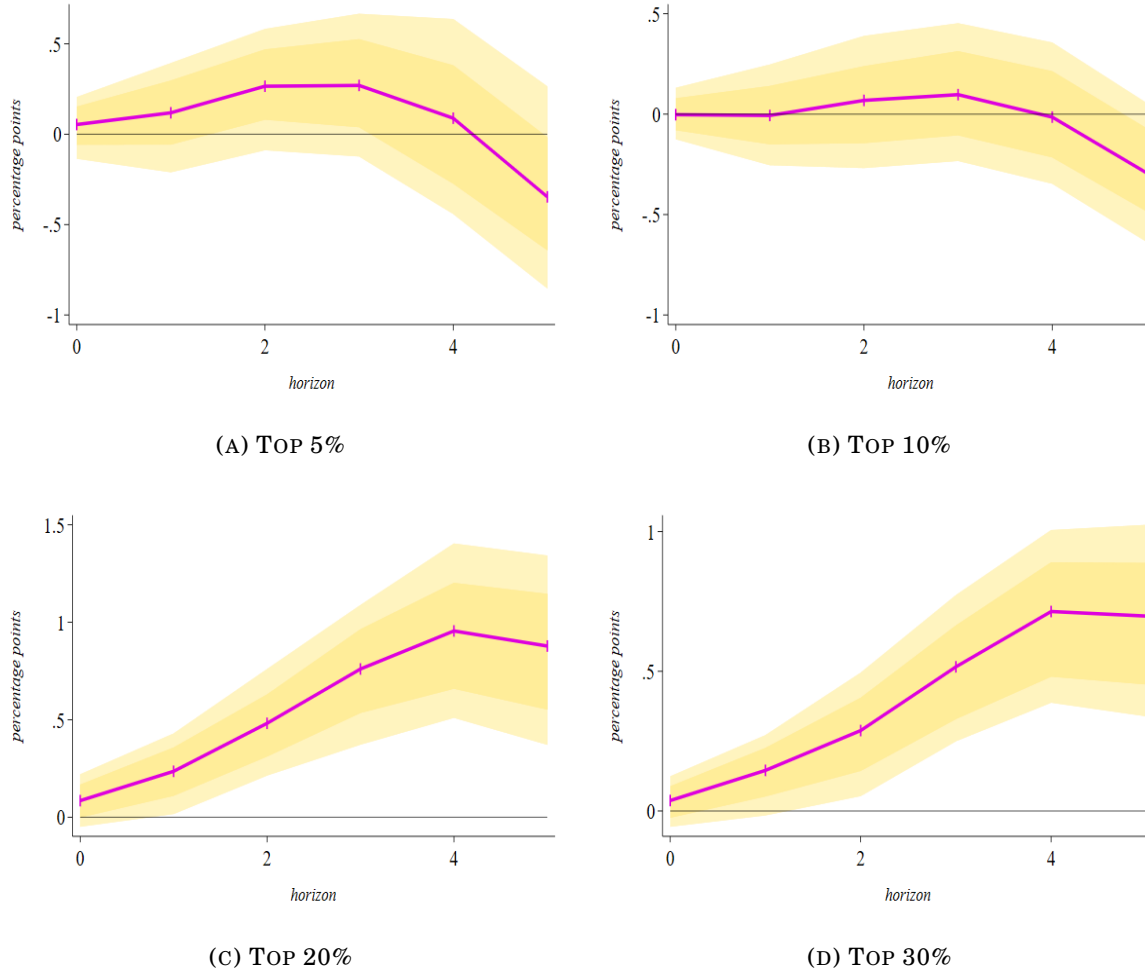


FIGURE D.2: DEMAND ($d = 1$) EFFECTS FOR INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (i.e., demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Unpacking Panel 7a of Figure 7, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 5% (Panel D.2a), 10% (Panel D.2b), 20% (Panel D.2c), and 30% (Panel D.2d) more connected sectors in the production network (i.e., major number of I-O linkages) – from top-left to bottom-right, respectively – to employment changes in their closer (distance equal to 1) sectors. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

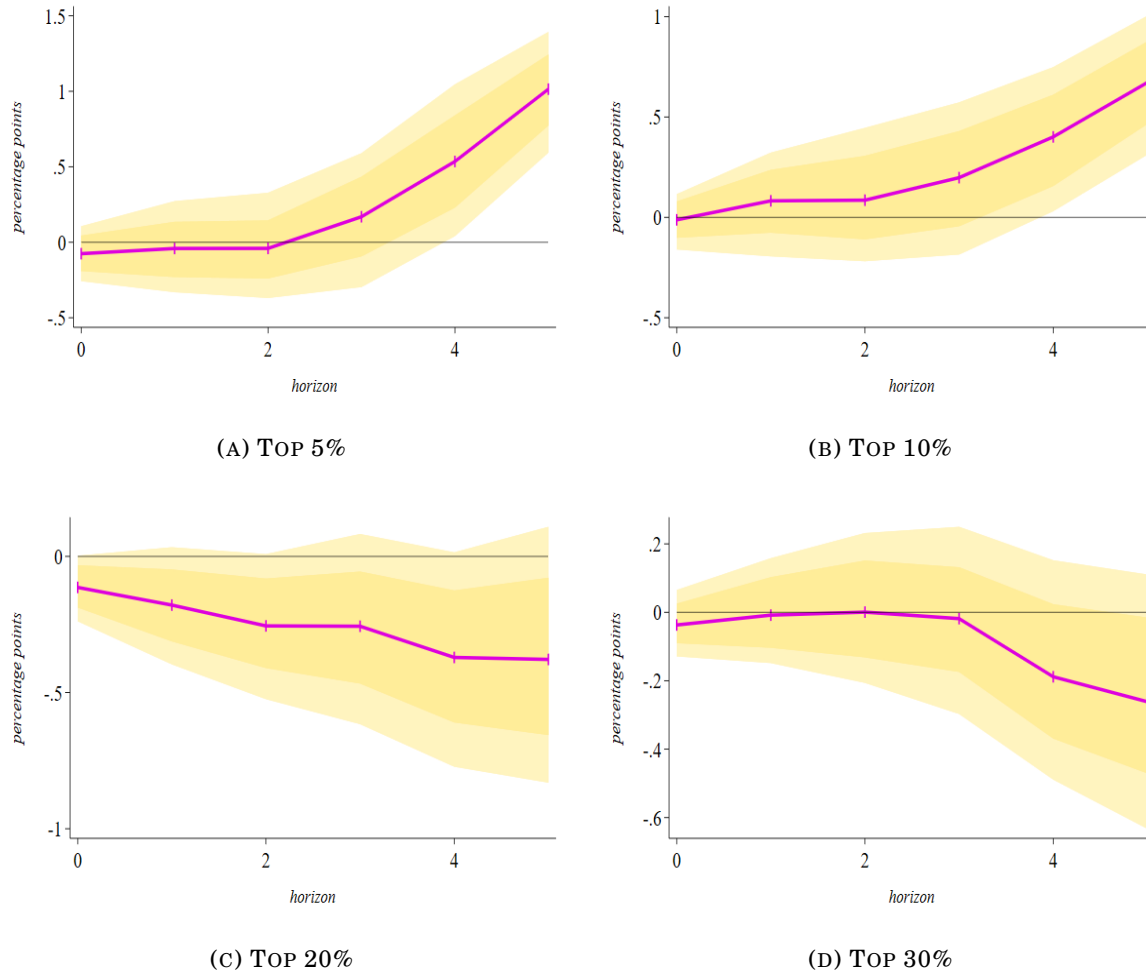


FIGURE D.3: DEMAND ($d = 2$) EFFECTS FOR INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Unpacking Panel 7b of Figure 7, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 20% (Panel D.3c) and 30% (Panel D.3d) more connected sectors in the production network (*i.e.*, major number of I-O linkages) to employment changes in their further (distance equal to 2) sectors. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

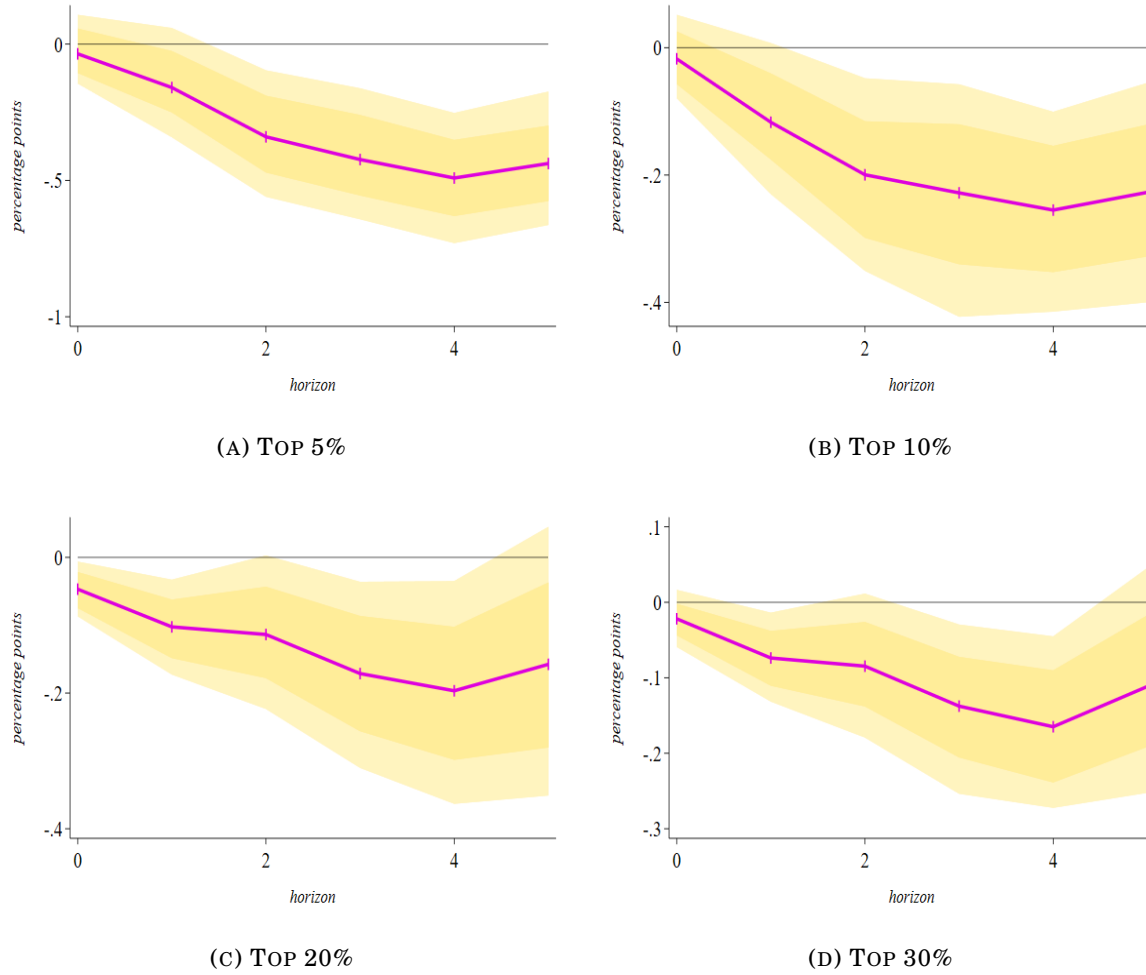


FIGURE D.4: SUPPLY ($d = 1$) EFFECTS FOR INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Unpacking Panel 9a of Figure 9, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 5% (Panel D.4a), 10% (Panel D.4b), 20% (Panel D.4c), and 30% (Panel D.4d) more connected sectors in the production network (*i.e.*, major number of I-O linkages) – from top-left to bottom-right, respectively – to employment changes in their closer (distance equal to 1) sectors. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

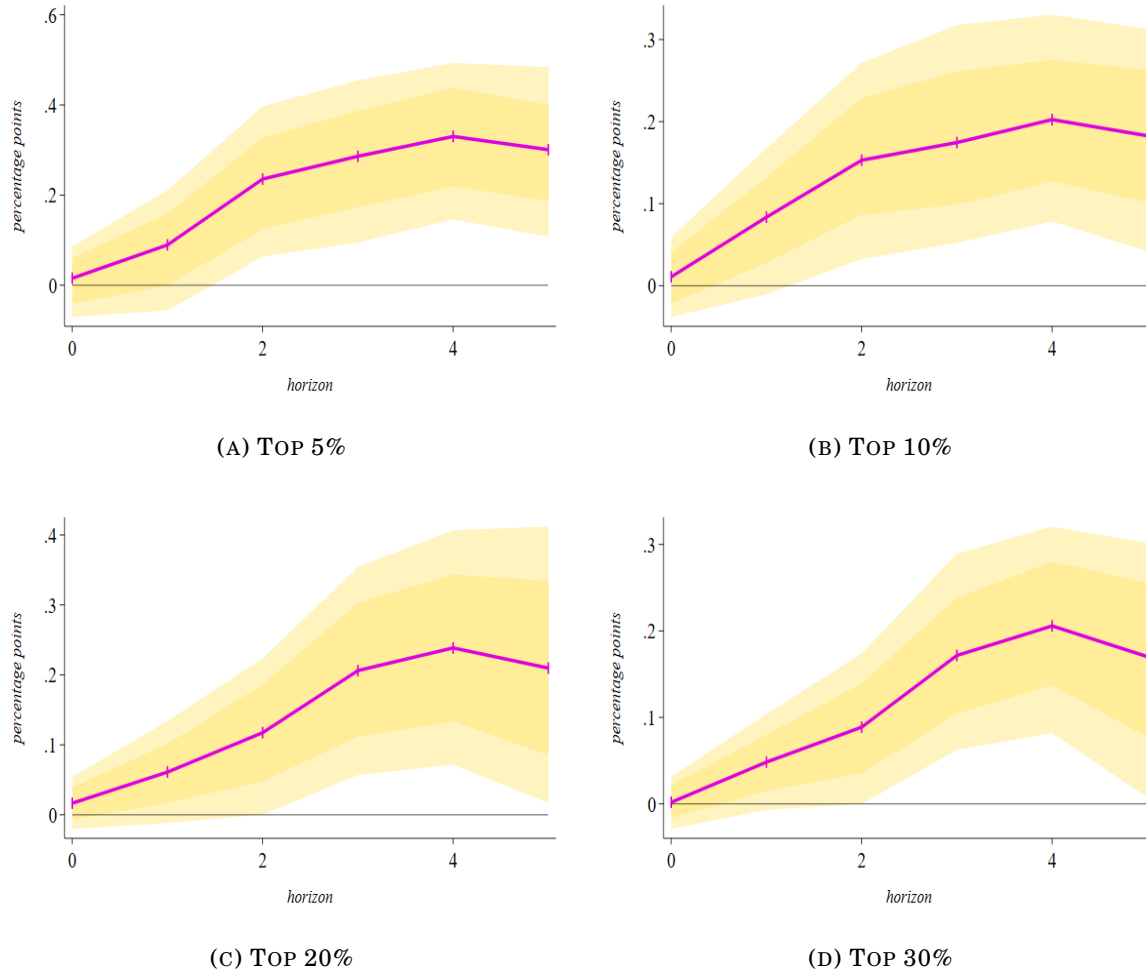


FIGURE D.5: SUPPLY ($d = 2$) EFFECTS FOR INTERLINKED SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Unpacking Panel 9b of Figure 9, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 5% (Panel D.5a), 10% (Panel D.5b), 20% (Panel D.5c), and 30% (Panel D.5d) more connected sectors in the production network (*i.e.*, major number of I-O linkages) – from top-left to bottom-right, respectively – to employment changes in their further (distance equal to 2) sectors. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

(Robustness with centrality measures) *To identify the centrality degree of each sector, I follow the approach outlined in Carvalho (2014) to measure the sector-level Bonacich-Katz centrality.⁵⁶ Using the Leontief-inverse matrix $\mathcal{H}$ for the U.S. production network as of 2007, the Bonacich-Katz centrality vector, $\mathbf{bk}$, is defined as:*

$$\mathbf{bk} = \sum_{p=0}^{\infty} \phi^p \mathcal{H}^p \mathbf{1} = \left(\mathbf{I} - \omega \mathcal{H} \right)^{-1} \mathbf{1}, \quad (\text{D.1})$$

where index- p refers to the length of the paths in the production network – that is, the number of steps (or network “hops”) connecting one sector to another – and, given a finite set of sectors $\{s, s', s'', \dots, S\} \in \Phi(s)$:

- $\mathbf{1}$ is an $S \times 1$ vector of ones, reflecting the base influence;
- $\omega \in \left(0, \frac{1}{\lambda_{\max}}\right)$ is a dampening parameter, with $\lambda_{\max}$ being the largest eigenvalue of matrix $\mathcal{H}$;
- $\mathbf{I}$ is the $S \times S$ identity matrix.

The value of ω determines the weight assigned to indirect linkages: smaller values place more emphasis on direct connections, while larger values account for deeper propagation within the network. Following Carvalho (ibid.), a value of $\omega = 0.5$ is typically used, which lies safely below the inverse of the largest eigenvalue of most empirically observed Input-Output matrices, ensuring convergence of the series. This measure reflects the idea that a sector is central not only if it is directly connected to many others, but also if it is connected to sectors that are themselves highly central.

This formulation ensures that the centrality score of each sector captures both its direct connections and its indirect influence through other sectors due to the use of matrix $\mathcal{H} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{H})^{-1} = [\ell(s, s') \geq 0]$, where $\mathbf{H} = [\alpha(s, s') \geq 0]$ is the directed production network matrix (i.e., that in the BEA Input-Output tables), defining the intensity of good produced by sector- s' in the total intermediate inputs used by sector- s , with $\alpha(s, s') = 0$ indicating that sector- s does not make use of the good produced by sector- s' in producing its own intermediate good.

⁵⁶ Outlined by Bonacich (1987), it is a measure of a sector's overall importance within an Input-Output system, capturing not only its direct connections to other sectors but also the centrality of those it is connected to. In essence, a sector is considered central if it is linked to other central sectors, creating a recursive structure of influence. This measure goes beyond simple counts of linkages by incorporating indirect connections – weighted by a dampening factor – to reflect the diminishing influence of more distant sectors in the network. In the context of production network, a sector with high Bonacich-Katz centrality is one that plays a key role in the propagation of shocks, as its position allows it to influence (or be influenced by) large portions of the economy through both direct and indirect channels. Compared to other centrality measures, Bonacich-Katz is particularly well-suited for economic applications, as it accounts for the intensity of inter-sectoral relationships and the structure of the network in a realistic and nuanced way.

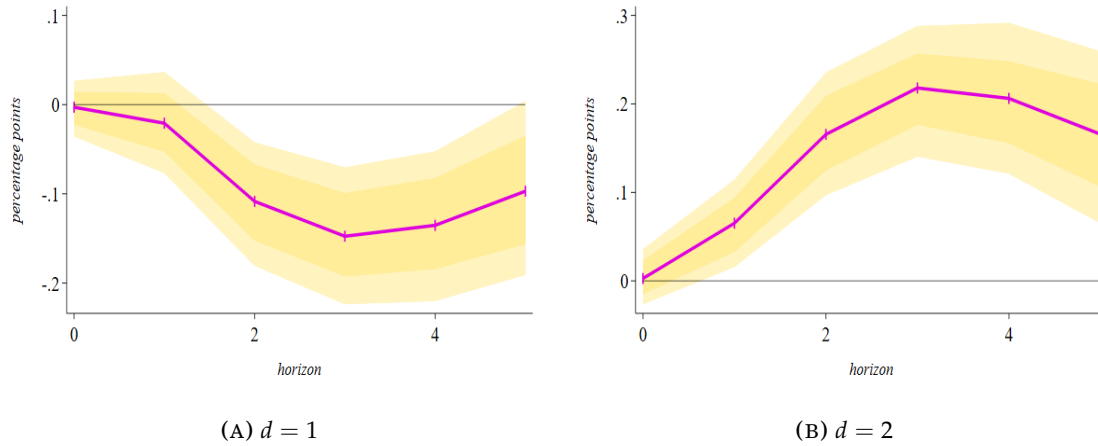


FIGURE D.6: DEMAND LINKAGES AND COMOVEMENT IN PERIPHERAL SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of most central sectors (with *centrality* defined according to sector's relevance in final consumption) to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel D.6a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel D.6b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

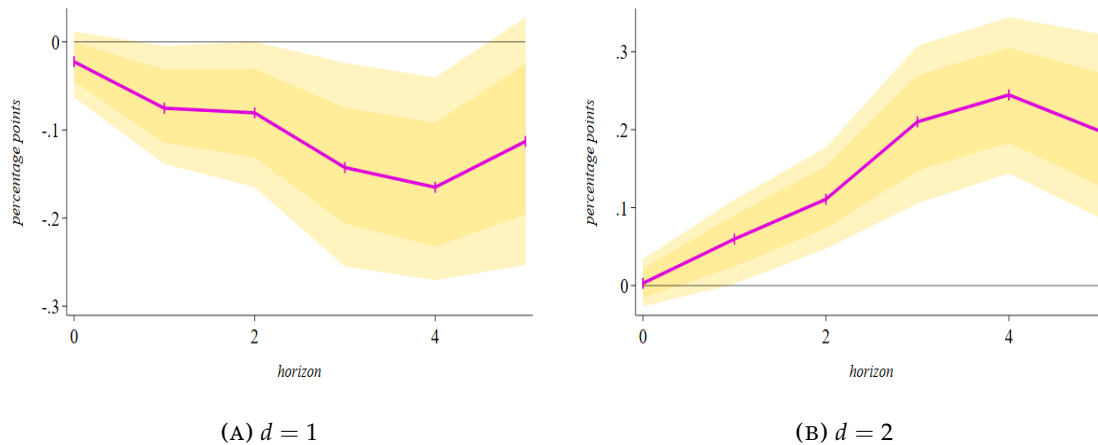


FIGURE D.7: SUPPLY LINKAGES AND COMOVEMENT IN PERIPHERAL SECTORS

Note: given the *factor input supply* network distance (*i.e.*, supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network in year 2007, the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of most central sectors (with *centrality* defined according to sector's relevance in final consumption) to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Panel D.7a represents the sector-level employment response to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) sectors, while Panel D.7b plots the response to employment changes in further (distance equal to 2) ones. The solid-purple line corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while shadow-gold and shadow-light gold areas correspond to 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), respectively, computed from eq. (18). *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

(Robustness with production network at different base years) Responses for comovement in sectoral employment levels in the main analysis of Section 4 are centred on the implementation of a sectoral production network represented by an Input-Output matrix in the baseline year 2007. Differently, Figures D.8, D.9 and D.10 perform again all the main analysis by referring, instead, to a production network structure five years before (2002) and five years after (2012) the baseline year. Note that Input-Output matrices always correspond to their Leontief inverse configuration.

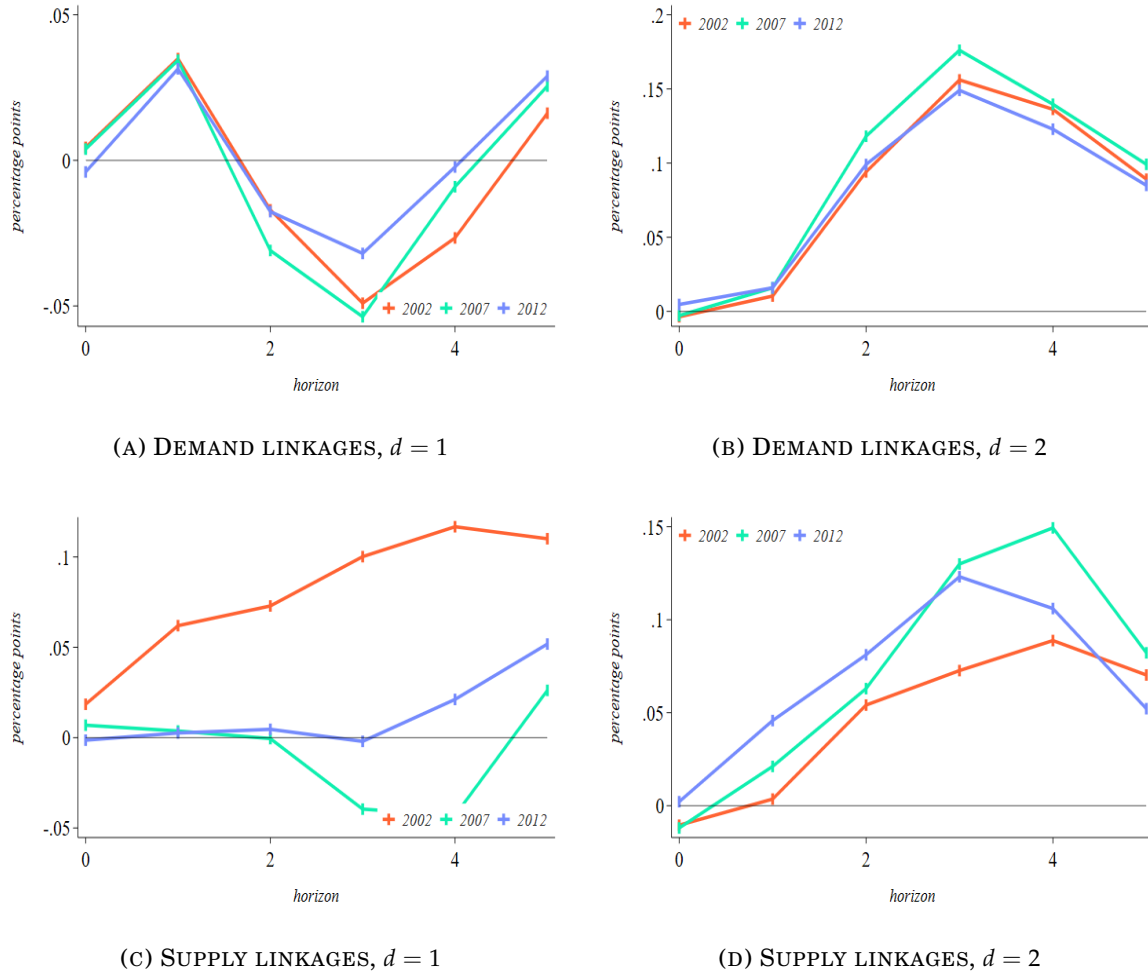


FIGURE D.8: COMOVEMENT OVER DIFFERENT BASELINE YEARS

Note: given both the *factor input demand* (i.e., demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *factor input supply* (i.e., supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) network distances, and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network over different years (2002, 2007, and 2012), the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Expanding to different production network structures the results in the main text: Panels D.8a-D.8b expand their relatives of Figure 6, while Panels D.8c-D.8d do so for their relatives in Figure 8. Solid lines corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), computed from eq. (18), roughly correspond to the associated figures in the main text. Responses are referred to employment changes in closer (distance equal to 1) and further (distance equal to 2) sectors. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

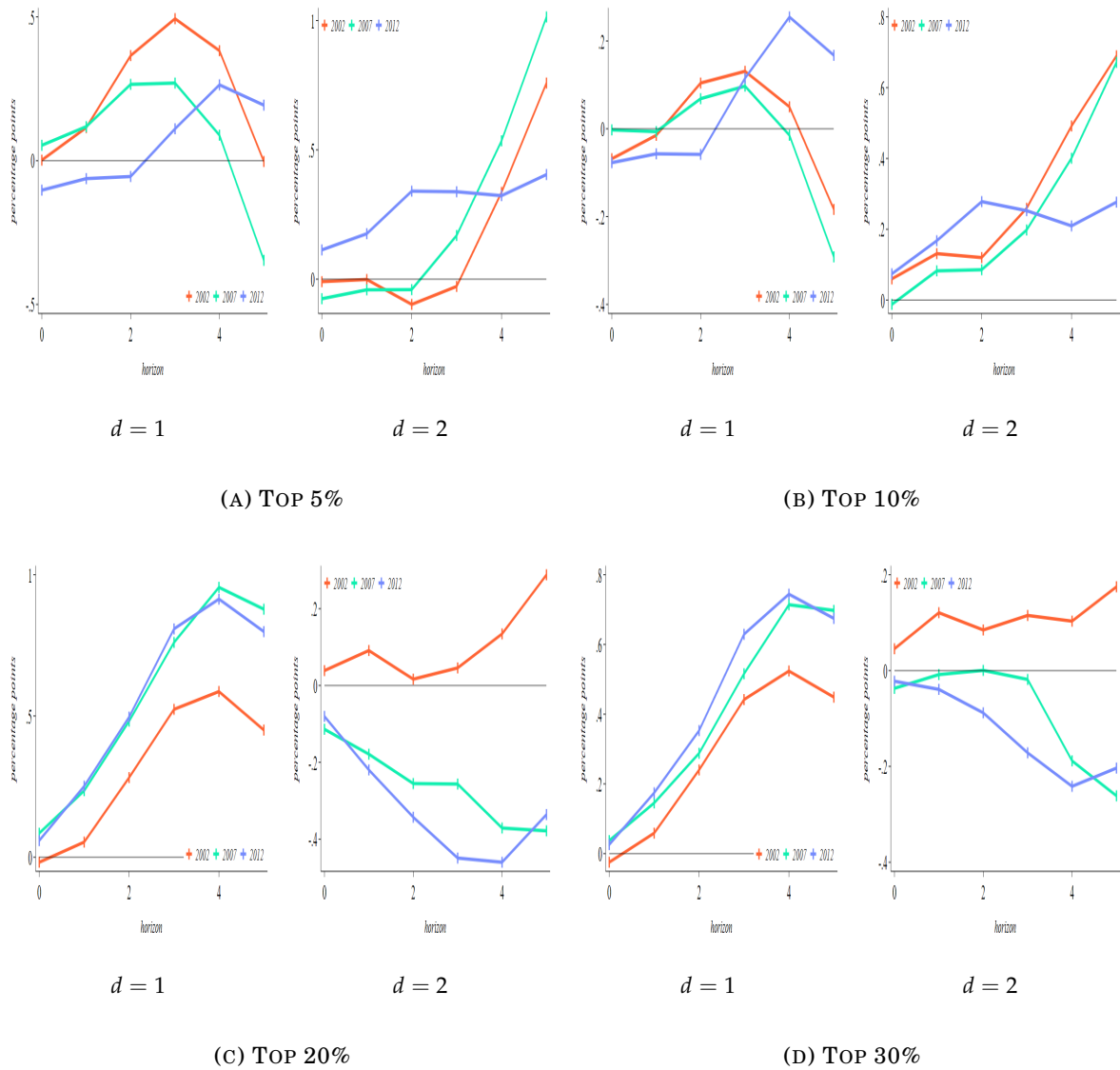


FIGURE D.9: DEMAND LINKAGES AND INTERLINKED SECTORS OVER THE YEARS

Note: given both the *factor input demand* network distance (*i.e.*, demand linkages across sectors given their common upstream sellers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (*i.e.*, sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network over different years (2002, 2007, and 2012), the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Expanding to different production network structures the responses of Panels 7a-7b of Figure 7, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 5% (Panel D.9a), 10% (Panel D.9b), 20% (Panel D.9c), and 30% (Panel D.9d) more connected sectors in the production network (*i.e.*, major number of I-O linkages) – from top-left to bottom-right, respectively – to employment changes in their closer (distance equal to 1) or further (distance equal to 2) sectors. Solid lines corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), computed from eq. (18), roughly correspond to the associated figure. If a plot is not appearing, it means there is no response for the specified distance value. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

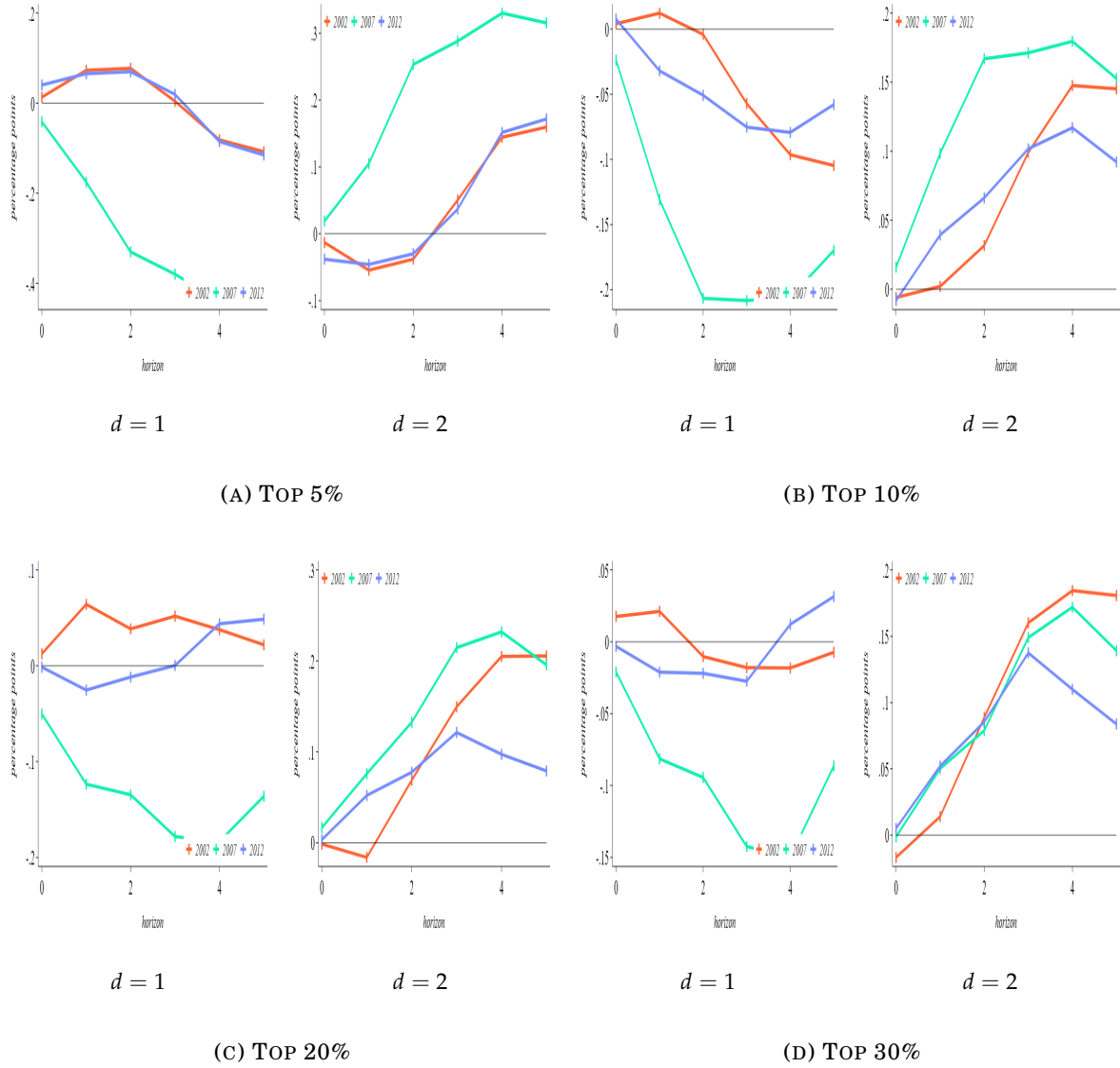


FIGURE D.10: SUPPLY LINKAGES AND INTERLINKED SECTORS OVER THE YEARS

Note: given both the *factor input supply* network distance (i.e., supply linkages across sectors given their common downstream buyers) and the *Leontief inverse* transmission (i.e., sectoral direct and indirect network exposure) characterizing the North American production network over different years (2002, 2007, and 2012), the figure shows the response of sectoral employment of sectors with most Input-Output linkages to a 1% increase in the employment level of other sectors for 3-digit U.S. 2017 NAICS sectors over the period 1998-2022. Expanding to different production network structures the responses of Panels 9a-9b of Figure 9, each panel of this figure shows the employment response of top 5% (Panel D.10a), 10% (Panel D.10b), 20% (Panel D.10c), and 30% (Panel D.10d) more connected sectors in the production network (i.e., major number of I-O linkages) – from top-left to bottom-right, respectively – to employment changes in their closer (distance equal to 1) or further (distance equal to 2) sectors. Solid lines corresponds to the average response of employment across sectors, while 68% and 90% significance levels of bootstrapped Confidence Interval (CI), computed from eq. (18), roughly correspond to the associated figure. *Source:* BEA and own calculations.

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